

Site Management Manual



Army

Transition Assistance Program (TAP)

July 2025

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Chapter 1: Introduction

Transition Assistance Program Site Management Manual

The Site Management Manual (SMM) defines the delivery of the Army Transition Assistance Program (TAP) and career assistance services according to contract requirements. It is necessary for contractor staff to be thoroughly familiar with this manual. This manual is for the administrative and operational control of contractor requirements at TAP locations and is not intended to supersede Army Regulation (AR) 600-81 Transition Assistance Program, Army Directive 2019-26 or DoDI 1332.25.

Emerging issues and policy changes frequently necessitate revisions to the guidance outlined in the SMM. Updated TAP procedures are communicated through email and implemented via operational updates. Training and information resources can be accessed through shared channels and will be distributed electronically through requested secure access. Staff members are advised to thoroughly read and comprehend all updates to the SMM.

This manual does not encompass all corporate contractor policies. In matters of employee relations, corporate personnel policies take priority over the guidelines presented in this manual. For any inquiries regarding corporate personnel policies, please direct them to the corporate Human Resources Office via the Contractor Installation Manager (CIM) and the Regional Manager (RM) responsible for your site.

The TAP Mission

TAP provides effective transition and employment assistance services designed to help Transitioning Service members evaluate their skills and objectives. It guides them in setting goals and developing actionable plans to achieve those aspirations.

TAP strictly adheres to both legal and Army policies. Army Regulation 600-81 outlines the Transition Assistance Program policies set forth by the Department of the Army headquarters.

Army transition initiatives encompass various legal obligations, including the Career Readiness Standards policy, as dictated by law and Department of Defense regulations, and the National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA). The Career Readiness Standards (CRS) policy, mandated by the Office of the Secretary of Defense (OSD) and the DoD, specifies a set of requirements that Service Members must fulfill prior to their transition date, as indicated on their DD Form 214.

The National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2019 mandates that transition services offer at least three (3) counseling pathways (tiers) for Service Members addressing 13 distinct demographics. It also stipulates that an in-person review of the self-assessment must be conducted before any other transition services can be provided.

U.S. Title 10 Code Chapter 58 provides comprehensive details on these benefits and services, including all amendments.

The Transition Assistance Program (TAP) encompasses all government mandates, including those set forth by the CRS and NDAA. The NDAA designates transition as a mandatory program, detailing the core functional requirements that assess and enhance a Service Member's career readiness. To streamline our discussion, we collectively refer to all these requirements as CRS.

The Army provides unemployment compensation to eligible Service Members who are separated from Active Duty under specific circumstances; completion of their tour of duty, fulfillment of an enlistment contract, disability retirement, separation due to the Selective Early Retirement Board, or regular retirement, provided they have not received an unfavorable discharge. Transition Assistance Program (TAP) training is designed to minimize the need for these payments by equipping Service Members with the tools they need to successfully navigate their transition and excel in their future careers.

TAP not only supports the transition process but also encourages retention within the Army. It enables Service Members to evaluate the benefits and compensation associated with their services, empowering them to make informed career decisions. For those opting to leave Active Duty, enlisting in the Guard or Reserves can enhance their income, broaden their community connections, and open doors to educational and career opportunities.

The dedicated staff of TAP contractors express a genuine commitment to Service Members and their families, reinforcing the Army's lifelong pledge to support them. This level of dedication fosters a favorable perception of the Army and enhances its capacity to attract the next generation of men and women into service. Service Members who feel that their military experience has prepared them to thrive in civilian careers are more likely to remain loyal to the Army and to recommend it as a career path to their friends and family.

The TAP Client

The TAP Client is outlined in AR 600-81 and DoDI 1332.35. Laws and policies mandates Service Members who transition from military service with 180 or more continuous days of Title 10 Active-Duty service (excluding certain training days) to comply with legal and regulatory requirements for receiving transition assistance services and benefits as early as possible. Retiring Service Members may begin TAP services 24 months before their retirement. All other Service Members can initiate TAP services 18 months prior to their scheduled release date, but no later than 365 days beforehand. Additionally, United States Army Reserve (USAR) and Army National Guard (ARNG) Service Members with Title 10 orders resulting in at least 180 days of continuous Active-Duty service, excluding training days, are also mandated to receive transition services.

A short-notice unanticipated loss is defined as a separation occurring 30 days or less before scheduled separation, retirement, or release from active duty. An unanticipated loss refers to a release from active duty that occurs before the completion of an enlistment, contract, or orders. Service Members who are separated from the Army prior to their scheduled release date, whether voluntarily or involuntarily, face unique challenges and are at a high risk of unemployment. Once such Service Members experiencing short-notice or unanticipated loss are identified, Commanders will immediately refer them to commence Transition Assistance Program (TAP) services. This includes receiving Individualized Initial Counseling with the review of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation Counseling, and participating in all available transition services prior to their departure. A Service Member is deemed to be involuntarily separated if they are discharged involuntarily, or they are denied reenlistment.

All staff will review and adhere to TAP eligibility guidelines as outlined in AR 600-81. This regulation defines three primary categories of TAP Clients: Service Members, their Family Members, and DA Civilian employees. However, these individuals are part of a broader population that includes Veterans, retired Service Members, and Reserve Component Service Members, all of whom are eligible to enroll in and benefit from specialized transition assistance counseling and employment services offered through TAP.

It is essential to differentiate between an eligible Client who may receive services and one who is required to do so. For instance, a Veteran who has already retired is eligible for lifetime services, but is not obligated to complete Individualized Initial Counseling, with the review of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation or Capstone Counseling with the review of the Post Assessment. Conversely, a Service Member planning to retire within 24 months is also eligible for TAP; however, they are required to complete Individualized Initial Counseling with the review of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation, or Capstone Counseling with the review of the Post Assessment. They should aim to be career ready by acquiring all applicable Career Readiness Standards (CRS) in line with their tier assignment.

Additionally, the Department of the Army policy extends transition assistance to family members and caregivers of all Active Component (AC) Service Members, as well as those Reserve Component (RC) Service Members on Active Duty who have been referred to the Integrated Disability Evaluation System (IDES). This support also encompasses caregivers of eligible Service Members assigned or attached with Soldier Recovery Unit (SRU) or Soldier and Family Assistance Center (SFAC). Furthermore, TAP services are available to the family members of retired Service Members and Veterans, contingent upon space availability.

TAP offers effective transition and employment assistance services designed to help Clients evaluate their skills and career aspirations, thereby providing them with a roadmap to establish future goals and develop actionable plans.

The TAP Center, Army Installation, and Contractor

The Army installation serves as the fundamental operational hub for delivering services to Service Members, Department of the Army (DA) Civilian employees, and their families. To provide these services, the Transition Assistance Program (TAP) Program Management Office (PMO) implements regulations, directives, and instructions which carry out the will of Congress, as expressed in authorization and appropriation bills, along with the policy decisions of DoD.

Installation Management Command (IMCOM) is responsible for budgeting and overseeing the provision of essential installation services. At the installation level, the Garrison Commander allocates resources and manages all functions and services that support the installation.

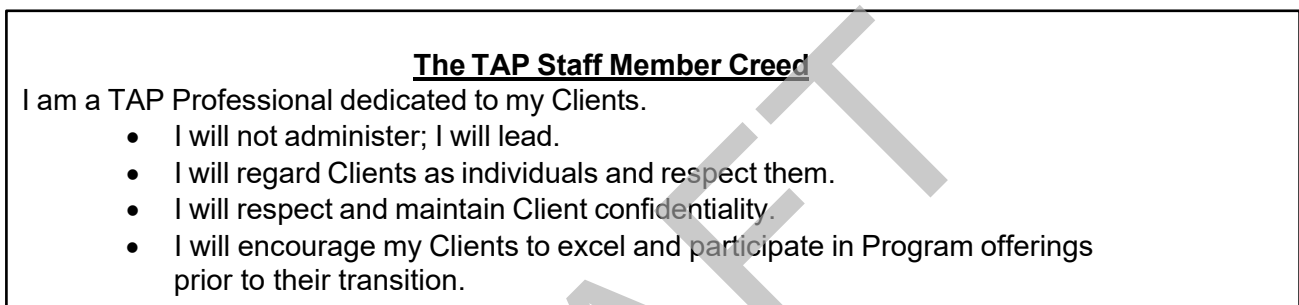
While the TAP contractor staff does not provide all transition-related services, they are integral members of a diverse multidisciplinary team. The Transition Services Manager (TSM), who holds governmental oversight for local TAP operations, facilitates the coordination of transition services and support among TAP, various contractors, interagency partners, civilian organizations, and installation service providers. Several installation elements collaborate closely with transitioning Service Members throughout the TAP process, including but not limited to:

- The Directorate of Human Resources (DHR) plays a pivotal role in shaping the working and living environments on the installation. The services offered under this Directorate encompass Military Equal Opportunity and Affirmative Action Programs, the Army Substance Abuse Program (ASAP), the Director of Family and Morale, Welfare & Recreation (DFMWR), the Civilian Personnel Advisory Center (CPAC), and the Military Personnel Division (MPD)
- Personnel from the Network Enterprise Center (NEC) establish operating policies, manage automation activities and systems, and ensure the maintenance of the network on the installation
- The Office of the Staff Judge Advocate (SJA) offers legal counsel to Commanders, Service Members, and Family Members, as well as advising transitioning Service Members about restrictions on post-government employment
- The Chaplain provides traditional religious services and oversees counseling programs for Service Members and their Families
- The Public Affairs Officer (PAO) staff delivers guidance on public and media relations, facilitating information exchange within the Command
- Public Affairs Officer (PAO) staff provides advice on public and media relations and information exchanged within the Command
- Army Community Service (ACS) representatives on the installation assist transitioning Service Members with a variety of issues, ranging from relocation assistance to behavioral health concerns

The TAP Culture of Professional Service

The Army expects a standardized delivery of high-quality service from TAP contractor staff. Consequently, staff members are required to adhere to the business processes and guidelines outlined in this manual, as well as other TAP operating directives. As integral members of a professional team, TAP contractor staff uphold a strong ethical code, respecting the dignity of Clients and ensuring that personal information, counseling disclosures, and job search documents remain confidential. TAP Clients are the central focus of our mission, as their goals and needs are the foundation of TAP's existence. [Figure 1](#) illustrates the TAP Staff Member Creed.

Figure 1: TAP Staff Member Creed



TAP contractor staff cooperate with other service providers but should not intrude on their missions. TAP adheres to installation safety and security, as well as administrative rules and regulations, which exist to protect TAP contractor staff and Clients. TAP contractor staff cooperate with unit Commanders, leaders, and supervisors and depend on those relationships to encourage Service Member participation in TAP. Unit Commanders, leaders, and supervisors expect TAP contractor staff to respond to inquiries promptly, accurately, and politely.

TAP SOR (System of Record) is the central database for Army transition assistance services. Detailed operating instructions for the TAP system can be found in the TAP User Guide, available on the contractor's reference library or shared drive. TAP contractor staff must effectively and efficiently capture and update data in TAP SOR to track Client progress accurately. The updated data reported from TAP SOR is essential for ensuring mutual support of the TAP initiative and transition program.

TAP contractor staff must always maintain objectivity and avoid behavior that could compromise their impartiality. The roles of Counselors (Transition, Education, Career Skill or Financial) in facilitating transition and job search activities focus on motivating Clients, not controlling them. The goal is to empower Clients to take ownership of their transition process. For example, counselors should not dominate conversations, impose their own values, or interrupt during meetings with Clients. [Figure 2](#) demonstrates the Client Bill of Rights.

Figure 2: TAP Client Bill of Rights

<u>Client Bill of Rights</u> As a TAP Client, I have the right to . . . • Efficient TAP services and programs provided in a timely manner. • A trained and knowledgeable counseling staff. • Be recognized as an individual and regarded as a person with value. • Honest responses from my TAP counselors. • Assistance or guidance as I define my goals and objectives. • A TAP experience that centers on my goals and objectives. • Empathy; not judgment, personal opinions, or sympathy. • A responsive and attentive counselor who listens and wants what is best for me.

Staff must know their limitations and be able to refer Clients to the principal source of information and assistance whenever appropriate. Regardless of their professional background, TAP contractor staff does not provide family counseling, substance abuse treatment, or mental health counseling. Clients may indicate a need for such services and are to be referred to appropriate service providers at the time of question; if it is not indicated until Capstone, then the Transition Counselor will provide a Warm Handover. Except in emergency cases, then reference the [Threat to Life section](#).

Chapter 2: TAP Staff, Roles, and Responsibilities

TAP Employees

There are many differing types of TAP employees. This section will explain various roles government and contractor employees serve within the program.

Human Resources Command (HRC) Government Employees

HRC government employees include the Transition Division Director, who oversees the policy for TAP, Army separations, and the funding for the TAP contract. Multiple policy analysts support the Transition Division Director. The Contracting Officer Representatives (COR) are located at HRC. In addition, the Transition team responsible for TAP system of record (SOR) comprises of government employees who oversee additional contractors for the maintenance and revision of TAP SOR.

Installation Management Command (IMCOM) Government Employees

IMCOM government employees include Transition Regional Leaders responsible for monitoring the relative health of each installation's TAP. These individuals maintain communication with their assigned region's Transition Services Manager (TSM) and the HQ IMCOM Staff.

Transition Services Manager (TSM)

The AR 600-81 provides insight into the TSM function for TAP. This section identifies items related to local TSM responsibilities related to the TAP contractor. A TSM may function as an Assistant Contracting Officer Representative (ACOR) to the COR to assist the Army in monitoring contract performance and standardization. All TAP ACORs are designated and appointed by the HRC COR in writing and work directly for the HRC COR. TSMs, in their role as an ACOR, are limited in scope regarding working relationships between government employee/contractor staff. For example, TSMs do not supervise the TAP Center staff nor have authority to direct the contractor not to report to work. If closure of a Center is needed, the TSM will inform the HRC COR of the closure and reason. In inclement weather, the TSM should notify the HRC COR.

The TSM also assists the TAP contractor staff by coordinating all contact with installation officials, arranging work orders, and maintaining an effective relationship with the NEC for staff access. The TSM or other assigned local government employee can assist contractor staff with obtaining security clearances due to installation guidance. The TSM monitors and reports compliance and ensures contractor Common Access Cards (CAC) are issued. The TSM also coordinates with the local security office and/or other government entities responsible for documenting and granting access to Transition and functional items. An example would be obtaining signatures on items such as Acceptable Use Policies (AUP), System Authorization Access Request Forms (SAAR – DD form 2875), and access to necessary or required training.

The TSM ensures local resources are available for TAP success, such as staff and Client computers, office furniture, copiers/printers, paper, office supplies, telephones, classrooms, and adequate storage areas for TAP materials. Contractor staff assist the TSM with labeling and inventory activities for government utilized equipment.

The TSM's role in the TAP process includes providing direct facility and logistic support to the TAP center contractors. TSMs play a critical role in the initial identification of eligible Service Members in the TAP process. The TAP SOR provides TSMs and Commanders the Service Member TAP eligibility roster (projected loss roster). TSM obtains information about unanticipated losses from Commanders to identify Service Member who are rapidly discharged. TSMs and Commanders work together to get Service Members registered in the TAP SOR. Once the Service Member is registered in the TAP SOR, the CIM ensures Service Members are identified and referred for Individualized Initial Counseling, with the review of the Initial Assessment and Pre-Separation Counseling along with all required transition assistance. At training installations, the TSM works with the installation to identify courses where students or trainees accrue 180 days or more of continuous Active-Duty military service outside of training days to determine eligibility and TAP SOR registration.

The TSM may also complete and submit a mission request for staffing support in the event of a surge in transitioning Service Members, such as mobilization, demobilization, or Service Member Readiness Processing (SRP) which requires a temporary increase in TAP services at their location. Contractor personnel vacancies do not warrant a request for staffing support.

The TSM may designate a Transition Services Specialist (TSS) as a TAP installation POC supporting the TSM or Directorate of Human Resources (DHR). A common occurrence may be that the TSS and CIM coordinate to ensure sufficient materials are on hand to meet expected throughput for a defined period, or the TSS may assist the contract staff in working with installation officials in support of TAP endeavors. Regardless of a TSS, contract requirements dictate that the TSM and CIM must meet weekly as communication between these two entities is vital to program success.

Contractor Staff Relationship with Government Employees

TAP service delivery is governed by the centrally managed, non-personal services contract. According to the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 37.101, a non-services contract is typically defined as a contract under which the personnel rendering the services are not subject, either by the contract's terms or by the manner of its administration, to the supervision and control that usually prevails in the relationship between the government and its employees. Under a non-personal services contract, the contractor is required to perform or deliver work as defined in the Performance Work Statement (PWS). The government tells the contractor what to deliver and to what standard and the contractor supervises their employees to achieve those goals.

Consequently, at the installation/activity level, when providing work defined in the PWS, the CIM supervises the contractor staff. As the Commander's principal staff agent for TAP, the TSM is the source of installation policy and transitioning Service Member needs for the CIM and contractor staff.

The contractor hires the TAP contractor staff and implements all personnel actions for these employees. The TSM does not participate as an approving agent in the selection process, evaluate individual performance, or release contractor staff. Policies and operational guidance are communicated, and issues are resolved through a management chain within the contractor organization. The contractor's Program Manager establishes performance standards based on the PWS. The contractor uses periodic reports, Quality Control Plan (QCP) inspection results, and input from the TSM to ascertain how well these standards are met.

Within the limits of the contract, the TSM coordinates the location and number of events, such as Individualized Initial Counseling with the review of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation Counseling and TAP additive classes. TAP additive classes should be offered at least once a month, and if they are not, the CIM is to inform their RM why they are not being facilitated. The TSM serves as the primary link for administrative and logistical support between the CIM and the installation; however, the TSM has no legal

status as a Contracting Officer (KO) or Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) and cannot direct a member of the TAP Center contractor staff to take an action that will obligate the government in any manner. Likewise, the contractor staff cannot obligate the government in any manner. Should a conflict arise between the TSM and CIM over these responsibilities, the TSM should immediately notify his or her Chain of Command, HQ IMCOM, and the HRC COR. The CIM should promptly notify his or her Regional Manager (RM).

Contractor Ethics

TAP contractors work under the Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) 37.101, as defined above. In this relationship, government employees cannot direct or authorize contract employees. For example, they cannot grant administrative leave or change the dress code. Contractors work toward the PWS as interpreted by government contract officials and the Program Manager.

As employees of a government contractor providing services to Clients, staff are expected to maintain a professional demeanor and adhere to both company and contractor policies. Contractor employees are accountable to the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) as well as any other relevant statute. Engaging in impropriety, the appearance of impropriety, or conflicts of interest between an employee's official responsibilities and personal interests are strictly prohibited.

Contractors are not considered government employees. To minimize errors, misrepresentation, and confusion, contract employees are required to self-identify as contractors by wearing a contractor-issued badge. This identification should be reflected in various forms of communication, including email signature blocks, work product documents, phone interaction, and during meetings. Contractor personnel must display the contractor-issued badge prominently above the waist while performing work under this contract. Badges should never be concealed under clothing or kept in pockets; they must always be visible while on a military installation.

Contractor hours may vary and can include work on federal holidays or weekends. Contractor employees are prohibited from giving gifts to government or federal employees, including their TSM (Transition Services Manager) or TSS (Transition Services Specialist). Additionally, contractor employees are not authorized to utilize government facilities, such as a commissary, within the United States unless they are entitled to these services, potentially as retired military personnel or dependents.

Personal information regarding Clients or their family members may only be shared with other TAP contractor staff or the TSM/TSS when conducting official business or to provide transition services. Client approval is required before releasing this information to any third party. It is strictly prohibited to disclose Client information to an employer or business that may benefit financially from it. Files and information pertaining to Clients and their family members must be protected to prevent unauthorized access. Unauthorized access to information in the web-based TAP SOR system must be strictly controlled.

Data Security and Breaches

All contractor personnel are tasked with preventing and addressing information security threats, monitoring workstations to control access, and ensuring adherence to security protocols. To safeguard against unauthorized disclosure or disposal, contractor staff must protect all forms of sensitive written or digital information. Credentials, including usernames and passwords, must not be shared.

The documents, publications, and information acquired during work with TAP and found in TAP SOR are considered Army property and cannot be used, discarded, or exploited by an employee for personal gain or for the benefit of anyone other than the Army, TAP Center Clients, or the contractor while fulfilling contract obligations.

All contractor personnel are responsible for reporting security lapses, violations, or breaches involving Personally Identifiable Information (PII) to the PMO. This must be done by submitting a written report to the PMO, specifically to the Program Manager (PM), Deputy Program Manager (DPM), Regional Manager (RM), Contractor Installation Manager (CIM), and HRC COR within ONE HOUR of the breach. This report must include detailed accounts of the “who, what, when, where, and why” (the 5W’s) related to the incident.

Organization Conflict of Interest

Organizational Conflict of Interests (OCI) typically refers to a situation involving a contractor who provides advice, information, direction, or assistance to an offeror or another contractor in the preparation or submission of an offer for a government contract. In the event an OCI is identified, a written report must be submitted to the Program Manager (PM), Deputy Program Manager (DPM), Regional Manager (RM), Contractor Installation Manager (CIM), Designated Government Representative (DGR) and assigned Contracting Officer’s Representative (COR) within ONE HOUR. This report should encompass the 5W’s. Subsequently, a staff member from the Program Management Office (PMO) will promptly develop a plan for the avoidance or mitigation of the conflict and submit it to the Contracting Officer.

Common Access Card and Other Government Credentials

A Common Access Card (CAC) is an identification card equipped with a smart chip that encodes information uniquely identifying the cardholder. It is read by a device typically connected to a computer. The Department of Defense (DoD) and the Army utilize CACs to establish an individual’s identity and confirm their authorization to access automated systems, networks, or facilities.

All contractor personnel are required to obtain a CAC as soon as possible after receiving a favorable security investigation. It is essential that all contractor staff adhere to government guidelines regarding the handling, storage, and display of their CAC, as it is considered a sensitive item.

No staff member is permitted to share their username and password with others, nor may they use another individual's login of CAC under any circumstances, regardless of their personal relationship (e.g., spouse). Furthermore, to safeguard sensitive information, staff must ensure that Clients do not observe their username and password.

Passport Requirements

As a result of ongoing military operations and the deployment of Army personnel, TAP contractor staff, to include Forward Transition Support Teams (FTST) personnel, may be assigned to provide remote TAP services to Service Members who are deployed or stationed overseas. It is essential to maintain a valid passport with at least six months from remaining before its expiration date due to travel requirements.

Dress

Employees are expected to always present themselves in a professional manner, whether in business casual or formal attire, as all Clients are considered business associates. There may be instances where the nature of the work permits less formal clothing, such as an office relocation or when operating in a non-business setting. In such limited cases, site management will determine the appropriate attire.

For TAP contractors, formal business attire (such as a suit) is required while delivering courses, presenting to Clients, or during VIP visits. Business casual attire is also acceptable for daily work activities. Should an employee fail to adhere to the dress code, site management will remind them to comply with the guidelines in the future. If an employee's attire is deemed inappropriate, site management will request that the employee go home to change into suitable clothing before returning to work. Please refer to [Figure 3](#) and consult the Contractor Additional Employment Information (CAEI) training for further details.

The dress guidelines are flexible to accommodate religious beliefs and disabilities. Employees requiring such accommodation must submit a request through their supervisor, who will then notify the manager of a final decision.

Figure 3: Dress Guidelines

ACCEPTABLE Dress Guidelines	
Outerwear: Suit jacket, sport jacket, blazer	Bottoms: Dress or skirt at the knee or longer (typical rule is longer than end of fingertips when hands are at sides), khakis, dress pants, dress jeans
Tops: Appropriate blouse/shirt, turtleneck, suit vests, dress shirt (with tie), knit shirt, sweater, polo, camisole or similar (when layered)	Footwear: Dress shoes/sneakers/sandals, loafers, flats, heels, pumps, peep toe shoes (all toes should not be exposed)
UNACCEPTABLE Dress	
Jeans that are faded, torn, or ripped (jeans not allowed while presenting to Clients)	Tank tops, spaghetti straps, low cut shirts, crop top; Sundresses or strapless dresses or shorts
Leggings or gym clothing; see-through or excessively tight clothing	Clothing with obscene, vulgar, profane wording or graphics
Flip flops, or sandals (No strappy or fully open toe heels/sandals)	Tee shirts, sweatshirts, hoodies, hats, or visors
Ripped, torn, dirty, or stained clothing	Earbuds when interacting with Clients

Timekeeping

All contract staff are required to adhere to strict timekeeping practices. Timesheets, whether electronic or paper format, must be maintained consistently with daily entries for hours worked. Assigned labor charge codes must be recorded for time spent on tasks specific to the contract. Codes for Holiday, Time Off, and Leave Without Pay (LWOP) should be entered to accurately reflect any time away from work. It is essential that both Time Off and LWOP are approved in advance. Contract Installation Managers (CIMs) retain authority to deny LWOP requests if they disrupt operational needs. Please note that installation announcements pertaining to training holidays, inclement weather closures, or holiday gatherings do not alter contractor timekeeping regulations. The government authorized 59-minute rule does not apply to contractors. Employees are expected to notify their CIM in the event of an emergency that prevents timely arrival at the worksite or leads to a work absence. Deliberately submitting an inaccurate timesheet may constitute a violation of Federal Law. Therefore, all contractor staff must ensure that the hours recorded accurately reflect work performed, and only approved contract charges should be applied. Additionally, all submitted hours must exclude any time spent on non-work-related activities, such as attending activity days hosted by the Government or Contractor. All time entries must be submitted daily by 0900 on the following business day.

Paid Work Hours

The staff may consist of a combination of full-time and part-time employees. Full-time employees can be classified as either exempt or the Service Contract Act (SCA). Exempt employees receive a salary, while SCA employees are compensated on an hourly basis. Part-time employees are allocated a maximum of 20 paid hours per week.

All staff members are responsible for maintaining their calendars, and the CIM ensures that the scheduled events for part-time employees align with their allotted hours.

To ensure the effective provision of transition and employment assistance services, the CIM is responsible for managing all employee schedules, including vacation and illness-related absences.

To fulfill mission requirements, the TSM is authorized to implement changes to the TAP Center's operating hours. However, the TSM cannot initiate changes that incur costs not previously approved by the Army. The TSM must confirm that any proposed alterations to operating hours can be accommodated without additional expenses, or that, if costs are involved, the HRC COR has approved the change. Furthermore, the TSM or CIM is not permitted to close a TAP Center or satellite office without prior authorization from the TAP Program Management Office at Fort Knox, unless an emergency arises.

It is the responsibility of each employee to document the hours they have worked. The contractor has established guidelines for timesheet documentation, and the CIM is tasked with enforcing these rules. Both the CIM and RM are responsible for verifying the hours reported on timesheets. As timesheets reflect contractor costs to the Army, any falsification may be considered fraud under Federal law and will result in disciplinary actions, up to and including dismissal.

Timesheets must accurately represent only the actual hours worked or otherwise credited as legitimate sick leave, vacation, observed holidays, or leave without pay, among others. While all official hours worked must be documented, granting overtime for hours worked is prohibited, including evening or weekend hours required by the Center's operating hours. Any inquiries regarding work hour documentation or authorization for work outside the TAP Center should be directed to the RM.

TAP Contractor Staff

The Program Manager (PM) serves as the primary liaison between the contracting entity and the Army Contracting Officer, as well as the Army Contracting Officer's Representative. This role encompasses the management of all contractor personnel and the daily operations of TAP. The contractor staff within TAP is led by the PM, who oversees the Project Management Office (PMO) for the contract. The PM is accountable for the overall management of the contract and all associated contractor personnel. This includes directing performance management, conducting reviews, and overseeing investigations and counseling for contractor staff. Supporting

the PM, the Deputy Program Manager (DPM) assists with the day-to-day operations of TAP. Regional Managers (RMs) provide management support and guidance to TAP contractor staff outside of the PMO, ensuring that required services are delivered in a standardized manner across the program, which includes staffing, recruiting, and coverage planning.

Additional personnel are assigned to the PMO, including quality control specialists, strategic communications experts, intelligence officers, liaison officers, analysts, and trainers. This additional staff supports TAP Centers in various capacities and helps fulfill contract requirements beyond the direct services offered to transitioning Service Members.

Most contract personnel are stationed at TAP Centers to deliver direct services to transitioning Service Members. Therefore, the following sections will concentrate on the staff typically found at these sites and the roles they play.

Telephone Etiquette and Email Signature Block

All staff must maintain the standard voicemail/answer greetings and utilize the default signature block on all email correspondence.

- **Front Desk:**

"Thank you for calling (Installation Name) Transition Assistance Program (Company Name) Contractor, we are sorry that we cannot come to the phone right now. However, if you leave your First & Last Name along with your Phone Number, a TAP Staff Member will call you back within 24hours. Thank you and have a great day."

- **Staff Member – Desk:**

"Thank you for calling the (Installation Name) Transition Assistance Program. You have reached the desk of (Company Name, Contractor) (Staff Member Name). I am sorry, I am unable to take your call at this time, but please leave your First & Last Name along with your Phone Number, and I will call you back at my soonest opportunity, within 24hours. If you need immediate assistance, please call our main office at (Provide Main Center Phone Number). Thank you and have a great day."

- **Telephone Etiquette – When you Answer a Call on your Desk Phone:**

"Thank you for calling (Installation Name) Transition Assistance Program (Company Name) Contractor (Staff Member Name) speaking, how may I assist you?"

Threat to Life Phone Procedures

Step 1. Identify that caller is a threat to self or others.

Step 2. Keep Service Member on phone. Get as much information as possible: name, location, unit, and phone number.

Step 3. Get a coworker's attention and have them call the National Suicide Prevention Lifeline 988.

Step 4. Coworkers will give National Suicide Prevention Lifeline SM phone number to call.

Step 5. When the National Suicide Prevention Lifeline calls SM's phone, have SM answer call. This will end your call with SM.

Step 6. Immediately notify your Chain of Command and SM's Commander about the situation. (Notification should occur within 60 minutes)

- Email Signature block should read as follows: (returned Within 24 hours)

First and Last Name

Position Title, Company Name,

Contractor

Transition Assistance Program

Government Email Address

Contractor Email Address (if applicable)

Site Address

U.S. Army Human Resources Command

Follow Army TAP on social media!

Facebook @USArmyTAP

LinkedIn @linkedin.com/in/taphq

Twitter @usaarmy_tap

Desk Number

Confidentiality Notice: This email may contain confidential information. If you received this email in error, please delete and notify sender.

Contractor Installation Manager (CIM)

As the representative of the TAP contractor at the installation, the Contract Installation Manager (CIM) is responsible for the smooth and efficient operation of the TAP Center, ensuring compliance with the contract terms. The CIM manages personnel and materials supplied by the contractor in accordance with contractor policies and regulations. In overseas (OCONUS) locations, the CIM ensures that employees adhere to the provisions outlined in the host nation's Status of Forces Agreements (SOFA). Acting as the contractor's point of contact on the installation, the CIM collaborates closely with the Regional Manager (RM) and Transition Site Manager (TSM) to achieve the goals of the TAP program. New CIMs undergo training and certification under the guidance of their RM.

The CIM ensures that newly hired employees complete and submit a National Agency Check with Inquiries (NACI) application and that the NACI process is initiated and finalized for each staff member. Additionally, the CIM provides regular updates on the NACI status for staff members. For newly hired employees, the CIM submits a DD Form 2875 for their TAP System of Record (SOR) and DoD TAP accounts, seeking the necessary signatures for further processing once all requirements are fulfilled. The prerequisites for the TAP SOR account include completion of a NACI, TAP SOR training, Cyber Awareness Challenge, training on Personally Identifiable Information (PII), and HIPAA training, in addition to the submission of a DD Form 2875 and potentially other Acceptable Use Policy (AUP) agreements.

The CIM does not create, modify, or delete a TAP SOR account locally and will adhere to the procedures outlined in the TAP SOR User Guide and the communication from the Transition Division Director. Forty-eight hours prior to an employee's departure, the CIM ensures that no Clients are assigned to the departing employee and that all TAP appointments are resolved. Additionally, the CIM will notify the contractor or Information Technology Liaison Officer (IT LNO) of the employee's departure date for deactivation purposes.

The CIM performs all duties akin to those of a counselor and provides the same services as any staff member within the TAP setting, except for the approval of Spending Plans (unless the individual is a Certified Financial Counselor). The CIM is also responsible for training, directing, evaluating, and, when necessary, disciplining contractor employees in accordance with the policies and operating procedures outlined in this manual. The CIM ensures that contractor staff comprehends and implements these policies and procedures as intended. Furthermore, the CIM conveys TAP performance standards to the staff to prepare them for achieving those expectations.

No new staff member is permitted to engage in substantive activities, such as counseling Clients or teaching classes, without supervision until they have demonstrated proficiency in those activities. The CIM, or an employee with certification, must observe the performance of new contractor staff to confirm this proficiency prior to allowing them to facilitate classes, counsel, or engage in other activities. Ultimately, the CIM is responsible for certifying a new employee's proficiency by completing a certification memo, which is then forwarded to the Training Team for processing.

The CIM conducts weekly meetings with the TSM and DGR for TAP to ensure that the site aligns with the Command's requirements, optimizes efficiency, and reduces redundancy. Additionally, the CIM will hold weekly staff meetings at their respective locations.

The CIM is responsible for monitoring and verifying the hours recorded on timesheets to ensure that only authorized contract charges and charge codes are utilized. It is important to note that knowingly completing or approving an inaccurate timesheet may be considered a violation of Federal law.

In collaboration with the TSM, the CIM establishes appropriate protocols and referral procedures to be followed (e.g., in situations that warrant contacting Military Police) and disseminates this information to all TAP Center staff.

Scheduled counseling appointments take precedence over walk-in Clients, which means that walk-in Clients should not disrupt the appointments of those who are scheduled. For service members seeking counseling appointments, the maximum wait time from the date of request should not exceed ten (10) working days. Contractors are responsible for ensuring that Brick and Mortar sites are adequately staffed to maintain this timeline, based on the average weekly throughput from the previous fiscal year for each specific location.

Contractors must also ensure that the TAP Center is appropriately staffed to handle incoming calls and assist walk-in Clients who wish to schedule appointments or inquire

about general transition-related questions. Walk-in Clients without a scheduled appointment will be attended to by a TAP Center staff member within 15 minutes of their arrival at the TAP site. The CIM confirms that at least one walk-in counselor must always be available; additionally, the CIM may serve as the walk-in counselor when it does not interfere with other assigned responsibilities throughout the day.

The CIM is responsible for managing class schedules, setting up, and breaking down classrooms. This includes planning and announcing local group briefings, as well as coordinating Department of Labor (DoL) One Day and Department of Veteran Affairs Benefits and Services classes to address the needs of Service Members. It is important that the efforts outlined here are coordinated with the TSM prior to implementation.

The setup and breakdown of classrooms involve a range of activities, including but not limited to scheduling, signing for room keys if necessary, arranging materials (such as notepads, pencils, pens, manuals, etc.), wiping down tables or whiteboards, placing trash cans outside the door, clearing easel pads, turning equipment on and off, and testing it to ensure proper function. Additionally, any issues with broken or malfunctioning equipment should be reported appropriately. The CIM may either manage the inventory of supplies, furniture, or equipment designated solely for contractor staff use at the location or designate another TAP contract staff member to do so.

Every Friday, the Contractor Installation Manager (CIM) sends an informal projected Personnel Status Report (PERSTAT) to the Regional Manager (RM) and the Transition Services Manager (TSM). This report outlines the duty status of contractor staff and any anticipated absences for the upcoming week, ensuring that the TSM is informed about the contractor staff's capacity to fulfill the mission. The CIM oversees staff absences to guarantee that mission coverage is maintained. Should there be any changes in status during the week, the CIM promptly informs the TSM. This information is also provided to the Regional Manager (RM) on a weekly basis.

The CIM is responsible for determining the layout, features, and location of bulletin boards. They display, promote, and make available materials received from the TAP Program Management Office or the TSM. The CIM has the authority to showcase job announcements and relevant materials, such as hiring events, that are deemed significant to a large segment of the Client population, with space constraints being the primary limiting factor. Bulletin board materials must be updated at least once a month.

The CIM cannot unilaterally deny an employer the opportunity to post job vacancies on the job bulletin board and must obtain authorization from the TSM to do so. In making decisions about how unsolicited materials from other sources are made available, the CIM and TSM consider the quality, quantity, and current relevance of both the new materials and the materials they will replace. The CIM does not display or provide any materials from individuals, companies, or agencies that are not bona fide employers or that solicit Clients to purchase products or services unrelated to education or training that would enhance the Client's employment prospects.

The CIM facilitates the distribution of information to Clients for the Partnership for Youth Success (PaYS) program while ensuring staff members are well-versed in both the PaYS program and its website. For guidance on accessing the Army PaYS website, please refer to [Appendix 10](#).

In collaboration with the TSM, the CIM strives to meet the standards set by the Transition Assistance Program (TAP). Operating within resource constraints, the CIM works alongside the TSM to establish operating hours and facilitate Individualized Initial Counseling, which includes reviewing the Initial Assessment, conducting Pre-Separation Counseling, and coordinating workshop and briefing schedules tailored to the needs of the installation.

The TSM and CIM hold weekly meetings to assess and monitor the availability of Individualized Initial Counseling, including reviews of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation Counseling, Army Transition Day courses, Department of Labor Employment workshops, VA Briefings, and other employment assistance training. Their objective is to ensure that the number and capacity of scheduled events align with Client needs.

The overarching goal is to provide Service Members with reasonable access to essential services early in their transition process, allowing them to benefit from available workshops and courses without inefficiently utilizing valuable staff resources. If necessary, the TSM and CIM will convene to reevaluate the frequency and capacity of TAP Center event schedules.

The CIM is responsible for ensuring that events created in TAP SOR meet compliance standards, are accurate, and are readily available for scheduling. The CIM and staff actively encourage Service Members to utilize the Virtual Center if they are situated more than 50 miles from a local Brick and Mortar facility or if they are deployed in austere environments where TAP Center services are inaccessible.

To document attendance, the CIM ensures that staff use the printed sign-in roster and / or a QR code within the TAP SOR at the start of each class, with the requirement that attendance data be entered into TAP SOR no later than two (2) business days after the event. The CIM emphasizes the importance of paying special attention to events held on Fridays and/or the last day of the month, as these are critical for end-of-month report collection. Before the last week of the current month, the CIM ensures that TAP core course schedules are extended a minimum of 90 days beyond the end of the current month.

Furthermore, the CIM guarantees that services and data are accurately recorded in TAP SOR in a timely manner.

The CIM prepares, reviews, and distributes essential reports, questionnaire responses, and administrative documents to ensure efficient Center management and support the Army and PMO in their decision-making processes. These reports include the weekly PERSTAT report and all other end-of-month reports.

The CIM encourages Clients who utilize TAP services to fill out an Exit Questionnaire. CIMs are encouraged to request Clients to complete this questionnaire during the Capstone or clearing process to ensure the most valuable feedback is gathered. On a monthly basis, the CIM collaborates with the TSM to analyze the data from these Client questionnaires. This analysis helps the CIM identify trends and investigate potential issues, allowing for informed planning and implementation of corrective actions.

The CIM performs a same-day QCP check to prevent errors and omissions from appearing in the following day's report. They ensure that Client registrations accurately reflect the correct type, affiliation, status, grade, and that the DD Form 2648 (eForm) is completed for the appropriate phase of the Service Member. When the Center opens, the CIM conducts a next-day QCP check to rectify any remaining errors or omissions.

If the Center operates an SFAC, the CIM visits the SFAC on a weekly basis to maintain communication with the TAP SFAC Counselor(s) and assess whether the support provided is adequate, ensuring that the counselors' needs are met. The CIM or SFAC Counselor is also required to meet with the SFAC Director weekly. When necessary, the CIM assigns both permanent and replacement staff to the SFAC and informs the TSM and RM if demand surpasses current staffing levels.

Transition Counselor (TC)

TAP Transition Counselors are required to hold a bachelor's degree and possess a background in training and development, human resources management, counseling, or a related field. Additionally, candidates should have at least two years of experience in career counseling, education, or comparable discipline.

The TAP Transition Counselor delivers comprehensive transition and employment support services to Clients. In this role, the Transition Counselor also undertakes administrative and front desk responsibilities, including answering phone calls and guiding Clients to appropriate workstations.

Transition Counselors are responsible for conducting Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC), which involves reviewing the Initial Assessment and Pre-Separation Counseling materials. Capstone Counseling focuses on the Post Assessment and provides coaching and guidance for separating military personnel as they complete the DD Form 2648 (eForm). Each counseling session led by Transition Counselors should cover the following key areas: available Transition Assistance Program (TAP) services, the development and updating of an Individual Transition Plan (ITP), guidance on creating a resume tailored for federal or private sector opportunities, the establishment of individual transition goals, an understanding of the Continuum of Military Service, and fostering an environment where Service Members can ask questions, seek clarification, and obtain assistance.

Transition Counselors must schedule Service Members for required services in accordance with the Army Transition Timeline. Service Members are typically scheduled for a primary two-day track that aligns with their tier and transition goals, and they are

also informed about additional available services. All IIC, follow-up, and Capstone counseling sessions must be conducted in person, via phone, or through a virtual live conference.

Transition Counselors utilize the IIC as the foundational session to introduce and begin developing an ITP with Clients. Counselors will send all relevant class materials and supporting transition documents to Clients via their preferred email accounts (either personal or group.mil). Clients also have the option to complete their Individualized Initial Counseling by logging into the Virtual Center or by calling the Virtual Center, if they are located more than 50 miles from a physical location or in an austere environment. In such cases, they will receive equivalent service and information from counselors at the Virtual Center.

When a counselor refers a Client to the Virtual Center for services, it is essential to document this referral in the Client's TAP record. The note should indicate the reason for the referral and any relevant details that may assist the Virtual Center team in providing services. For instance, if a Client has not met the Career Readiness Standards (CRS) and is unable to return to the physical site to fulfill the CRS, the Client may be directed to the Virtual Center for further assistance. Transition Counselors should make every effort to verify that the Client has completed the CRS, such as by communicating and obtaining necessary documents via email, before recommending the use of the Virtual Center. If this is not feasible, the referring counselor should make a general note in the TAP record stating that the Client has not met the CRS, is unable to return to the physical site, and has been referred to the Virtual Center for additional services.

Transition Counselors facilitate all necessary instructor-led training as directed by the CIM. Additional courses, such as the Guide to Federal Employment, Dress for Success, and Salary Negotiations, are also offered at local sites. It is important to note that Transition Counselors do not conduct VA Briefings or Department of Labor Employment workshops.

Counselors encourage workshop participants to put what they learn into action while completing every aspect of their transition—resume writing, education planning, financial preparation, and interview readiness.

Transition Counselors also assist Clients in obtaining a copy of their Verification of Military Experience and Training (VMET) document, which is essential for their mandatory Military Occupational Code (MOC) Crosswalk class.

Transition Counselors play a vital role in assisting Clients with accessing their Joint Services Transcript (JST) during the IIC session and ensuring continued access on the day the Service Member transitions.

In a one-on-one counseling setting, Transition Counselors review the Individual Transition Plan (ITP) with Clients and provide valuable insights during the Capstone review process.

Additionally, Transition Counselors offer clarification and guidance on completing the Pre-Separation Assessment section of the DD Form 2648 (eForm), which pertains to Service Member Pre-Separation/Transition Counseling. They meticulously review the eForm for accuracy and sign it following the completion of the Pre-Separation Counseling. During Capstone, they assist Clients in finalizing the Capstone Review section of the eForm and verify that the necessary Career Readiness Standards (CRS) have been met. This verification involves checking the Service Members' activities as recorded in TAP SOR and any pertinent documentation presented during Capstone. Transition Counselors will again sign the eForm for the Capstone Review.

Transition Counselors play a vital role in referring Clients to on-post service providers and delivering timely services, including transition and employment assistance counseling.

They guide Clients in navigating the TAP website and support them with resume development, application processes, and practice interviews.

Transition Counselors are responsible for ensuring that services and data are recorded accurately in the TAP SOR, including maintaining notes, benchmarks, and attendance. This documentation should be completed within 24 hours of the service being provided, or as soon as possible if TAP SOR is unavailable. They also manage Client registrations, schedule appointments, and update Client notes as necessary to align with program objectives.

Additionally, Transition Counselors ensure that Clients who receive TAP services complete an Exit Questionnaire and any relevant Transition Assistance Curriculum Participants Assessments. To obtain the most constructive feedback, they should encourage Clients to fill out the Exit Questionnaire upon completion of the Capstone or during their clearing process.

Transition Counselors will be trained by a certified resume writer located at Fort Knox, providing them with the knowledge to assist Clients in reviewing resumes, providing constructive feedback where needed. Additional assistance will be provided if a Client needs to adjust a resume for a specific employment opportunity.

Soldier and Family Assistance Center (SFAC) Counselor

The SFAC Counselor is a staff member based outside the TAP Center within the SFAC, tasked with providing services to Service Members assigned to a Soldier Recovery Unit (SRU), Community Care Unit (CCU), or other specialized populations needing additional support. The SFAC Counselor operates under the supervision, daily oversight, and policy guidance of the CIM. They participate in all Center meetings and training sessions.

In addition to their core responsibilities, the SFAC Counselor enters Client and service information into the Army Community Service (ACS) Client Tracking System (CTS) and meets with the SFAC director as determined by the CIM, TSM, and SFAC director. The Counselor also performs administrative and front desk duties, which include answering

phones, guiding Clients to workstations, and instructing TAP courses at the SFAC. Moreover, the SFAC Counselor may work with caregivers of wounded, injured, or ill (WII) Service Members, customizing services to meet their individual program needs.

Any issues, concerns, or conflicts that cannot be resolved through the Transition Coordinators (TCs), SFAC Directors, Nurse Case Manager, Physical Evaluation Board Liaison Officer (PEBLO), TSM, and the contractor at the SFAC must be reported to the Contracting Officer Representative (COR) and subsequently communicated to the Transition Assistance Program (TAP) Management Office at Fort Knox.

Under the Joint Base concept, SFACs provide services to members of other military branches who are hospitalized or in the SRU at that Joint Base installation, unless their own military branch offers transition assistance services.

Financial Counselor (FinCO)

Financial counselors are required to possess a nationally recognized financial counseling credential, such as the Accredited Financial Counselor (AFC), Certified Financial Planner (CFP), or FinCert.org. Alternatively, they must demonstrate successful completion of the examination requirements for the Accredited Financial Counselor Certification prior to employment.

Financial Counselors are responsible for facilitating instructor-led financial planning training sessions using only the authorized materials provided by the government. They ensure that attendees complete a post-transition financial spending plan as mandated by their specific tier. After conducting each workshop, Financial Counselors must record attendance in the TAP SOR no later than two (2) business days following the event. Additionally, Certified Financial Counselors are responsible for documenting relevant notes and benchmarks in the Client's TAP record upon verifying the Client's Spending Plan. Certified Financial Counselors will record the appropriate notes and benchmarks in the Client's TAP record when the counselor verifies the Client's Spending Plan.

The certified FinCO offers personalized one-on-one Spending Planning counseling for transitioning Service Members who have successfully completed the Financial Planning for Transition class. These financial counseling sessions may address a wide range of topics, including financial counseling issues, credit card use, credit reports, consumer fraud, and leveraging public agencies to address financial matters related to military transition. Financial Counselors also provide strategies for debt reduction and offer guidance on issues such as child support, alimony, repossessions, housing, student loan debt, bankruptcy, personal finance, tax management, budgeting, cash flow management, life insurance planning, and retirement planning. Sessions can be conducted in person, over the phone, or via virtual live conference.

Financial Counselors do not conduct marketing for services, provide recommendations for stocks or other investment purchases to transitioning Clients, nor do they retain Client files outside of the TAP SOR.

For Service Members engaged in the asynchronous curriculum, Financial Counselors will review the Client's Spending Plan to ensure it is complete. They will then document the appropriate notes and benchmarks in the Client's TAP record.

Additionally, Financial Counselors will participate in training and various administrative

tasks, as well as assist with front desk duties or other responsibilities assigned within TAP SOR. It is essential for Financial Counselors to be well-acquainted with all aspects of the Army Transition Day curriculum and the Pre-Separation Counseling process.

Installation Liaison Officer (LNO)

The LNO, or Contractor Installation Liaison Officer, is assigned standard responsibilities to support the CIM. The LNO follows the CIM's directives to complete specific tasks, including reports. LNOs are positioned at designated installations identified by the government.

Additionally, this role involves collecting, gathering, analyzing, and reporting on the effectiveness and timeliness of tasks at the installation level, preparing command-level reports, and reviewing all TAP SOR reports specific to the installation. The LNO also provides ad hoc reports for data that is not provided by the TAP SOR dashboards and standardized reports.

Finally, this position includes analyzing and reporting on TAP events to evaluate throughput, attendance, and resource utilization; resume completion at installation level; monitoring and tracking notification and attendance at DoL One Day; monitoring and tracking attendance for events/functions at the TAP Center; analyzing and reporting on TAP events to determine throughput, attendance, and facility/resource usage.

The LNO supports the CIM in the preparation and distribution of local reports for Commanders and Commander Designees as directed by the TAP Program Management Office.

The LNO consolidates, analyzes, queries, and reports information from the TAP IMCOM tactical office, TAP counselors, VA, DoL, and other TAP transition stakeholders concerning program operations, training opportunities, and other activities that affect the Army's Transition Lifecycle. Additionally, the LNO may be responsible for preparing and delivering post Command-level briefings based on the analysis of collected data on a monthly basis, as well as uploading and monitoring information in the IMCOM knowledge management portals.

LNOs facilitate collaborative public affairs and marketing initiatives among the TAP Centers, the VA, the DoL, and other stakeholders in preparation for upcoming employment and career assistance events, including hiring fairs, employment summits, virtual job fairs, and conferences at both the installation and local levels. In installations without a designated or staffed LNO, the CIM ensures that coordination occurs with the TSM to fulfill LNO responsibilities. The LNO is responsible for ensuring that all Center-hosted employment events are coordinated through IMCOM to ensure that the installation sponsored events are listed on the Army TAP Hiring Events Calendar.

In partnership with the TSM, the LNO provides administrative support and assistance to prepare Service Members for local hiring events, employment summits, virtual hiring events, and career days. Following the conclusion of supported events, the LNO analyzes the data gathered and provides the government with feedback regarding the

number of employers, participants, interviews conducted, attendees receiving firm job offers, and those hired. Additionally, the LNO oversees the setup and teardown of TAP exhibits and booths at approved local events.

The LNO is responsible for monitoring the execution and implementation of TAP questionnaires distributed at the onset, conclusion (exit), and after TAP services with Clients. This evaluation aims to assess satisfaction with transition services and measure progress towards goals aligned with the selected career tracks, which encompass education, employment, entrepreneurship, and vocational pathways, as well as Command support.

LNOs are responsible for monitoring the execution and implementation of all TAP requirements outlined in AR 600-81, which includes Capstone, Individualized Initial Counseling, ITP development, resume completion, and reporting findings to the TSM as necessary. They verify the automated input of the DD Form 2648 (eForm) and analyze the number of Capstone participants along with TAP SOR reports. LNOs are responsible for tracking and monitoring attendance at all events and functions associated with the TAP Center and its initiatives.

The LNO collaborates with the TSM to ensure that work orders are submitted for the repair and maintenance of TAP Center facilities and equipment, including computers, classroom technology, furnishings, printers, and copiers.

Administrative Specialist (AS)

Administrative Specialists are responsible for a range of general administrative tasks and serve at the front desk of TAP locations. Their duties include, but are not limited to: answering phone calls, directing Clients to classrooms, scheduling classes in TAP SOR, creating class rosters, running ad hoc TAP SOR queries, updating event attendance, instructing Clients on computer access, sending reminders (including confirmations and no-show notifications), monitoring the group mailbox, and tracking phone calls and Client traffic (which is required for MSR). Additionally, Administrative Specialists may be tasked with setting up or breaking down classrooms. This may involve up to 15 minutes of work, including tasks such as cleaning surfaces (wiping down tables, etc.) or relocating trash to a designated area for removal (outside the classroom, etc.).

Administrative Specialists may also assist the CIM and TSM in monitoring supply levels and ensuring that office files are maintained in compliance with ARIMS through regular inventory checks. While these responsibilities primarily fall to the Administrative Specialist, all staff members will receive cross-training in these tasks and are expected to support front desk operations as part of a collaborative team effort. In locations where an Administrative Specialist is not available, these duties are distributed among the entire staff, which includes Transition Counselors, Financial Counselors, LNOs (if located onsite), Education Counselors, Career Skills Program Counselors, and the CIM.

Forward Transition Support Teams (FTST)

Forward Transition Support Teams (FTST) deliver a consistent level of service to all Clients, much like the staff at the Virtual Center and TAP Centers. FTST services are provided in accordance with government-approved mission requests, which originate from government officials such as Training Support Managers (TSMs) or Commanders. Upon receiving and approving a mission request, FTST will be notified and provided with travel information in advance of their mission support. The teams offer assistance to Clients who are mobilizing or demobilizing at their locations, as well as providing remote support to Clients in deployed or remote sites. Typically, FTST services are rendered during pre-mobilization, mobilization, demobilization, and Yellow Ribbon Events specifically for the Reserve Component. FTST teams are strategically stationed at various locations throughout the TAP program and is comprised of Transition Counselors, Financial Counselors, and Administrative Specialists.

To comply with travel requirements, it is essential to maintain a valid passport that has at least six months remaining until its expiration date. FTST is responsible for completing all required travel reports as instructed by their CIM. The FTST may also have a work schedule that frequently includes evenings and weekends, reflecting a 40-hour work week from Monday to Sunday. They collaborate with the CIM and RM to fulfill all travel tasks and contract requests, as they are a specialized team within TAP, while still adhering to all training protocols and utilizing the materials provided by the PMO.

Education Counselors (EdCO)

Education Counselors are required to possess a bachelor's degree and should have a background in training and development, human resources management, counseling, or a related field. Additionally, a minimum of two years of experience in career counseling, education, or a comparable discipline is essential.

The role of the Education Counselors involves delivering comprehensive education counseling and support services to Clients. They assist transitioning Clients in establishing educational and occupational goals, interpreting capability and needs assessments, and navigating school admission applications. Counselors will also manage scheduling within the appropriate transition tracking systems, organize Client appointments, and document attendance in accordance with AR 600-81 and SMM. In delivering services, the Education Counselor adheres to the CIM's guidelines and provides Transition assistance comparable to that of the Administrative Specialist. The Education Counselor also undertakes administrative and front desk tasks, including answering phone calls and directing Clients to their designated workstations. Responsibilities may include coordinating and reserving classroom space and equipment at government facilities, setting up government-provided audio-visual equipment, distributing necessary training materials, confirming classroom reservations two weeks in advance, and coordinating with the CIM.

During counseling sessions, the Education Counselor will encourage Clients to utilize available personal assessment tools, such as the Kuder Career Planning System, along with providing an interpretation of the results. Education Counselors offer Client's information on financial assistance and educational benefits, including the Montgomery GI Bill (MGIB), Post 9/11 GI Bill, Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA), scholarships, and strategies for maximizing veterans' education benefits, as well as guidance on applications for student and financial aid.

Education Counselors assist Clients transitioning from active duty in fulfilling the requirements for admission to military schools or programs. These may include the United States Military Academy Preparatory School (USMAPS), the Army Green to Gold Scholarship, various non-scholarship options, and the Health Professions Scholarship Program.

Education Counselors also monitor and document educational goals, counseling notes, and the achievement of the Client Records System within the Clients' transition tracking systems (e.g., TAP System of Record, etc.).

Education Counselors serve as the primary instructors for the Education Track, in alignment with the requirements outlined in DODI 1332-35. Their role is to assist Clients in identifying their career, personal, and academic goals, as well as evaluating the institutional factors that influence the selection of a higher education institution. They provide valuable information regarding funding considerations for educational choices and share essential details about admission requirements. Additionally, they facilitate all necessary instructor-led training as mandated by the CIM. At local sites, they also offer supplementary courses, such as Guide to Federal Employment, Dress for Success, and Salary Negotiations.

Following the conclusion of the MY Education workshop or class, Education Counselors will follow up with Clients within seven (7) days to support their goal achievement, such as assisting with the timely submission of college applications. Moreover, they will reach out within 60 days after the Client's completion of the MY Education workshop/class to monitor progress and offer further guidance in reaching their educational and occupational objectives.

Follow-on counseling shall, at a minimum, assist the Client in understanding and determining if and how they can: transfer recommended military credits; select a degree program; effectively utilize the Servicemembers Opportunity Colleges (SOC) Degree Network System (DNS); comprehend the implications of Executive Order 13607; recognize factors influencing an institution's graduation and retention rates; understand the types and significance of accreditation; navigate databases of Accredited Postsecondary Institutions and Programs; grasp the basic organizational structures of higher education institutions; evaluate the benefits and challenges of various instructional delivery methods; identify institutions that offer flexibility for unique circumstances (e.g., Guard and Reserve); recognize types of Veteran support; research institutions providing Veteran support services; and understand education benefits programs, eligibility criteria, funding options, and the overall cost of a degree

program.

Education Counselors will utilize the Government-provided online questionnaire to be completed at the conclusion of the MY Education workshop. Clients will be given the opportunity to finish the Accessing Education Assessment, which is part of the Transition Participant Assessment located at <https://www.dodsurveys.mil/EFM/se/074A97152CE36DA0>.

Career Skills Program Counselor (CSP CO)

The Army Career Skills Program (CSP) is an integral part of the Transition Soldier Life Cycle model that encourages Clients to take advantage of civilian training and development opportunities during their transition period. These opportunities have a strong likelihood of leading to post-service employment. The CSP provides transitioning Clients the chance to pursue high-demand and skilled careers as they move off Active Duty. As outlined in Chapter 5 of AR 600-81, the CSP encompasses four categories: pre-apprenticeship, internships, employment skills training, and on-the-job training (OJT). The program collaborates with garrison-approved CSP employers, professional associations, unions, industry leaders, and educational and training providers to promote opportunities that can lead to high-value jobs or careers for transitioning Clients.

Approval authority for all providers wishing to partner with the Career Skills Program that requires 121 days or more to complete is granted to HQDA G-1. This includes Individual Internships and all approved DoD SkillBridge programs, with delegation of authority permitted to The Adjutant General (TAG). The DCS, G-1 is the approval authority for all exceptions to policy (ETPs). ETP requests can be submitted tousarmy.knox.hrc.mbx.tagd-transition-assistance-program@army.mil. The authority for soldiers' participation in the Career Skills Program or DoD SkillBridge programs remains in accordance with AR 600-81.

Commanders are responsible for evaluating their unit's readiness and mission requirements to determine the level of risk associated with approving a Soldier's participation in various programs. An administrative absence, not exceeding 180 days, may be authorized for this purpose. For details on approval and the administrative processing of all administrative absences, please refer to AR 600-8-10.

Soldiers attending programs located on installation or within a 50-mile radius of their current duty station must do so in a "Present for Duty" (PDY) status. Conversely, Soldiers participating in programs beyond a 50-mile radius must do so under an "Administrative Absence" (AA) status. Commanders are tasked with establishing daily personnel accountability procedures for those Soldiers authorized to participate. Additionally, commanders reserve the right to revoke participation authorization at any time throughout the program, depending on unit mission requirements.

Furthermore, planning must account for adequate time following the completion of the program to ensure that Soldiers can return to their permanent duty station for the necessary physical and administrative out-processing, as stipulated in AR 600-81.

This includes both unit-level and installation-level out-processing, as well as final clearance before any separation or retirement date.

Counselors are responsible for ensuring that Clients are informed about the Career Skills Program during their Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC) and are referred to a Career Skills Program Counselor (CSP CO) for assistance with registration and applications. CSP COs are required to hold a bachelor's degree in any field and provide substantial transition assistance services to Clients. In delivering these services, the CSP CO follows the instructions outlined by the CIM and offers the same Transition support as the Administrative Specialist. Additionally, the CSP CO carries out administrative and front desk responsibilities, which include answering phone calls and directing Clients to appropriate workstations.

CSP COs are also tasked with developing and conducting briefings, orientations, and special presentations to educate stakeholders and unit Commanders about the CSP mission and opportunities available to Clients. Suitable venues for these activities include the Commander/First Sergeant Course, Installation Information Exchanges, Job Fairs, Education Fairs, Newcomer Orientations, Transition Councils, and other events designed to maximize outreach efforts. Furthermore, the CSP CO will keep CIM informed about relevant policies, procedures, trends, issues, and the overall status of CSP execution. Educational materials may include flyers, news articles, and social media posts.

CSP COs are responsible for educating and marketing CSPs to all transitioning Clients. This encompasses providing information and counseling on CSPs that align with their Individual Transition Plans (ITP), conducting briefings on available CSP opportunities, scheduling CSP training providers for participation in garrison job fairs and other informational sessions, connecting Clients with specific CSP points of contact, and performing interest inventories to inform future CSP development.

CSP COs will verify Client eligibility for CSP participation in accordance with Chapter 5, AR 600-81. If eligible, they will provide Clients and assist in reviewing various forms, including the Soldier/Commander Memorandum of Participation, individual CSP applications, and other application requirements from the provider.

CSP COs are responsible for entering all necessary data into designated IT systems. Furthermore, they must track and document individual Client CSP attendance in the TAP SOR within two business days post-completion.

Soldiers enrolled in the Integrated Disability Evaluation System (IDES) or assigned to a Soldier Recovery Unit (SRU) may commence participation immediately after their Medical Retention Determination Point (MRDP) upon authorization. Soldiers in a SRU

are no longer required to wait 85 days to begin, following the establishment of their MRDP, due to the potential for a separation date that might prohibit their participation in the program.

Commanders may assign qualified Soldiers participating in a program to excess positions (known loss) in IPPS-A, thereby making military positions available for replacement personnel per the modified table of organization and equipment or the table of distribution and allowances authorization documents.

Internships are permitted within Federal, State, or local government entities, or within the private sector (either for-profit or not-for-profit). However, internships cannot be utilized for work on Capitol Hill in any capacity, as the Defense Fellows Program oversees all internships on Capitol Hill.

Chapter 3: The TAP Process

Tiers

Three pathways, or "tiers," have been established for Service Members undergoing their Individualized Initial Counseling. These tiers determine the specific transition classes and Career Readiness Standards that a Service Member must complete to effectively prepare for their career and achieve their transition goals. The assignment to a tier is based on the Initial Assessment conducted prior to the Individualized Initial Counseling session, which subsequently tailors the program, requirements, and support to the unique needs of each Service Member. The tier levels consider various factors, including the Service Member's overall readiness to transition successfully from Active Duty. [Figure 4](#) outlines the requirements associated with each tier.

Figure 4: Tiers

Tier 1	Tier 2	Tier 3	CRS Dependent Upon Track Selection
• Initial Counseling with review of the Initial Assessment • Pre-Separation Counseling • eBenefits • Army Transition Day • DoL One Day • VA Day • ITP • Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only) – All Retirees are Exempt • Capstone with review of the Post Assessment	• Initial Counseling with review of the Initial Assessment • Pre-Separation Counseling • eBenefits • Army Transition Day • DoL One Day • VA Day • ITP • Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only) – All Retirees are Exempt • Capstone with review of the Post Assessment	• Initial Counseling with review of the Initial Assessment • Pre-Separation Counseling • eBenefits • Army Transition Day • DoL One Day • VA Day • ITP • Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only) – All Retirees are Exempt • Capstone with review of the Post Assessment	• DoL Employment Track ◦ Draft Resume or Verification of Employment • DoD Education Track ◦ Comparison of Higher Education Institutions • DoL Vocational Track ◦ Comparison of Transition Training Institutions • SBA Entrepreneur Track ◦ No associated CRS required
	• Post-Transition Financial Plan • Gap Analysis or Verification of Employment • CRS associated with selected primary Career Track (if not waived)	• Post-Transition Financial Plan • Gap Analysis or Verification of Employment • Track Selection* • CRS associated with their selected primary Career Track	*All Tiers must select a Track; Tier 1 and 2 Track attendance can be waived *Tier 3 Clients must select, attend, and provide deliverables for their selected primary Career Track (e.g., Employment, Education, Vocational, or Entrepreneurship)

Career Readiness Standards (CRS)

All transitioning Service Members must fulfill the Career Readiness Standards (CRS) prior to their DD Form 214 transition date. The final verification of CRS compliance is participation in the Capstone event. All Service Members are required to complete Capstone no later than 90 days before their transition and must record the results on the DD 2648 eForm. The comprehensive list of CRS requirements includes:

- Initial Assessment
- Individualized Initial Counseling
- Pre-Separation Counseling
- Individual Transition Plan (ITP)
- VA Benefits and Services
- eBenefits Registration
- Army Transition Day
- DoL One Day (*refer to [Figure 8](#) for qualifying exemptions*)
- Post Transition Spending Plan (Tier 2 and 3 only)
- Gap Analysis or Verification of Employment
- Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only- All Retirees are Exempt)
- Post Assessment
- Capstone with DD Form 2648 Capstone CRS review completion

In accordance with a Service Member's tier and transition goal(s) (education, employment, or vocational), additional track-specific CRS are:

- Resume or Verification of Employment
- Comparison of Academic or Training Institution Choice

Transitioning Service Member Process

[Figure 5](#) illustrates the standard process for transitioning Service Members, commencing with the Initial Assessment, followed by Individualized Initial Counseling and Pre-Separation Counseling. This process is designed for Service Members who start the Transition Assistance Program (TAP) no later than 365 days before their transition date. By spreading the completion of TAP over several months, disruptions to Army missions are kept to a minimum.

Key touchpoints for Client management are:

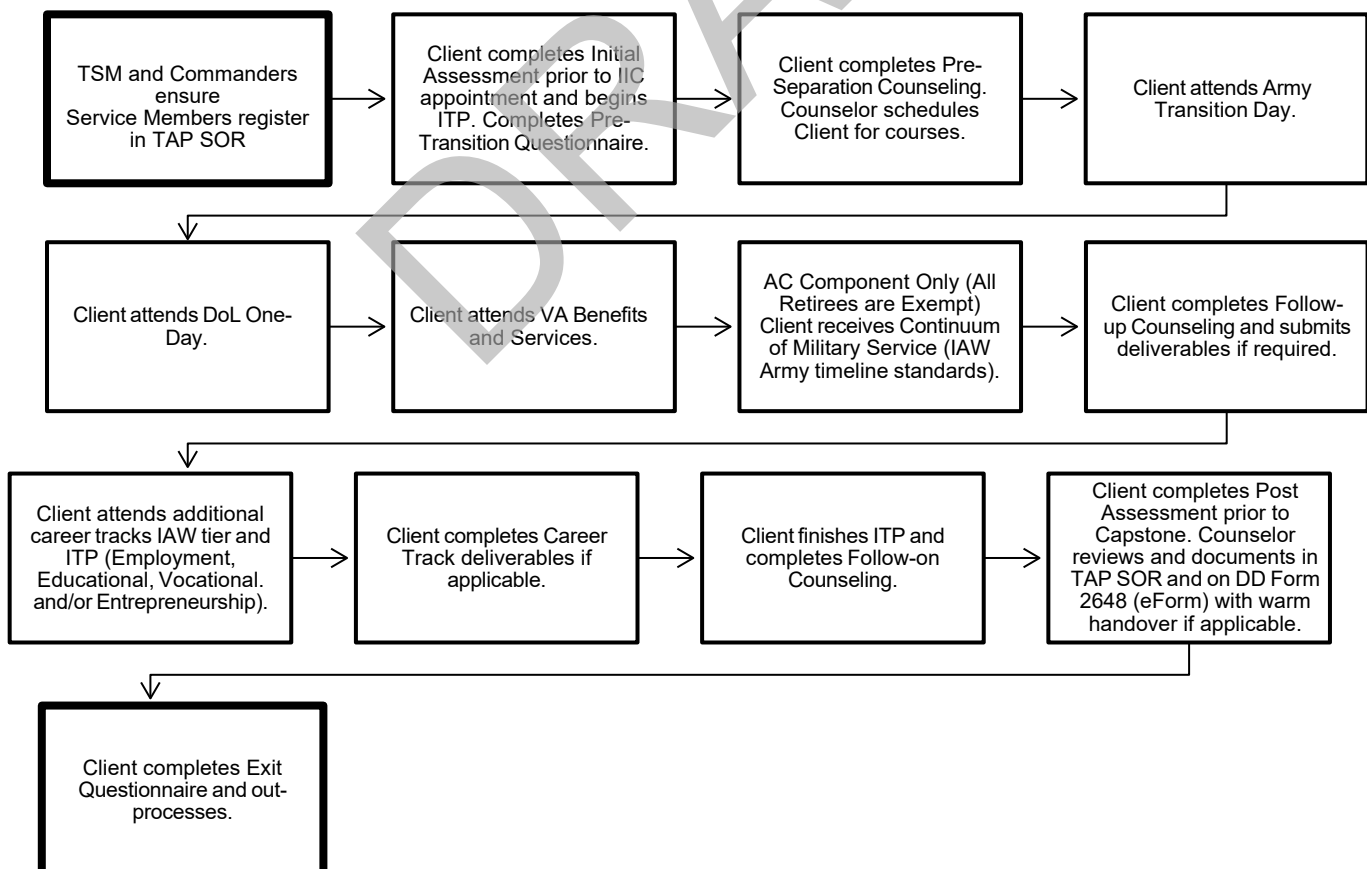
- Eligible transitioning Service Members who have not completed an Individualized Initial Counseling with the review of the Initial Assessment
- Eligible transitioning Service Members who have completed an Individualized Initial Counseling but have not completed Pre-Separation Counseling
- Eligible transitioning Service Members without DoL One Day attendance

- Eligible transitioning Service Members without VA Benefits and Services attendance
- Eligible transitioning Service Members 90 days from Transition Date needing to complete Capstone with the review of the Post Assessment

A notification email using a government email account (personal or group.mil) should be sent to Service Members in TAP SOR that meet one of the five key touchpoints. A copy of the notification email must also be recorded as a note in the Client's TAP record in order for the contractor to meet requirements.

Figure 5: Transitioning Service Member Process

The TAP process starts when TAP SOR provides TSMs and Commanders the Service Member TAP eligibility roster (projected loss roster). The TSM obtains information about unanticipated losses from commanders when Service Members need to be rapidly discharged. TSMs and Commanders work together to get Service Members registered in the TAP SOR. Once the Service Member is registered in the TAP SOR, the CIM ensures Service Members are identified and referred for Individualized Initial Counseling, with the review of the Initial Assessment and Pre-Separation Counseling along with all required transition assistance. At training installations, the TSM partners with the installation Commanders to identify students or trainees who accrue at least 180 consecutive days of Active-Duty service—excluding training periods—to assess eligibility for TAP and SOR enrollment.



*** Counseling appointments or Financial Counseling must (be available to) be scheduled within 10 days of the request and annotated in their record ***

Curriculum Delivery Models

The preferred delivery method for the curriculum is by following the Army Transition Timeline as illustrated in [Figure 6](#). This timeline ensures that Service Members have ample time to prepare for a successful transition, allowing for the resolution of unit scheduling conflicts. Research indicates that initiating the transition process earlier can lead to quicker career placement and better financial preparedness. For example, Service Members should obtain their Verification of Military Education and Training (VMET) and Joint Service Transcript (JST) and complete the MOC Crosswalk prior to participating in the DoL One Day Event.

If the Army Transition Timeline is not feasible, the alternative is the Consecutive Model depicted in [Figure 7](#).

Course Cancellation

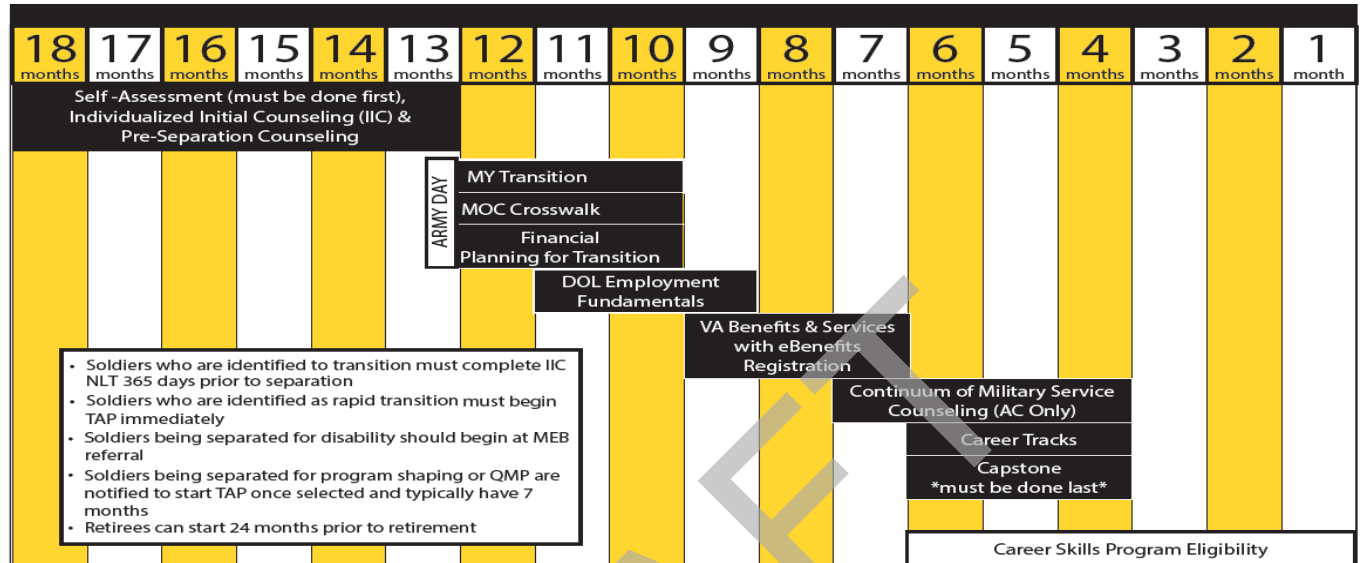
The government retains the right to cancel or reschedule a planned workshop at least 48 business hours before its commencement. The contractor is required to specify the number of classes that are canceled within this 48-hour timeframe when submitting the Monthly Status Report (MSR).

Figure 6: Army Transition Timeline (Distributive Model)



TRANSITION
ASSISTANCE PROGRAM

Commander's Fact Sheet



TAP services represented here can be accessed face-to-face at your local TAP Center, through Army TAP Virtual Center (www.armytap.army.mil) or at 800.325.4715.

www.linkedin.com/in/taphq *www.facebook.com/USArmyTAP *www.armytap.army.mil *twitter.com/usaarmy_tap

Figure 7: Consecutive Curriculum Model (example)

Consecutive Model				
Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
MY Transition	VA Benefits and Services	Department of Labor Employment Fundamentals of Career Transition (DoL One Day)	Career Tracks Two days of instruction in either Education, Employment, Vocational, or Entrepreneurship	
MOC Crosswalk				
Financial Planning for Transition				

*** Counseling appointments or Financial Counseling must be (available to be) scheduled within 10 days of the request and annotated in their record ***

Accountability and Monitoring

TAP SOR generates automated appointment slips for transitioning Service Members and DA Civilian employees. These appointment slips ensure that Commanders and supervisors are informed of the legitimate reasons for their Service Members and employees being excused from their duties.

Unit Commanders, First Sergeants, and supervisors have the authority to verify that their Service Members and DA Civilian Employees are present as required. Client attendance at events and TAP Center services is recorded electronically, allowing Commanders and supervisors to contact the Center at any time to confirm a Service Member's or employee's participation in scheduled activities.

In coordination with the DGR, it is essential to identify and communicate any no-shows for scheduled events to the respective units within 24 hours. Additionally, individual Clients should be contacted to reschedule any missed appointments.

Questionnaires and Assessments

Data collected through Service Member surveys is vital for the Transition Division Director, the Program Management Office (PMO), and managers to effectively monitor the quality and effectiveness of TAP services, as well as the performance of various sites and staff members. All Clients are encouraged to complete electronic questionnaires and TAP Center staff members are responsible for promoting its use

among all Clients. This promotion occurs prior to the delivery of Individualized Initial Counseling, through the Pre-transition Questionnaire, and at the conclusion of the TAP process with the Exit Questionnaire. The system invites feedback from all Client categories, including Service Members, Family Members, Department of Army Civilians, Veterans/Retired Service Members, those assigned to the Soldier Recovery Unit (SRU), and caregivers. While locally designed questionnaires are not permitted, the Department of Defense (DoD) may implement additional questionnaires as needed. Approximately 60 to 90 days after a Client separates from military service, the Post-Transition Questionnaire is automatically sent via email for completion.

The Post-Transition Questionnaire is administered for the purpose of program evaluation, aiming to assess attitudes and perceptions regarding the Transition Assistance Program (TAP) modules at both the Department of Defense (DoD) and installation levels. The insights gained from this assessment will be instrumental in formulating policies that may be essential for enhancing TAP. Reports will be submitted to the Office of the Secretary of Defense (OSD), each Military Department, the Joint Chiefs of Staff, and interagency TAP partners. Additionally, the findings will contribute to the development of reports and testimonies presented to Congress.

To support the TAP contractor staff and management team in identifying and addressing systemic issues, TAP Clients are encouraged to provide feedback on the transition and employment assistance services offered by the TAP contractor staff. TAP contractor staff can assist Clients in completing the Exit Questionnaire once substantial services have been delivered or during the clearance process. For monthly statistics, please refer to the contractor's reference library or shared drive.

To encourage participation, a placard, as illustrated in [Appendix 6](#), displaying the TSM's name and inviting Client feedback is prominently posted at each TAP Center. Clients have the option to reach out directly with comments or concerns either in writing or by phone to the POC listed on the placard. Clients who are dissatisfied are strongly encouraged to contact the POC. Upon receipt of any written or telephonic complaints or comments, the TSM promptly engages with the CIM to discuss the specifics of the issue. The TSM then collaborates with TAP HQ to develop a written synopsis of the Client's feedback, the actions taken, and the final resolution. A copy of this synopsis is sent to the CIM, who forwards the synopsis to their Regional Manager (RM).

Chapter 4: Identification and Notification of Transitioning Service Members

Effective identification of Service Members transitioning from Active Duty and timely notifications are critical to the success of the Transition Assistance Program (TAP). According to AR 600-81, TAP is designed for both Active and Reserve Component Service Members and is treated as a Commander's Program that is guided by performance metrics. By promoting early engagement with TAP services, senior mission or tenant Commanders, Command Sergeants Majors, First Sergeants, and first-line supervisors can help ensure that Service Members can arrange their TAP activities to align with unit mission requirements.

The TAP SOR provides TSMs and Commanders the Service Member TAP eligibility roster (projected loss roster). TSM obtains information about unanticipated losses from Commanders to identify Service Members who are being rapidly discharged. TSMs and Commanders work together to get Service Members registered in the TAP SOR.

When identifying transitioning Service Members who are leaving Active Duty earlier than anticipated, it's important to note that TAP SOR reports are not exhaustive. Their accuracy is limited, as many inaccuracies stem from actions that have not yet been recorded in the personnel database, such as reenlistments, extensions, or retirement packets that have not been submitted. Additional inaccuracies may arise from unexpected changes to ETS or ESA dates due to administrative or medical separations. Therefore, it is essential to obtain further information regarding unanticipated losses from the TSM or other governmental representatives beyond what is provided in the TAP SOR reports. Moreover, these Service Members should receive notifications about their TAP eligibility and requirements within 24 hours.

While TAP contractor staff are not permitted to create or maintain a database for identification or notification purposes, they are allowed to use Excel spreadsheets. However, such spreadsheets must be password protected or encrypted and stored securely if they contain personally identifiable information (PII).

Notification

The TAP SOR provides TSMs and Commanders a dashboard which summarizes Services Members eligibility for TAP. TSMs and Commanders work together to ensure separating Service Members eligible for TAP get registered in the TAP SOR before the 365-day timeliness requirement, or as soon as possible for unanticipated losses.

Intake

Once transitioning Service Members are registered, Service Member must complete an initial assessment before scheduling their Individualized Initial Counseling session. The Service Member registration and initial assessment completes the intake process.

Follow Up with Clients

TAP Centers are responsible for tracking Service Members who schedule but do not attend their Individualized Initial Counseling sessions, as well as those whose status has changed, making this counseling no longer applicable. These individuals are referred to as Clients. For instance, a Service Member may choose to reenlist or decide against retirement.

Reenlistment data is integrated with the TAP SOR application; however, updates to Client records may take up to eight weeks to be processed. If a Client indicates they have reenlisted, but their record remains active after this period, staff should notify their CIM for record deactivation.

Chapter 5: Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC) with review of the Enterprise Individualized Self-Assessment

The EISA is self-administered and will take Service Members between 10-15 minutes to complete; it can be taken virtually from any location or onsite at TAP locations. The EISA is taken online by the Service Member twice during their TAP process:

- Prior to Individualized Initial Counseling (Initial Assessment); no later than 365 days prior to the anticipated date of separation, retirement, or release from Active Duty
- Prior to Capstone (Post Assessment); no later than 90 days before the anticipated date of separation, retirement, or release from Active Duty

TAP Counselors and Center staff should encourage all Service Members to respond to the EISA honestly. This helps TAP Counselors and TAP contractor staff assess the appropriate level of support and resources needed as Service Members navigate their TAP process.

Service Members should understand that their responses will not dictate their TAP requirements. Instead, they will guide the recommendation of customized support and follow-on services, which may vary for each individual.

Individualized Initial Counseling involves a review of the Initial Assessment conducted prior to Pre-Separation Counseling. Both the Initial Assessment and Individualized Initial Counseling are considered Career Readiness Standards (CRS).

Eligible Service Members will participate in an Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC) session in person. If a Service Member is unable to attend in person, the IIC may be conducted over a video/audio teleconferencing capability, or telephonically if the client does not have access to video/audio teleconferencing capability. This must occur no

later than 365 days prior to their release from Active Duty, regardless of discharge status. If the 365-day window cannot be met, the Service Member will initiate the IIC as soon as possible within the remaining period of service.

For Service Members deployed in austere environments, a telephonic Individualized Initial Counseling session may be conducted if adequate equipment or bandwidth is unavailable.

The Transition Counselor, in collaboration with the Service Member, will assess the needs and determine the appropriate counseling pathway or tier that aligns with the Service Member's transition goals based on the Initial Assessment.

The EISA is structured into five sections, labeled A through E. Sections A to D are completed prior to the IIC, focusing on registration and demographic information. Only Section E, which addresses various life domains, is revisited before the Capstone to assess changes in scores from pre- to post-assessment. The weights for the EISA are predetermined in Sections A to D to reflect a Service Member's transition readiness—factors such as retirement versus separation with less than five years of service, education level, and projected discharge weights are taken into account. Additionally, Section E allows for adjustments to accommodate the unique culture of Reserve Component members. The Initial Assessment must take into consideration several factors to effectively address the transition assistance needs of the Service Member:

- Section A: Service Member Information – 10 items
- Section B: Demographics – 14 items max (this is inclusive of skip logic/check boxes)
- Section C: Projected Discharge Type – four items with skip logic
- Section D: Personal Goal Intentions – three items
- Section E: Multiple Life Domains – 42 items max; 35 min - RC skip logic
 - Social & Relational – three items
 - Sense of Belonging – four items
 - Employment – six items (* RC-4)
 - Housing – seven items (* RC-3)
 - Hope (Purpose/Goals) – four items
 - Financial – eight items (* RC- 7)
 - Resilience – three items
 - Physical Health (Awareness) – four items
 - Mental Health (Awareness) – three items

* RC (Reserve Component) skips logic accounts for sub-section items, which may not be appropriate or relevant for RC members

EISA Score at IIC (Tier Score)– The EISA Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC) score serves as the tier score, establishing baseline data to identify the transition-related needs of Service Members. This score is instrumental in determining the tier level associated with the Career Readiness Standards (CRS) and may also influence the

potential waiver of a two-day track. The summated score from the EISA directly determines the tier score, which is automatically calculated once the Service Member completes the EISA assessment. The tier factors evaluate the extent of potential challenges the Service Member may encounter during their military-to-civilian transition, including major readjustment, healthcare, and employment issues. Consequently, a higher EISA tier score indicates a greater level of preparedness for this transition. This score considers the overall EISA rating, along with demographic information and various life domains. The enterprise-wide tier score will be validated through the results of the EISA.

Score Key -
Tier 1: 121 - 180
Tier 2: 61 - 120
Tier 3: 0 - 60



The higher the EISA Tier score rating, the more prepared the member is for their military-to-civilian transition.

Final tier assignments are based on both the recommendations from the Initial Assessment and the Transition Counselor's evaluation of the Client's readiness to transition. TAP Counselors have the authority to adjust a Service Member's tier level on the EISA platform during their Individual Initial Counseling (IIC) session if they determine that the Service Member did not provide honest responses on the EISA. In such cases, the TAP Counselor will be required to include justification and comments in the Client's TAP record if the EISA tier recommendation is not applied.

During the IIC, the counselor will aid the Service Member in identifying transition goals and developing an effective plan to achieve those goals. Additionally, the Service Member and counselor will select which two-day track(s) the Service Member will participate in, based on the initial assessment and identified transition goals. The selected track will be documented in the Client's TAP record during the IIC.

The Client is provided with information regarding their tier and the CRS requirements (such as Gap Analysis, ITP, Spending Plan, etc.). They are referred to the installation ETS or Retirement Briefing and directed to the Reserve Component Career Counselor (RCCC) for Continuum of Military Service (CMSC), if applicable. Additionally, the Client is scheduled for follow-on services, including Pre-Separation Counseling and other core requirements. The Service Member receives a schedule for all events during their transition period, which lasts either 18 or 24 months. Should a Service Member choose not to schedule these appointments at the IIC, this decision must be documented in the TAP SOR section to indicate that the option was presented. If the Service Member prefers to complete their transition through Transition Online Learning (TOL) instead of scheduling appointments, this preference, along with the reason, should also be documented in the TAP SOR notes.

The ITP is developed and explained, outlining the various career track options and the

minimum completion requirements. Following this, a follow-up email is sent to Clients from a government email address (either personal or group.mil) containing the TAP Resource Guide, ITP, instructions for the Gap Analysis and its worksheets, instructions for financial worksheets, and course resource pages. Clients will receive only one hard copy of the TAP Resource Guide, which may be distributed at MY Transition. In the event of loss, Clients can refer to their digital copy.

Service Members are required to access their Joint Services Transcript (JST) during their Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC), or be provided the link and instructions on how to access it.

The IIC is documented in TAP SOR using the IIC note and the IIC attendance sections, with appropriate benchmarks applied. In cases where TAP SOR is unavailable, the Client Information Sheet must be completed. This sheet will then be temporarily stored in the TAP Center's ARIMS filing system until it can be entered into TAP SOR as a proxy registration. Data entry should be carried out as soon as possible—ideally on the day the IIC is conducted—but as soon as the SOR accessibility is restored. For more details, please refer to [Appendix 8](#) for the TAP Client Information Sheet.

Chapter 6: Pre-Separation Counseling

Completion of Pre-Separation Counseling is a mandatory requirement for the Career Readiness Standards (CRS) and offers eligible Active Component (AC) and Reserve Component (RC) Service Members vital information on services, benefits, and Transition Assistance Program (TAP) events related to their transition from Active Duty. The Pre-Separation Counseling consists of informational sessions covering benefits and entitlements, the completion of the DoDTAP Pre-Separation/Transition Counseling Needs Assessment phase (DD 2648 eForm), and the distribution of relevant PSC handouts, including Service Provider Information.

Service Members in the AC or RC who are separating after 180 days or more of continuous Title 10 Active-Duty service (excluding training status) must complete Pre-Separation Counseling NLT 365 days prior to their transition or retirement date. Additionally, those AC or RC Service Members referred for a Medical Evaluation Board (MEB) or Physical Evaluation Board (PEB), regardless of their length of service, are required to receive Pre-Separation Counseling as soon as they are referred to the Integrated Disability Evaluation System (IDES). For further details on Pre-Separation Counseling for Service Members within the IDES, as well as for prisoners and eligible or pre-deploying Service Members, please refer to AR 600-81.

In this manual, PSC will refer specifically to the presentation of information regarding benefits and entitlements that must be conveyed to Service Members transitioning off Active Duty. Pre-Separation Counseling can be conducted through two methods: in-person or via a virtual/telephonic format, the latter of which will be referred to as Automated Pre-Separation Counseling. The Transition Support Manager (TSM) and the Contractor Installation Manager (CIM) will collaborate to determine the timing and

frequency of Pre-Separation Counseling sessions.

In-Person Pre-Separation Counseling

Pre-Separation Counseling sessions are provided by the CIM or Transition Counselor to an individual or group.

After completing the Pre-Separation Counseling (PSC), the counselor will help the Service Member complete the Pre-Separation Assessment section of the DD Form 2648 (eForm). Once completed, both the Service Member and the CIM or Transition Counselor will sign the Pre-Separation portion of the form. If DoDTAP is not available, a blank hard copy of the DD Form 2648 (eForm) and the Client Information Sheet ([Appendix 8](#)) will be completed. The DD Form 2648 (eForm) and the Client Information Sheet will be temporarily stored in the TAP Center's Army Records Information Management System (ARIMS) until they are entered into the TAP SOR and DoDTAP eForm using the Disconnected Operations signature function. Data entry should be completed as soon as possible, ideally on the same day the Pre-Separation Counseling takes place, or when DoDTAP becomes accessible. After the manual forms have been entered into the automated systems (TAP SOR and eForm), they should be shredded immediately, and the digital reference in ARIMS should be deleted.

Pre-Separation Counseling Supplements

Regardless of the Pre-Separation Counseling method employed, the Service Provider Referral handout is consistently provided. This handout contains national referral information for service providers, while local referral details should be incorporated by the site. Clients receive referral information that is pertinent to the topics covered in the PSC. The referral document is exclusively given to Clients who complete the PSC, as it serves as the primary resource for service provider information. Counselors and CIMs must be knowledgeable about all service providers available on the installation and within the local community, as well as the specific services they offer.

It is worth noting that Automated PSCs may not always provide the most current information for the Client. Service members receive information about post-government (military) service employment restrictions, as determined by local JAG policy, along with a printout of their VMET and the PaYS handout. The PaYS handout may have already been given to the Client during the Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC).

Additionally, service members are provided with local American Job Center locations and points of contact, which can be found on the Department of Labor website at <http://www.veterans.gov>.

Chapter 7: TAP Courses and Service Member CRS Deliverables

All courses are scheduled in TAP SOR in alignment with the guidelines issued by the PMO. These guidelines may encompass event guidance documents, as well as training references. Any CRS initiated during live instruction or through TOL must be verified by a counselor to confirm completion before the related benchmark can be applied to the Client's TAP record. The PMO will supply the curriculum to the TAP Centers.

Army Transition Day

Upon completion of the Pre-Separation Counseling, the next step is guiding the Service Member to attend the mandatory Army Transition Day. This event includes three key courses: Managing Your (MY) Transition, MOC Crosswalk, and Financial Planning for Transition. The standardized curriculum for these courses is provided to the contractor, and instructors are required to adhere to the curriculum materials provided. During Army Transition Day, Transition Counselors present essential information, to include an overview of the transition process, the importance of mentorship, family considerations, and how to translate military experience and training into civilian opportunities. Financial Counselors will guide participants in developing a post-financial spending plan. Additionally, CIMs are expected to receive cross-training to lead all courses, except for Financial Planning for Transition, in the absence of a Transition or Education Counselor.

Individual Transition Plan

The Individual Transition Plan (ITP) serves as a step-by-step guide, derived from the Service Member's ITP. Service Members will be introduced to the ITP during the Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC) session. A hard copy of the ITP will be provided during this session and will be initiated at that time. Furthermore, the ITP will be emailed to the Client as part of the follow-up communication associated with the IIC, which is included in the Army Transition Assistance Program Guide.

Service Members are required to document their personal and professional transition goals and objectives within the ITP.

Completion of the ITP is classified as a Career Readiness Standard (CRS). At a minimum, Service Members must complete sections I-III of the ITP. If a Service Member determines that Education, Employment, Vocational, or Entrepreneurship aligns with their post-transition goals, they must also complete the corresponding section of the ITP. For those selecting the Education, Employment, or Vocational Tracks, additional CRS requirements, based on their tier and track selection, must be met. The Entrepreneurship Track does not have any additional CRS.

The ITP is a dynamic document that undergoes review, modification, and verification throughout the transition preparation process. Transition Counselors collaborate with

Service Members to identify their primary career pathway—be it Employment, Education, Vocational, or Entrepreneurship—during the IIC session, and this information is recorded in the Transition Assistance Program (TAP) record.

Service Members may adjust their post-transition goals at any point during the TAP process, so it is crucial for counselors to verify their individual track selections and update the TAP record as necessary.

Lastly, it is important to note that attendance at a course does not alone constitute the completion of a deliverable; all documents must undergo “eyes on” verification for completion.

Post Transition Spending Plan

A Post Transition Spending Plan comprises several key components: total household income, expenses, insurance, household debt, and assets. Service Members are encouraged to complete a Post Transition Financial Spending Plan prior to their Capstone. This Spend Plan is initiated as part of the Financial Planning for Transition during Army Transition Day. TAP Financial Counselors provide the necessary information and tools to help identify financial responsibilities, obligations, and objectives following the transition.

Service Members will have the opportunity to receive follow-up counseling and assistance from TAP Financial Counselors to help complete the required deliverable before the Capstone event. Service Members who are tiers two or three must complete a one-on-one appointment with a Certified Financial Counselor to review their Spend Plan – tier 1 Service Members are not subject to this mandate

Once a post-transition Financial Spending Plan has been completed and verified, the CRS requirement is validated by a Certified Financial Counselor and benchmarked in the TAP SOR.

Gap Analysis

TAP Transition Counselors guide Service Members in evaluating their military experience, education, and training. They assist in identifying civilian career options that correspond to this background and help document the discrepancies between their career aspirations and the qualifications needed for their desired roles. This process can be effectively presented using a Gap Analysis worksheet. TAP Transition Counselors instruct Service Members on how to examine their military experience, education, and training, identify civilian occupations that align with their experience, and document the gap between what they want to do as a civilian with what is required for their desired occupation. This process is annotated on a Gap Analysis worksheet.

The Gap Analysis is initiated as part of the MOC Crosswalk during Army Transition Day. Service Members are encouraged to continue refining their Gap Analysis prior to

Capstone. Completing the Gap Analysis helps identify the requirements and eligibility for certification, licensure, and certificates in the desired career field. Once the analysis is completed and verified, it is recorded in the TAP Client record as a benchmarked CRS requirement. It should be noted that Verification of Employment may serve as a substitute for the completed Gap Analysis requirement, and this should be documented in the TAP SOR accordingly.

Service Members should be provided with the opportunity to receive military crosswalk training and subsequent counseling prior to their scheduled DoL One Day.

DoL One Day - Department of Labor Employment Fundamentals for Career Transition (EFCT)

A collaborative initiative between the Department of Labor (DoL) and the Department of Defense (DoD) ensures that Congressionally mandated employment assistance training is accessible on military installations both within the United States and Outside the Continental or Contiguous United States (OCONUS). The DoL oversees and funds this initiative through their DoL One Day program. Service Members are required to attend the DoL One Day no later than nine months following their transition date, unless they qualify for an exemption, as outlined in [Figure 8](#). If a service member is eligible for an exemption from the DoL One Day, a waiver benchmark will be applied to their TAP record after verification.

Those service members participating in a Career Skills Program do not qualify for a DoL One Day exemption unless they meet one of the criteria specified in [Figure 8](#).

Transitioning Service Members can exempt themselves from the DoL One Day by providing proof of their exemption criteria to their Transition Counselor. While this can be done at any stage of the TAP process, it is recommended to address it early on.

Wounded, injured, or ill service members enrolled in the Integrated Disability Evaluation System (IDES) may partake in a modified DoL One Day if such an option is available at their Service Member and Family Assistance Center (SFAC).

Figure 8: DoL One Day Exemption Criteria

5–19. Department of Labor One Day Exemptions

- The DoL One Day is the only CRS event from which a Service Member can possibly be exempt. The reasons eligible Service Members can be exempt from the DoL One Day portion of the TAP curriculum are:
 - Eligible Service Members retiring after 20 or more years of qualifying military service.
 - Eligible Service Members who, after serving their first 180 continuous days or more on Active Duty, meet at least one of the following criteria:
 - Are able to provide documented evidence of civilian employment.
 - Are able to provide documented acceptance into an accredited vocational training, undergraduate, or graduate degree program.
 - Have specialized skills which, due to unavoidable circumstances, are needed to support a unit scheduled to deploy within 60 days. Additionally, a make-up plan must accompany the postponement certification.
 - Eligible recovering Service Members who are separating, retiring, or being released from Active Duty who are enrolled in the education and employment initiative, or similar transition program designed to secure employment, higher education, or vocational training post-separation.
 - Service Members not medically capable of attending
- A TAP contractor staff member documents on the DD Form 2648 the decision of an eligible Service Member who qualifies for an exemption and elects not to participate in the DoL One Day.
- A TAP contractor staff member documents on the DD Form 2648 any approved exemptions and records them in TAP SOR.
- Eligible RC Service Members who have previously participated in the DoL One-Day may request an exemption.

*****Exemptions are voluntary. Service Members transitioning under the exempted categories may still elect to participate in the DoL One Day.*****

VA Benefits and Services

A representative from the VA will conduct a briefing on the application process and how to effectively utilize the various services and benefits offered by the VA to Service Members and their families.

Briefing attendance is required no later than six months from a Service Member's transition date. Pre-Separation Counseling introduces many topics that will be covered during VA Benefits and Services.

Registration on eBenefits

eBenefits registration is an essential step that takes place during the VA Benefits and Services course. Once completed, this requirement is documented in the Client's TAP SOR, pending verification by a Transition Counselor. Verification of the eBenefits registration may be conducted during subsequent counseling sessions or at the Capstone event.

Continuum of Military Services

The Continuum of Military Services briefing (CMS) is a requirement for Active Component (AC) Service Members as part of the Transition Assistance Program (TAP). This counseling provides AC members, including those who are involuntarily separating, valuable information about the benefits of transitioning to the Reserve Component (RC). It is important to note that all Retirees are exempt from this requirement.

The CMSC is not facilitated by TAP contractor staff, although they are permitted to record a Service Member's completion of this requirement in the TAP SOR. Typically, a Reserve Component Career Counselor (RCCC) delivers the CMS brief. The RCCC is authorized to input this data into TAP SOR on behalf of Service Members. The CMS may occur at various points during the TAP process and should be completed prior to the Capstone event.

If the RCCC does not record attendance for the CMS, the TAP Counselor is able to apply attendance to the TAP SOR Client record if one of the following conditions are met:

- If your local RCCC provides a list of Service Members who have received the Reserve Component Career Counselor CMS brief at the installation location, annotate attendance based on the roster
- If your location provides a Continuum of Military Service Briefing and you have received approval from a Training Support Manager (TSM) that this briefing fulfills the CMS requirement, record attendance and includes a note in the Client's record indicating that the Client attended this briefing offered by the local RCCC, as verified by the participant roster
- If a Service Member presents a signed Department of Army Request for Reserve Component Assignment Orders (DA Form 5961-R), document a CMS benchmark and annotate the provided form accordingly
- In cases where a Service Member is retiring or has a disability and presents orders to that effect, record their attendance for CMS. In your notes, specify that the Service Member has provided orders indicating retirement or separation on either the Permanent Disability Retired List (PDRL) or Temporary Disability Retired List (TDRL), thereby fulfilling the CMS requirement as mandated by the Army

- When Clients out-process, the installation Clearance Record (DA Form 1372) indicates whether the Service Member has satisfied the Reserve Component Career Counseling obligation. If this block is marked as met, then document that a CMSC event has occurred and make the appropriate notation

Service Member orders and DA Forms will not be retained, scanned, or filed. Rosters are destroyed in an appropriate manner (burned, shredded, etc.) once corresponding attendance is entered in TAP SOR Client records.

Transition Counselors mark the DD 2648 eForm entry for CMS as “N/A” for RC Service Members. For AC Service Members, Transition Counselors mark the DD 2648 eForm entry for CMS as “Yes” if the requirement has been met and a CMS applicable appointment/benchmark exists in the Client’s TAP SOR Client, or “No” if the requirement has not been met. If “No” is marked for an AC Service Member, the Transition Counselor will refer the Service Member to the local RCCC to meet the requirement and perform the necessary procedures.

Career Tracks and Workshops

Eligible Service Members can participate in TAP career track workshops. Participation in individual career tracks is determined by the Service Member’s tier and Individual Transition Plan (ITP).

Service Members may attend one or more of the following two-day TAP transition career track workshops, depending on resource availability and operational requirements: 1) Education, 2) Employment, 3) Vocational, and 4) Entrepreneurship.

Track-specific additional CRS:

- **Employment:** a completed resume or verification of employment
- **Education:** a completed comparison of higher education options
- **Vocational:** a completed comparison of training institution options

TAP Education Counselors lead the Education Track, designed for Service Members seeking higher education. This track offers guidance on the application and admission processes. Client appointments are arranged, and attendance is recorded based on a course roster of participation. TAP contractors are responsible for entering related attendance and benchmarks into TAP SOR.

The Employment Track is facilitated by Department of Labor contractors, providing Service Members with comprehensive knowledge of the topics covered during the DoL One Day session. TAP contractor staff are tasked with scheduling Clients for this track. Upon completion of the track, the contract staff will use the attendance roster from the course to apply attendance and applicable benchmark into the TAP SOR

Additionally, the Vocational Track is instructed by Department of Labor contractors. This track supports Service Members pursuing vocational training by offering guidance in

selecting appropriate schools and transition fields. As with the other tracks, Client appointments are scheduled, and TAP contract staff record attendance in the TAP SOR based on the course participation roster..

Representatives from the Small Business Administration (SBA), along with their volunteers and contractors, lead the Entrepreneurship Track. Service members interested in self-employment receive valuable insights into the benefits and challenges of entrepreneurship, as well as the necessary steps to achieve business ownership. Client appointments are scheduled, and attendance is documented from a course participation roster. The TAP contractor staff is responsible for recording this information in the TAP SOR.

Chapter 8: Employment Assistance Counseling

Employment assistance counseling is offered following participation in core curriculum classes. Service Members opting to attend the Employment Track are required to complete a draft resume prior to their Capstone. TAP contractor staff are tasked with entering the attendance and benchmarks into TAP SOR. Additionally, they should engage in interview preparation, conduct a self-assessment, and research potential careers and job opportunities. Contractor Installation Managers (CIMs) and Transition Counselors are available to provide further information, support, and coaching upon request.

Walk-in services, resource counseling, and scheduled follow-up employment assistance counseling may encompass evaluating skills and experiences, exploring various occupations, setting job search objectives, critiquing and revising resumes, developing personal and professional references, identifying and utilizing job search resources, conducting practice interviews, critiquing actual job interviews, preparing for hiring events, and negotiating job offers. The format of the counseling greatly influences the duration and depth of information discussed during the sessions. All sessions will be recorded on Client's TAP SOR.

To enhance Client satisfaction and motivation, and to promote additional services, it is essential for Clients to engage with a Transition Counselor before their departure from the Center. The Transition Counselor should assess the Client's achievements and discuss the next logical steps—for instance, if the Client has completed a resume, the Transition Counselor will review it and provide constructive feedback (see Appendix 11). The Counselor may also revisit the Individual Transition Plan (ITP) with the Client, making any necessary updates to reflect their progression.

It is important for the Transition Counselor (or CIM) to attach a copy of the Resume Rubric to each reviewed resume, along with the counselor's feedback in accordance with the Resume Rubric guidelines. These reviewed resumes will be stored in the TAP Office for a duration of one month.

If the Client has not scheduled another appointment, the Transition Counselor should utilize insights gained during the wrap-up session to encourage further engagement, motivating the Client to fulfill any remaining Career Readiness Standards (CRS) requirements, make additional appointments, and generate an appointment slip. Upon completion of Capstone, the Client will complete their TAP Exit Questionnaire within the Service Member Portal.

For comprehensive information on employment assistance and the job search processes, please refer to AR 600-81. Federal job application training is also accessible through Transition Online Courses (TOL).

Value Added Classes

Additive classes include Advanced Resume, Guide to Federal Employment, Dress for Success, Skills Development, Interviewing Techniques, and Salary Negotiations.

- These classes aim to enhance a Service Member's employment skills, which are introduced in standardized courses (e.g., DoL One Day). The objective is to offer these additive classes prior to or in conjunction with employment assistance events (such as employer days and hiring events)
 - The Guide to Federal Employment and Advanced Resume should be made available prior to employer days or hiring events to ensure that Clients are well-prepared. These resources are essential for Clients to effectively prepare for such occasions. It is mandatory to offer these courses on a monthly basis, with adjustments made according to the event schedule
 - Interview Techniques, Salary Negotiations, and Dress for Success are offered before an employer day, hiring event etc. to ensure the Client has a clear understanding of what they learned in DoL One Day
 - Skills Development should be held as a class or conducted during individual one-on-one training (site dependent)

All the classes mentioned have a standardized curriculum along with handouts available in the contractor's reference library or shared drive. It is essential for all Contract staff, including CIMs, Transition Counselors, and Financial Counselors, to utilize the provided curriculum contained within the scripts and be fully prepared to conduct the classes effectively.

Hiring Events, Employer Days, and other Employment Assistance Events

TAP contractors can support the TSM or other government representatives in organizing employment events, including Hiring Events, Career Fairs, National Transition Summits, Job Fairs, and Employer Days. Each TAP location is permitted to assist with a maximum of one Employer Day and one Hiring Event per quarter.

Acceptable efforts include social media announcements, updates to Google Calendar, distribution of flyers during TAP courses, and aiding the TSM in submitting articles to the PAO. However, due to the limited role of assisting with these events, leading or spearheading hiring events and Employer Day events cannot be supported.

Furthermore, participant and employer data may be collected during the TAP events and updated on the Common Operating Picture (COP) by the TAP contractors, pending approval from the Transition Support Manager (TSM) and/or other designated action officers specified in the Operation Order (OPORD) related to the Employment Events. Within five business days following the supported events, the Contractor is required to provide an analysis of the captured data, offering the DGR insights on the number of employers, participants, individuals interviewed, those given firm job offers, and those ultimately hired. The Contractor shall also assist with the setup and break down of booths/tables.

Support for the administration, execution, and implementation of connection events beyond one hiring event and one employer day each quarter will be limited to the following:

- Collaborative marketing efforts with stakeholders in the form of social media announcements
- Set-up and tear down a TAP booth at approved events in the local area
- Assist the TSM and other government representatives in event attendee and employee questionnaire collection
- Assist in uploading data to Knowledge Management Portal (IMCOM's COP) to update the TAP website events calendar (Google Calendar) by the TAP IMCOM LNO
- Assist the TSM and other government staff with inputting the event After Action Review (AAR) in the IMCOM COP accordingly
- Ensure Soldiers are prepared for scheduled hiring events, job fairs, etc.
- Preparation includes a resume, Dress for Success advice as well as interview and salary negotiation techniques
- Contractor shall support the Soldier with development of a targeted resume or application package
- On-site assistance shall include walk-in participants who are not adequately prepared for the event (e.g., not having a resume); the contractor shall be prepared to provide a condensed version of services that would be provided at the Brick-and-Mortar transition center

The LNO assists with hiring events and Employer Days at Centers that have them. However, at locations without an LNO, if employment assistance or connection events require more than eight hours per month, then the CIM must report it to the RM.

Chapter 9: Capstone Counseling with the review of the Post Assessment and Installation Clearance

Capstone:

Capstone is conducted in two stages and must be completed no later than 90 days prior to transition. It serves as an opportunity for Service Members to confirm the achievement of Career Readiness Standards (CRS) as assessed by the Commander or designated representative.

During the Capstone, the Transition Counselor records the Capstone date for the CRS completed and logs any TAP course completions using the actual completion dates as noted on the TAP SOR.

The EISA Score at Capstone is the post-test score that validates whether Service Members' transition-related needs were adequately addressed during their TAP process. If any potential transition-related challenges were not resolved during the TAP process, appropriate resources or referrals, and/or a Warm Handover will be provided as necessary.

Service Members who receive a post-EISA Capstone Score of 2 or lower in a domain subsection will be given pre-populated resource and referral information related to that specific domain, as a score of 2 suggests that transition-related challenges may still exist.

Service Members with a post-EISA Capstone Score of 0 or 1 in a domain subsection qualify for a Warm Handover. The appropriate interagency partner for post-transition support as a score 1 or lower on a domain indicates transition-related challenges are still present.

The following outlines the appropriate Warm Handover partner in response to a 0 or 1 score on a multiple life domain subscale:

- Social and Relational – WHO ► Military OneSource ► Peer-support
- Sense of Belonging – WHO ► Military OneSource ► Peer-support
- Employment – WHO ► DoL
- Housing – WHO ► VA
- Physical Health – WHO ► VA
- Mental Health – WHO ► VA
- Hope – WHO ► DoL
- Financial – WHO ► DoL
- Resilience – WHO ► Military OneSource ► Peer-support

The information regarding the receiving partner will be detailed on the Service Member's DD Form 2648 (eForm) by the TAP contractor staff during the Capstone stage, in accordance with current TAP guidelines.

TAP contractor staff are not restricted to the listed WHO partner agencies (such as DoL, VA, and Military OneSource). If a connection is made with a local agency, the TAP contractor staff should categorize this under "Other" for the Warm Handover agency type, and in the comments section of the eForm 2648, specify the local agency that the Service Member was referred to for post-transition support services.

The following outlines three of the nine domains in which appropriate service-specific retraining and TAP support are essential before the Client's separation, retirement, or release from Active Duty, particularly in response to a score of 0 or 1 on multiple life domain sub-scales:

- Hope (i.e., post-transition goals) ► TAP retraining/support
- Financial ► TAP retraining/support
- Resilience ► TAP retraining/support

A Warm Handover with external agencies is conducted if the Client does not meet the CRS criteria, does not have a viable Individual Transition Plan (ITP), lacks post-service housing or transportation plans, has inadequate peer support, or requires additional assistance. Warm Handovers are intended to be in-person meetings with representatives from the DoL, VA, Military OneSource, or other relevant agencies. During these interactions, Points of Contact (POCs) at the post-transition location are identified. If an in-person Warm Handover cannot be conducted, alternatives such as an email, phone call, or provision of a contact number for the agency at the post-transition location can be utilized.

All Warm Handovers are documented during the Capstone on the DD 2648 (eForm) in the Capstone Review Phase. If time allows, staff should ensure that Clients have a final opportunity to complete the CRS (offering to schedule attendance at an event). Additionally, staff should make sure that Warm Handover details are comprehensively recorded on the DD 2648 (eForm) so that external agencies can adequately understand the Client's needs.

Once the information entered on the DD Form 2648 has been verified, both the Client and the Transition Counselor sign the form to confirm its accuracy.

TAP contractor staff must not select the "I am the Commander's Designee" option for the Commander/Designee signature on the eForm.

Commander's Verification

In stage two, the Commander or Designee assesses whether the Service Member has successfully completed a viable Individual Transition Plan (ITP) and has met the criteria for Career Readiness Standards (CRS). If the Commander or Designee determines that the Service Member is not compliant with CRS during the Commander's verification, they will initiate a Warm Handover to suitable interagency partners or local resources for post-transition support.

The Commander or Designee will receive an email token from stage one, which allows them to review and sign the Service Member's DD Form 2648 (eForm) during the Commander's Verification Phase. If the Commander or Designee does not sign the Service Member's eForm within 14 days of receiving the email token, the Service Member's record will turn red on the Transition Counselor's DoDTAP dashboard. The Transition Counselor will then notify the Contractor Installation Manager (CIM), who will subsequently inform the Transition Services Manager (TSM) regarding the Service Member, their Unit Identification Code (UIC), and the Commander or Designee.

A complete DD Form 2648 (eForm) must include the signature of the Commander or Designee, which also finalizes the Capstone process for the Service Member. The completed DD Form 2648 (eForm) can be printed either by TAP contractor staff or the Service Member through DoDTAP. Completed eForms may be shared with the Transition Counselor for purpose of clearing and generating the DD 214. For any inquiries regarding who should receive the completed DD Form 2648 for these purposes, please contact your government point of contact.

Installation Clearance

Installation clearance allows Service Members transitioning from Active Duty to demonstrate their completion of all regulatory requirements, including receiving all legally mandated TAP services. During the installation clearance process, staff assist Service Members and may endorse their clearing papers with a TAP stamp or signature. It is important to note that a lack of a Commander or Designee signature on the eForm does not hinder TAP contractor staff from clearing Service Members. Additionally, Service Members cannot complete their installation TAP office clearance by contacting the TAP Virtual Center, as the Virtual Center staff will direct them to their installation for final out-processing.

Chapter 10: TAP Resources

TAP Website (<https://www.armytap.army.mil/>)

The TAP website serves as an essential marketing resource for Clients and employers to gain a deeper understanding of TAP and the array of services it offers. It's secure

portal feature enables Clients to complete an automated Pre-Separation Counseling after undergoing an Individualized Initial Counseling, which includes a review of the Initial Assessment, and to schedule or cancel courses as needed. Additionally, the website facilitates registration for the TAP Virtual Center and software downloads. This resource is particularly beneficial for Clients who are unable to access TAP services at their installation, those stationed in azure environments, or those whose responsibilities hinder their participation in in-person TAP services. The Virtual Center provides 24/7 access to one-on-one counseling, workshops, seminars, and training classes. TAP Center staff should be well acquainted with the website, exploring its capabilities as both an informational resource and an outreach tool for remote and deployed service members, while promoting and encouraging its utilization.

Calendars

The TAP website offers two comprehensive calendars of events. One calendar details virtual training sessions and events through the TAP Virtual Center, while the other lists hiring events, employer days, and additional resources available at the local TAP Centers. It is essential to maintain and schedule these calendars for a minimum of 90 days.

Marketing Folder

Marketing folders are distributed to TAP Centers and automatically ordered every six months based on the number of Pre-Separation Counseling sessions conducted during the previous fiscal year, as recorded in the TAP SOR and verified before shipment. There is no order form for the folders; therefore, Centers can expect automatic shipments semiannually. The TAP Marketing folders should only be provided to transitioning Service Members during Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC). Centers should refrain from distributing folders at any other events to avoid depleting their supply before the next shipment. If the content (ITP, UCX, JST, VMET, CSP flyer, PaYS flyer, and Tier sheet) cannot be distributed due to constraints such as a lack of funds for toner or paper, the IIC follow-up email will include digital copies of the materials that were originally intended for inclusion in their folders.

Career Skills Program Flyer

The Career Skills Program (CSP) flyer is an essential document that must be included in the Marketing folder. All Centers are required to distribute this flyer to raise awareness about the CSP and Transition Administrative Absence opportunities.

TAP Commander's Fact Sheet

This one-sheet marketing document was developed as a quick reference guide for Army leaders. It is found inside the contractor's reference library/shared drive and IMCOM SharePoint. It must be printed at the Center and the top block should be

customized with Center information. [Appendix 4](#) displays the Fact Sheet.

Social Media

Various social media platforms, such as Facebook and LinkedIn, allow users to connect instantaneously within a global network, enhancing the transfer of information significantly. When utilized effectively, these platforms serve as powerful tools for public relations, especially when reaching out to a broad audience. The Army Transition Division Headquarters manages the HQ Facebook page and holds moderator rights for all TAP Center Facebook pages. Additionally, the Transition Division oversees an international LinkedIn profile and a YouTube account. These platforms are rarely available at installations due to time constraints. If your Center manages multiple social media accounts, contractor staff assist the Transition Support Manager (TSM) in maintaining these accounts according to Army Social Media guidelines, which recommend posting on LinkedIn at least once a day and on Facebook at least three times a week.

All social media accounts must be registered with the U.S. Army Social Media Directory, as required by Army Social Media policies and the installation Public Affairs Office (PAO). Furthermore, all personnel, including contractors, who publish information on external online platforms must receive appropriate training. This mandatory annual training includes Operation Security (OPSEC) training for External Official Presence Operators (EOP) and the DISA Social Networking class. For additional information on these classes, please refer to the U.S. Army Social Media website <https://www.army.mil/socialmedia/> and the TAP social media training slides found in the contractor's reference library/shared drive and IMCOM SharePoint.

Refer to [Social Media Policies | U.S. Army Social Media](#) for more details.

Soldier for Life

Soldier for Life (SFL) is based in Crystal City, Virginia, and focuses on fostering strategic partnerships with employers and businesses that seek to hire Veterans.

The Soldier for Life initiative embodies the idea of being a “Soldier for Life.” The AR 600-81 outlines comprehensive information on objectives, outreach efforts, networking, and connection activities. It is important to distinguish Soldier for Life from the Transition Assistance Program, as they are two distinct programs.

Chapter 11: Administration

Center Hours

The operating hours of the Transition Assistance Program (TAP) Center are dictated by the contractor's obligations, which encompass minimum weekly office hours, maximum available counselor hours, and the installation's needs as determined by the Command through the Transition Support Manager (TSM). Typically, the published hours for the TAP Center amount to at least 40 hours per week, with core hours set from 0900 to 1500 local time. Observed holidays are listed separately in this section. To ensure Clients have ample access, TAP Center hours should align with those of other service providers, including the Military Personnel Office, Civilian Personnel Advisory Center, and Army Community Service.

Operating hours may differ from standard installation duty hours, and no TAP Center staff member is scheduled to work more than 40 hours, irrespective of the number of hours the TAP Center provides services. This stipulation is particularly crucial for Service Contract Act (SCA) employees, for whom any overtime must receive prior approval from Regional Manager (RM).

The TSM, as the primary authority for TAP-related matters at the installation, collaborates with the CIM and the TAP Center contractor supervisor to establish the weekly operating schedule. Any scheduling conflicts will be referred by the CIM to the RM for resolution. When determining office hours, the TSM and CIM should prioritize the needs of the service population, ensuring that hours align with when Clients are most likely to utilize the TAP Center. Additionally, they must consider activities such as Individualized Initial Counseling, installation requirements, other demands on counselor hours, and security considerations.

There may be special circumstances that necessitate temporary adjustments to the operating hours of the TAP Center. Factors such as personnel actions (e.g., significant reductions in the installation's civilian workforce) or operational issues (e.g., deployments or an increase in activity ahead of a hiring event) may require an expanded service schedule on a temporary basis.

The implementation of Additional Individualized Initial Counseling and workshops will create a heightened demand for counselor availability. If the Center needs to extend office hours beyond the standard 40-hour work week, the TSM should reach out to the CIM to arrange the new schedule. The CIM will assess the additional hours required for Counselors or Administrative Specialists to accommodate these extended hours.

Prior to implementing any schedule changes, the CIM must reach out to the RM to obtain authorization for SCA/Hourly employee overtime and/or adjusted schedule. The contract stipulates the necessity of maintaining adequate staffing at the TAP Center

during all scheduled office hours. As a guideline, it is recommended that a minimum of two staff members be present during these hours. For satellite sites with only one staff member, the CIM at the parent site must ensure that each satellite location is adequately supported and capable of delivering all required Client services in a timely manner. It is important to note that staff engaged in training, attending meetings, or participating in marketing activities are on duty, even if they are not physically present in the TAP Center.

The TSM or CIM is prohibited from closing a TAP Center or satellite office without prior approval from the TAP Program Management Office at Fort Knox, except in cases of emergency and/or Garrison closures. Occasionally, adverse weather or road conditions necessitate the closure of the installation to all personnel except those considered essential. In such situations, the TSM must secure confirmation from the COR at HRC before proceeding with any closure, and the CIM is responsible for notifying the contractor RM. It is important to note that TAP contractor staff are not categorized as essential personnel and, as such, will not report to work during these events. In anticipation of inclement weather that may result in base closures, the TSM must ensure that the CIM is informed when access to the installation is restricted, and the CIM is tasked with assigning projects for employees to complete from home.

Telework/Work From Home/Remote: Circumstances may arise in which site operations must revert to all staff telework from home or other approved location. When that site is identified to be closed, CIM is to ensure signs stating date(s) of Office Closure is posted on all site doors as well as social media sites. These circumstances include, but are not limited to:

- Inclement weather
- Site specific closures:
 - Building closure
 - Repairs that cannot be conducted after site hours
 - Plumbing
 - HVAC
 - Extermination
- Presidential Executive Orders
- TSM specified days on a memo
 - DONSA days

In all telework/work from home circumstances, staff is to conduct scheduled TAP services to Clients utilizing either telephonic or virtual means. Clients should be given the option to reschedule if in-person classes are desired. Email notifications should be sent to Clients and notes entered in the system of record (SOR). If staff choose, they may submit a leave request for either PTO, sick leave, or utilize Leave Without Pay (LWOP).

In the event of a national crisis, or other unforeseen circumstances involving occupational health and safety concerns that would impact

the Contractor's ability to perform the services at the authorized locations listed herein, the government (DGR) reserves the right to request contractors to telework on an as needed basis. In these cases, the Contractor is authorized to coordinate with the local DGR on shifting to a telework status with email notification to the COR. Request for individual/ad hoc telework, the contractor shall submit a request in writing to the COR for concurrence. If the COR does not concur the initial request, it will be routed to the KO for a final decision. The request shall identify who (contractor employee), performance location assigned, purpose (reason for the request), duration and how the contractor will ensure performance during the time identified.

Each Center is required to maintain an updated emergency telephone list for use in the event of an unexpected installation closure due to threats, weather, or other circumstances. The CIM is responsible for establishing a notification process and ensuring that all staff assigned to make calls are aware that they must reach out to their designated team members as soon as they receive notification themselves.

A semi-annual test of the internal notification processes will be conducted, with at least four months between tests, and the results must be reported to the respective installation RM/DGR and COR. During safety drills at installations, the local Contractor Installation Manager (CIM) will account for staff and provide a report to the RM/DGR.

Workplace Safety

Although TAP Center managers may not have the ability to control external threats, they can take proactive measures to reduce their impact on staff. It is essential for managers to receive timely information regarding the nature of the threat to ensure that the appropriate actions can be initiated. Managers, supervisors, and team leads at all customer and company work locations, along with their superiors, are instructed to take the following actions:

- Immediately report (in an emergency act first, then report) to their management chain any threat that may:
 - Endanger the health and safety of staff or the Clients we serve
 - Damage facilities or equipment
 - Interrupt business operations
- For those individuals in government facilities, report threats of violence and terrorism to the government POC and comply with published security guidance
- Reports must be passed up the chain quickly. Information must be complete regarding:
 - Nature of the threat—its potential consequences and timing
 - Location of threat (address including building number, floor, etc.)

- Actions taken (e.g., closing office, notifying employees, notifying government, moving equipment, etc.)
- Current status
- POC name and contact information
- All situations of this type will be immediately reported to their RM, PM, DPM, and government POC.

Observed Holidays

US Holidays: Work should not be performed on U.S. holidays occurring during the normal work week. Host Nation Holidays: Work should be performed on local host nation holidays occurring during the normal work week unless stated otherwise in the respective SOFA. *Local host nation holidays occur in the region/state where contract performance takes place.*

U.S. Holidays:

New Year's Day: 01 January
 Martin Luther King (MLK): 3rd Monday in January
 Presidents Day: 3rd Monday in February
 Memorial Day: Last Monday in May
 Juneteenth: 19 June
 Independence Day: 04 July
 Labor Day: 1st Monday in September
 Columbus Day: 2nd Monday in October
 Veterans' Day: 11 November
 Thanksgiving Day: 4th Thursday in November
 Christmas Day: 25 December

German National and Local Holidays:

New Year's Day: 01 January
 Three King's Day (Only in Baden Wurttemberg and Bavaria): 06 January
 Good Friday: Varies yearly
 Easter Monday: Varies yearly
 Labor Day: 01 May
 Ascension Day: Varies yearly
 Whit Monday: Varies yearly
 Corpus Christi (Only in Baden-Wurttemberg, Bavaria, Hessen, Nordrhein-Westphalia, Rhineland-Palatinate and Saarland): Varies yearly
 Assumption Day (Only in Saarland and Bavaria): 15 August
 Day of German Unity: 03 October
 All Saints' Day (Only in Baden-Wuerttemberg, Bavaria, North Rhine-Westphalia, Rhineland-Palatinate and Saarland): 01 November
 1st Christmas: 25 December
 St. Stephen's Day: 26 December

Italian Holidays:

New Year's Day (Capodanno) 01 January

Epiphany (Epifania): 06 January

Easter Monday (Lunedì dell'Angelo, Pasquetta): Monday after Easter

Liberation Day (Festa Della Liberazione): 25 April

International Workers' Day (Festa del Lavoro or Festa dei Lavoratori): 01 May Republic Day (Festa Della Repubblica): 02 June

Ferragosto/Assumption Day (Ferragosto and Assunta): 15 August

All Saints' Day (Tutti i santi or Ognissanti): 01 November

Immaculate Conception (Immacolata Concezione or just Immacolata): 08 December

Christmas Day (Natale): 25 December

St. Stephen's Day (Santo Stefano): 26 December

Republic of Korea (ROK) Holiday:

New Year's Day (Sinjeong): 01 January

Korean New Year's Day (Seollal): 1st day of the Korean Lunar Calendar

Independence (Declaration) Day (Samiljeol): 01 March

Children's Day (Eorininal): 05 May

Buddha's Birthday (Seokgatansinil): 8th day of 4th Lunar Month

Memorial Day (Hyeonchung-il): 06 June

Constitution Day (Jeheonjeol): 17 July

Liberation Day (Gwangbokjeol): 15 August

Mid-autumn Festival (Chuseok): 15th day of 8th Lunar month

Armed Forces Day (Gukgunuinil): 01 October

National Foundation Day (Gaecheonjeol): 03 October

Hangul Day (Gidoktansinil): 25 December

Financial Management

The CIM is responsible for conducting TAP Center operations in a manner that maximizes resource effectiveness. Maintaining a petty cash fund at the site is not allowed, nor is any other local fund. No obligation that leads to expenses is to be undertaken or agreed to without the Regional Manager's approval.

Travel and Expense Report Management

The COR at HRC is the authority for approving all travel requests and travel expenses. The CIM ensures that staff adhere to travel and expense procedures. Travel authorization forms must be submitted and approved by an HRC COR two to three weeks prior to travel. All expense report forms must be submitted and approved by an HRC COR NLT five days upon returning from an approved Mission: before submitting to the contractor company for reimbursement. Beyond travel expenses, no obligation leading to expenses is to be undertaken or agreed to without RM, DPM, or PM approval.

Communication

The continuing requirement to provide TAP Centers with administrative updates, operation, and training guidance is met primarily through training, meetings, and via the contractor's reference library/shared drive. It is imperative that all staff participate in weekly discussions to promote staff awareness, especially when new information is released. Newly hired personnel are required to read all training documents to include memos, which can be found in SharePoint ARIMS, or the contractor's reference library/shared drive. All applicable memos have been merged into the SMM. An ARIMS compliant file is maintained in the Center. Other documents are read as they are received, acted on, or filed as applicable.

Media

TAP Center staff must fully comply with the installation policy on public affairs. All requests by the media for visits to the TAP Center, whether from public or Army sources, must be approved by the TSM and the installation Public Affairs Office, even when the interview is to take place away from the TAP Center. Accordingly, all such requests are forwarded directly to the TSM for appropriate action and/or disposition. TAP Centers are contractual extensions of the Transition Assistance Program. Therefore, the Army has a right and obligation to ensure that information given to the media reflects accurately on TAP and the Army. The Army also has the right to have a representative present during interviews and filming and to know, in general, what transpired during a visit by the media.

While cooperation with the media is beneficial to the TAP Center, Army, and Clients, TAP Clients' privacy and rights to access Center resources are important and are protected during visits by the media. The media is never allowed to observe scheduled counseling. However, Clients have the right to cooperate with the media and to release details of their personal job search. The TAP Center does not have the right to release such information without prior approval in writing.

The CIM should work closely with the TSM to arrange a date and time that minimizes the impact on Client services and privacy for any approved visit. The CIM must notify the RM as soon as possible after the visit is scheduled. Email notification or a telephone call is sufficient. If the visit is subsequently canceled or rescheduled, a notification is sent to the RM. The contractor's headquarters (HQ) will notify TAP HQ.

Immediately after the visit, the TSM notifies the IMCOM TAP Regional Leader responsible for the site. The CIM provides a concise report to the RM immediately after the visit. The report may be emailed and must include the following information: date of the visit, identity of the visitor, intended purpose of the visit, and observations.

Very Important Person(s) (VIP) Visit

TAP Center staff can expect to receive important visitors on a routine basis. Often VIP visitors view the TAP Center from a unique perspective. Their questions and comments serve to help the TAP Center Program Management Team tailor operational guidance. To ensure that information collected during VIP visits is passed to the Program Management Team, the CIM completes VIP visit information as part of their Monthly Status Report (MSR). A VIP is defined as follows: a General Officer; a civilian in a Senior Executive Service (SES) grade; a representative of Department of Army (DA), such as Army Human Resources Command (AHRC), Army Inspector General (IG), Army G1, etc., or Major Command (MACOM), such as Forces Command (FORSCOM), Army Futures Command (AFC), United States Army-Europe (USAREUR), a representative of Department of Defense (DoD); members of Congress or their staffs; and/or any other visitor the CIM deems to be reportable. If the CIM is in doubt about whether the person is a VIP, call the RM for guidance and to provide advance notification of a visit.

Copyrighted Materials

TAP Center staff must avoid inadvertently violating copyright laws. TAP contractor staff will not make and distribute copies of any part of a copyrighted book, periodical, or other protected document without written permission from the copyright holder. Verbal permission is not sufficient. The CIM must maintain a copy of permission granted by a copyright holder and provide a copy to their RM. Additionally, distributed copies must bear the annotation, "Distributed with permission of the Author" or other similar phrasing (e.g., "Distributed with permission of Ten-Speed Press").

Plagiarizing copyrighted materials by retyping portions of printed materials is not permitted. While drafting original handouts, it is expected that the CIM may base the handouts on the contents of a wide range of published documents; however, TAP handouts must be original documents based on the synthesis of other publications with proper citation. The use of a thought or datum is permitted when credit is given. If staff use portions of another author's work, they must cite the author and the publication in their documents. The unauthorized distribution of a discrete element of a copyrighted document (such as a checklist, chart, drawing, or diagram) is not allowed. In addition, the CIM will not allow staff to use copyrighted videotapes or movies when conducting TAP Center activities without the approval of the RM. These rules do not apply to government documents that are in the public domain. As a matter of policy, however, all distributed copies of public domain documents must clearly indicate the source.

TAP Client Success Stories and Bulletin Boards

TAP Centers must maintain and update, on a weekly basis, TAP Bulletin Board, organization Knowledge Management (e.g. SharePoint) websites and other virtual environment platforms (e.g. Facebook, LinkedIn), in coordination with the DGR, utilize recent articles from industry magazines and trade associations. Post Success Stories of active or former TAP Clients who transition from the Center.

Also, TAP Centers are responsible for proactively collecting success stories from transitioning Service Members who find career, entrepreneurship, educational, and Transition opportunities post-transition. Statistical data yields facts, such as:

- 16% of respondents found their first civilian job before leaving the service and 14% of respondents found their first civilian job in less than a month
- Respondents who started their job search at least six months prior to leaving military service were twice as likely (25% vs. 12%) to have a job before leaving Active Duty compared with those who started less than six months before transitioning (Veterans in the Workplace, Hiring Our Heroes U.S. Chamber of Commerce Foundation, November 2016 / respondents were 1000 Veterans who left Active Duty in the last five years)
- 48% of transitioning Service Members have either found employment and are not looking or have found employment but are continuing to look (FY19 TAP Exit Questionnaire Data)

TAP Centers should be collecting these stories as part of a social proof marketing strategy that shows the Program's efforts are working.

Success Stories are helpful because:

- They offer advice to current transitioning Service Members when published
- They make the Centers a thought-leader, which means TAP becomes the go-to expert for transition help and services; that can lead to more positive media interviews, Service Members thinking highly of starting the program, and more Commanders seeing the value of TAP
- They bring the human aspect to the program's marketing efforts by inspiring and encouraging transitioning Service Members during a new time in their life
- They make more companies want to connect with the Centers to hire Service Members because they see that TAP can effectively connect Service Members with jobs
- When sent to the STRATCOM Specialist, they can be used to promote TAP on a national/international level

Success stories must have extensive content in them to be beneficial to the Center. Staff should be proactive about asking Service Members to submit their story, specifying that the program intends to use it nationally/internationally, locally, on social media, and on other platforms to promote TAP and to help other Service Members learn advice from those who have gone through a Military transition. Proper phrasing for permission is outlined on the Success Stories form.

To encourage more Success Stories, staff should consider these proactive ideas for social proof that the program works.

- When a Service Member emails a Transition Counselor to thank them and mentions that they found a position, the Transition Counselor should email back and ask if they would be willing to expand upon their email for local and international sharing. The Transition Counselor should send them the Success Story Form ([Appendix 5](#)) and/or forward them to HRC Marketing so they can be interviewed for national opportunities.
- Each Center should advertise the bulletin board location of posted Success Stories. The idea is not to just display the success stories, but to encourage other Service Members to submit them as well. Instructions encourage Service Members to submit their own stories next to the ones displayed.
- Service Members, on their last day of class, should be sent the Success Story Form that tells them where they can send their narrative. This should include the government group email box at the location for email submissions.
- Counselors can announce that they are looking for success stories during classes and share where to send them.
- Success stories are featured in the monthly newsletters. Newsletters can encourage those reading to send in their own stories.
- The Centers can share success stories and quotes from them to companies on flyers, in hiring event outreach, and emails. This encourages companies to get involved with TAP and hire more Service Members. Staff can ask companies to submit their Veteran hires as success stories, especially if it was at a TAP sponsored event.
- The Center can work with the PAO to find Service Members to feature every month or so in the post paper.

With success stories, the goal is not to have a Service Member write one or two sentences on a small card or piece of paper. The goal is to receive a narrative that is in-depth and produces useable quotes for marketing and distribution efforts. As a result, the Success Story Form now includes general questions to guide Service Members through the types of information to include. The Success Story Form, used to submit a Success Story, located in [Appendix 5](#), incorporates all necessary information to allow use by the Army for marketing and press releases.

In addition to Success Stories, recent articles, and current job announcements gathered from sources such as USAJOBS.gov, industry magazines, trade associations, etc., should be displayed on the bulletin board. This information must be updated monthly at a minimum.

Reports

There are many reports to be submitted at various points. In general, monthly reports are due to the PMO POC. Please refer to the TAP Report Details document provided by the PMO.

In addition to the regularly scheduled reports, After Action Reports (AARs) are to be completed and submitted to the PM, DPM, and RM within 24 hours whenever contractor staff have attended and/or participated in a staff assistance visit, Quality Control Plan, audit, or out-brief of an event similar in nature to the events listed. The standard AAR template and file name convention (AAR_SITE_MMM_YYYY) must be used.

AARs are also for FTST. AAR FTST is completed by the CIM/TC/FinCO (FTST) due from the Team Leader of the Event to the CIM NLT 48 hours of attending; POC/CIM sends the AAR to the HQ LNO NLT three days after the event.

If Quarterly Installation Transition Council Meeting notes are taken at a location, these meeting notes must be sent each month to the designated POC no later than the fourth calendar day of each month using the standard file name convention (Event_Name_Installation_DD_MMM_YYYY).

TAP Center Office Files

All files maintained by the contractor for the government are filed, maintained, archived, and/or disposed of in accordance with AR 25-400-2, the Army Records Information Management System (ARIMS), OPORD 18-010, Installation guidance, and contractor new hire training. CIMs can expect these files to be checked during QCP Inspections. In questionable cases, contact the RM. ARIMS defines how long-term and permanent records are managed. ARIMS addresses only the record copy of information. This allows the business process to manage short-term records. Short-term records are those used to create the master web-based TAP database and can include the following:

- TAP SOR Reports
- DD Form 2648 is filed under DD Form 2648, in alphabetical order, until DD 2648 Form information is entered in DoDTAP. **Destroy forms** in such a way as to ensure Client data is secure (i.e., tear, shred or burn) IAW installation guidance
- Client Information Sheet – File with the DD 2648 (eForm) if applicable. Maintain the form with Client's DD Form 2648 before filing as indicated above. **Destroy form** at the same time and in the same way as the DD Form
- The Client comment file includes all written favorable and unfavorable comments made by Clients except for comments made through TAP questionnaire forms. Any record of a complaint investigation or other related documents are attached

to the original comment

- File copies of equipment inventories. Other documents that should be in this file include theft reports, hand receipts, etc.
- File documents pertaining to evaluations, including reports of QC visits, copies of Inspector General (IG)/investigations/inspections, memoranda regarding investigations by the TAP Center staff in response to critiques or other evaluation documents, etc.
- File all requests for facility maintenance or modification directed to the TSM and related responses
- File current marketing plan (submission from TSM is required yearly to TAP HQ) and other documents that pertain to marketing. Documents published by the TSM should also be included. Other documents that may be placed in this file include flyers, news articles, press releases, etc.
- File sample resumes generated at the local site that represent the most common occupational specialties and some of the more unique skill areas, with a variety of samples for the various Clients served (Service Members, Spouses, DA Civilians, etc.)
- File all documents pertaining to safety and security at the TAP Center. The CIM is to create procedures designed to ensure a safe and secure workplace. As a minimum, this file should contain procedures addressing fire prevention, evacuation, bomb threat, violent Clients, key control, and security. Requests for security and fire inspections as well as reports of such inspections are also filed here. Maintain current procedures indefinitely
- File all documents pertaining to supply requests. Maintain open requisitions and back orders in the current files
- File all site documents related to staff-training programs. The contents of this file should include the general plan used to train new employees, specific staff training plans or initiatives and training material masters, along with a current training roster of completed mandatory training and completion certificates. Documents pertaining to an employee's individual training achievements or training plan should be filed

Chapter 12: Security and Safety

Facility Security and Safety

All installations have programs designed to prevent fires, injuries, and losses associated with poor security. Problems that cannot be corrected immediately and easily by staff must be reported to the appropriate authority. The installation provost marshal, fire marshal, and safety officer conduct inspections and provide advice on how to correct identified problems. All contacts with these officials must be coordinated by the TSM.

Avoid situations where only one staff member is present at the site. This is especially true at night, in a location where there is little to no light throughout certain times of the

year, or when activity in the local area is expected to be light. It is also a concern for FTST counselors conducting services at remote locations. The Virtual Center is to always have a minimum of two people on site.

The TSM has overall responsibility for safety and security of the facility. The CIM is responsible for developing written procedures designed to maintain a safe and secure working environment for the contract staff and Clients. The CIM, at a minimum, completes emergency procedures and contact rosters for their location. Staff must be aware of these procedures and receive a copy. At a minimum, procedures should address TAP Center control during operating hours, security checks at the end of the duty day (Center and all areas where property is stored), equipment and supply security, key control and accountability, personnel who are mentally and/or physically challenged, fire evacuation procedures, bomb threats, and working with unruly Clients.

Key Control: Contractors shall comply with AR 190-51 Security of Unclassified Army Property.

All references to keys include key cards. The contractor establishes and implements methods of making sure all keys/key cards issued to the contractor by the government are not lost or misplaced. Unauthorized people cannot use keys and keys cannot be duplicated. The contractor develops procedures covering key control that are included in the Quality Control Plan (QCP). Such procedures include turn-in of any issued keys by personnel who no longer require access to locked areas. The contractor immediately reports any occurrences of lost or duplicate keys/key cards to the COR and the TSM. In the event a master key is lost or duplicated, all locks and keys should be replaced by the government. The contractor will be held financially responsible for the total cost. When the contractor key control procedures conflict with government key control procedures, the government procedures will prevail. The contractor's key and lock custodian must be physically located on the installation where the locks are located.

The contractor prohibits the use of government-issued keys/key cards by any persons other than the contractor's employees. The contractor prohibits the opening of locked areas by contractor employees to permit the entrance of persons other than contractor employees engaged in the performance of assigned work in those areas, or personnel authorized entrance by the KO.

Unauthorized: If it is found that contractors have been misusing keys to gain entrance to the work area during non-duty hours, holidays, or weekends and there is no written requirement for access during non-standard working hours, this will be considered an abuse of government property security. The contractor establishes and implements methods of ensuring all lock combinations are not revealed to unauthorized persons.

The contractor ensures lock combinations are changed when personnel having access to the combinations no longer require such access. The contractor prohibits the use of government issued keys by any person other than the issued employees.

Lost Keys: The contractor verbally reports any occurrence of lost keys to the COR, or the individual designated as responsible for the facility within 30 minutes of discovery of the loss. The contractor provides the RM/DGR/COR a written report by close of business the next day. The report contains the key number, location(s) accessed by the key, date the key was discovered missing, name of person signing for the key, and any other relevant details. In the event keys are lost or duplicated, the contractor should, upon discretion of the KO, be required to pay for the re-key or replace the affected lock(s). When the replacement of locks or re-keying is performed by the government, the contractor is held financially responsible for the total cost of re-keying or the replacement of the lock or locks.

Lock Combinations: The contractor establishes and implements methods of ensuring that all lock combinations are not revealed to unauthorized persons and coordinates with the TSM to assure installation compliance for lock combinations. The contractor ensures that lock combinations are changed when personnel having access to the combinations no longer have a need to know such combinations. These procedures should be included in the contractor's QCP.

Security Clearance

All TAP Center contractor staff must receive a favorable National Agency Check with Inquiries (NACI) at a minimum. Some positions may require a higher level of security clearance, especially for those handling government mail. TAP contractor staff must have their NACI before they receive their common access card (CAC). At most installations, network access is not allowed without CAC verification. The CIM and RM are responsible for ensuring that new employees expeditiously complete and submit a NACI application, that the NACI process is initiated, and it is completed for each staff member. The installation processes NACI requests, and the TSM or physical security manager assists in obtaining a NACI. Fingerprinting is part of the NACI application process and can be accomplished on the installation. For those cases in which the installation does not fingerprint applicants, the cost may be reimbursable.

Network Enterprise Center (NEC)

The NEC is responsible for operating and securing the installation network, as well as all servers and personal computers connected to the network. The NEC provides customer service for network related problems and has the authority to remove systems, users, and hardware from the network. TAP SOR is designed to connect to the installation network. The network provides all users the ability to interface with TAP SOR and the Internet. At any time, the NEC can decide that the TAP SOR application or PCs represent a threat to installation network security or stability. In these cases, the NEC may request additional information or direct corrective action. Failure to respond in a timely manner may result in the TAP SOR application being removed from the network, which would halt the use of TAP SOR equipment and software, thus requiring a shift to very limited manual services.

The TSM is responsible for all official coordination with the NEC, as well as facilitating contact between the contractor's TAP personnel and the NEC. The CIM must respond to NEC questions and requests for information, informing the TSM when direct contact by the NEC is made (except for routine maintenance matters).

Information Security

TAP Centers are Army activities that must comply with the Army's Information Security Policies. Since TAP Centers utilize the installation network and are custodians of sensitive information supplied by Clients, there is a continuous need to ensure that TAP Center operations are conducted in a manner that does not threaten automated installation resources and protect sensitive Client information.

To ensure the data, system, and network security, staff will not give their user accounts to another person or log on to a system/network and allow another individual to use. Staff may log on to their terminals to review Client records with Quality Control Plan (QCP) and QCP inspectors. Client terminals may be logged on and used by Clients, however, not by visitors being given a tour of the TAP Center. Government and/or QCP inspectors must be logged on by a staff member to review email or compose reports. The staff member must monitor their workstation use.

All TAP Center staff and Client workstations are for official use only. The Department of Defense Joint Ethics Regulations now allow users limited use of DoD telephones, email systems, and internet connections for personal use, so long as such users are on a not-to-interfere basis or for an improper purpose (e.g., conducting private business, viewing inappropriate or prohibited websites, etc.) that raises legal concerns. Except for this limited use, staff workstations are to be used only for official purposes. Clients are authorized to use TAP Client workstations solely to facilitate their transition. Clients are not allowed to browse sites or use the computer terminal for purposes unrelated to their transition.

Client Information

The TAP process requires Clients to provide personal information. Documents such as DD Forms 2648, electronic rosters, and TAP reports may contain PII. Clients often reveal details of their personal or professional lives expecting that their privacy will be protected. Therefore, TAP Center staff safeguard Client information by ensuring documents containing PII are secured or disposed of properly, and that Client disclosures shared during counseling exchanges remain confidential. TAP SOR Client record notes should not contain detailed personal information regarding medical, financial, legal history, or disclosures.

DD Forms, rosters, and TAP reports are official military documents that can be shredded or burned at installation facilities. Correspondence and emails should never include full names and Social Security Numbers (SSN). Client full SSNs names are never included in a Transition or functional ticket, always add DoDID number. Staff

submit functional and Transition tickets via the email link and format provided by the PMO IT LNO. The document outlining this process is available in the contractor's reference library/shared drive. The CIM should be kept informed of all tickets entered. Only the Client's last name and DoDID number are included with the email message encrypted and sent Center to Center. Printouts (rosters, copies of DD Forms, resume drafts, etc.) containing PII are maintained in a secure filing system or rendered unreadable by shredding or other effective method, as required by local installation policy. Resumes are never given to employers or non-TAP contractor staff, except with the expressed permission of the Client.

When using printed TAP SOR event sign-in sheets, the DoD ID is used in classrooms/other settings for signatures or where others can view it.

Chapter 13: Personnel

Selecting and Training Staff

Employee selection is driven by a variety of education, skill, and experience requirements set for each type of position that is pre-determined through the contractual agreement and must be met when considering an applicant for hire. Although not a requirement, familiarity with the Army, the civil service system, and the local employment community are additional, desirable qualifications. This does not suggest that preference should be given to current or former Service Members and DA civilian employees. The advantage the experience the Army environment conveys does not supersede the requirement that the staff have experience in outplacement or other closely related fields.

Only a fully qualified, well-trained, and motivated TAP contractor staff can provide the high-quality services Clients deserve. To ensure that there is no appreciable loss of services to Clients as the result of a staff member's departure, the CIM is required to train new contractor employees under their supervision at the local level. Through scheduled, automated, or written activities, the CIM is responsible for ensuring completion of internal training programs. These programs maintain quality, professional services, as well as ensure that new information, techniques, and policies are disseminated and fully understood.

When training new staff, the CIM is directed by existing training programs, policies, and guidance. Each new staff member follows a standardized and methodical training program. They must understand the entire program and the evaluation standards that are applied. Training materials reflect Army approved business rules and the current TAP SOR system design. They are intended for use with this manual. Specific references are provided to guide new staff during training. Training must be complete prior to the staff member being fully certified as a Contractor Installation Manager, Transition Counselor, Administrative Specialist, Financial Counselor, Education Counselor, Career Skills Program Counselor, or LNO.

New employees must demonstrate mastery over required skills and materials. Those

who cannot demonstrate mastery are counseled and provided additional training. In accordance with the contractor's employment policies, new staff who are unable to master all required materials and skills are considered for dismissal. The degree to which a new employee has mastered a skill or material is determined by the CIM, based on observation of performance and answers to questions asked by the CIM or an appointed Counselor-Mentor during the training period. All staff are expected to have a working knowledge of concepts presented in the SMM, the TAP SOR User Guide, installation policies, and all other additional trainings. Staff must be proficient with all TAP SOR features.

CIMs and Transition Counselors must be able to provide Individualized Initial Counseling with the review of the Initial Assessment and Pre-Separation Counseling, facilitate TAP courses, core and additive, and be familiar with curriculum. Financial Counselors must be able to conduct Financial Planning for Transition and be familiar with the material presented during the Pre-Separation Counseling, Army Transition Day, and additional handouts. All Counselors must be able to conduct active counseling, which includes walk-in services, resource, and scheduled counseling. The CIM or a Counselor-Mentor observes briefings, training classes, and counseling sessions to determine if the new employee is providing services effectively and in compliance with TAP guidance. When new staff member training is complete and they have taken their specific certification exam, the CIM requests new employee certification in writing. A copy of the Certification Memo is provided to the RM who gives final approval.

The RM trains and certifies all new CIMs in their region. A new CIM must be able to conduct daily, weekly, and monthly checklist activities, in addition to being proficient with TAP SOR, CRS reporting, and all TAP curricula. The RM gives final certification approval of a CIM after the certification exam is taken using the CIM Certification Memo. The Certification Memo is then sent to the Training Team to be uploaded into contractor's reference library/shared drive.

For all personnel, routine sustainment training is important for maintaining staff competencies and high-quality services. The CIM ensures that all staff know and follow the Army's TAP SOR business rules, understand web-based TAP SOR operations, are proficient with them and can guide Clients in their use. At a minimum, on a quarterly basis, the CIM conducts periodic, formal sustainment training. Training can be conducted in small increments more frequently (e.g., mini modules conducted during weekly staff meetings) or in a single, formal training session. When the opportunity is made available for staff to attend training events conducted by the Training Team, time should be set aside for them to be able to attend.

The contractor's reference library/shared drive offers expanded resources designed to provide users with access to information, guidance, and management resources. CIMs will ensure that the contractor's reference library/shared drive resources are used to train new staff and support sustainment training for all staff. Many documents can be downloaded as PDF files and sent to staff as email attachments. The contractor's

reference library/shared drive can be updated by the contractor. For current information, staff can also refer to the Regional Manager, the PMO Training Team or the PMO.

Performance Standards

Each staff member is held accountable for contractor developed standards. Employees receive a copy of the standards when they report for work, and standards usually take the form of a performance plan. The standards are designed to ensure compliance with contractual obligations, TAP rules and regulations, and to promote excellence when providing services. Standards should be specific, quantifiable, and verifiable to form the basis for future personnel decisions (promotions, pay increases, disciplinary actions, dismissals, etc.). Performance standards generally address quantity and quality of work, knowledge of systems and processes, cooperation, attitude, and personal appearance.

Resolving Problems

A staff member might encounter a problem that is directly related to CIM action or inaction. In those instances, the preferred means of resolving the problem is to begin with the CIM, so they can resolve a problem before it reaches a higher level. If the staff member is uncomfortable about raising the issue with the CIM or if previous discussions with the CIM have failed to resolve the problem, the staff member may contact the appropriate RM directly. In a similar fashion, the RM should be given the opportunity to resolve a problem before it is raised with the DPM, then the PM.

TAP contractor staff should never directly contact the TSM, IMCOM, government representatives at the TAP Program Management Office at Fort Knox or any other Army official to resolve a problem. Only the CIM should directly contact the TSM or installation officials when the TSM authorizes it or is not available. Only contractor Program Management Office staff should contact Army officials above the installation level. The CIM is expected to work closely with the TSM, and installation level problems should ideally be resolved between the TSM and CIM. In some instances, it may be necessary for the RM or other contractor officials to assist in negotiations with the TSM. It is not appropriate, however, for the CIM or a TAP contractor staff member to enlist the assistance of DA or other Army officials in a dispute with the TSM. Contractor Program Management Office staff must make all contacts with Army officials above installation level for the TAP Centers. If problems cannot be directly resolved between the TSM and CIM, contact the RM immediately.

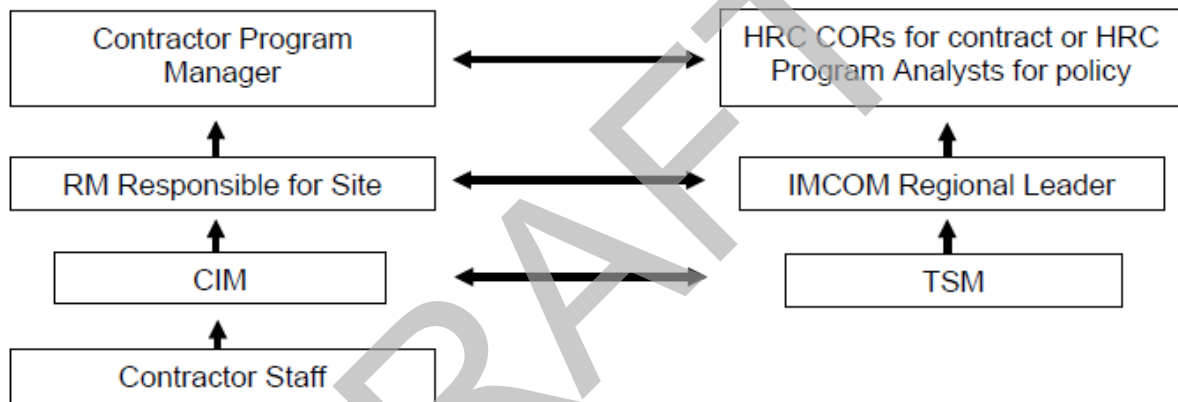
As a matter of policy, issues related solely to TAP management or TAP contractor performance normally are not raised with anyone except the RM or another member of the TAP Center contractor operations chain of command. If a contractor staff member is dissatisfied with the initial response from the TAP contractor operations team, resolution may be sought from the next higher member of the team.

Some problems or suggestions may relate directly to contractor-specific Transition issues (e.g., payroll, automation, purchasing, etc.). In these instances, direct contact with the Human Resources Point of Contact is appropriate. If the TAP employee is unable to resolve the issue in this fashion, contact the appropriate TAP Center RM for additional assistance. The contractor's Communication Chain is illustrated in [Figure 9](#).

The Army G1 provides guidance, which is distributed through the TAP Program Management Office as policy to the Army National Guard, Army Reserve, and Installation Management Command. To facilitate this flow, support is supplied by contractor staff through Forward Transition Support Teams (FTSTs) in addition to TAP Center staff.

Figure 9: Communication Chain

Communication Chain



Disciplinary Actions

The CIM establishes and preserves a high standard of conduct in the workplace that is guided by the principles of equity, reasonableness, and due process. If circumstances at the Center result in a disciplinary action, the action must be coordinated with the RM.

Dismissal

Dismissal is the most serious form of disciplinary action in Contractor matters, and the CIM must be fully informed. If a CIM believes that an employee's conduct or performance may warrant dismissal, they must immediately contact their Regional Manager before proceeding with any communication with the employee.

Personnel—OCONUS

Employees are required to comply with host nation laws and applicable Army or Military Command Regulations. Failure to comply with laws and regulations may cause

termination. In some instances, failure to comply with host nation laws may subject the employee or their Family Members to the jurisdiction of the host nation's courts.

Volunteers

Federal statutes and Army policy severely limit the contractor-volunteer relationship. Contractor staff are forbidden from supervising or directing volunteer activities in any manner. Volunteers are not permitted to perform any substantive function for which the contractor is responsible. The TSM may have administrative support personnel assigned to TAP and it is the TSM, not the contractor TAP contractor staff, who has supervisory authority over them. Contracting regulations do not allow contractor personnel to direct military personnel that are detailed to perform duties not supported by authorized positions or to allow military personnel to perform functions that the contractor is being paid to perform (e.g., transition and employment assistance training, counseling, and assistance). TAP contractor staff must ensure they do not violate Army policy, contracting regulations, or the law.

Contractors will inform their CIM who will point out any potential violations to government staff.

Chapter 14: Training

In accordance with our contract, all contractor personnel must complete initial and new hire training and then maintain currency of skills and qualifications required by TAP via one-time, annual, and ad hoc sustainment trainings. Both new hire and sustainment training dates will be tracked and filed locally. Training reports will be submitted to the PMO as directed, i.e., monthly, quarterly, etc. CIMs will utilize a standardized template when submitting the training report. All training will be filed in accordance with ARIMS.

New Hire Training

New hire training is initiated at orientation within the first days of employment or if assuming a new position, i.e., a counselor to an LNO position, and continues up to 30 days into employment. New hire training is based upon the employee's role and includes topics related to TAP and those specific to their role.

Training consists of progressive on-the-job- training, mentorship and observation, completion of all required government and contractor training, and completion of a final examination. Completed training is documented in a certification memo which is signed by the employee's supervisor (CIM or RM) and forwarded to the PMO Training Team POC for processing.

Some installations may require additional training based upon local policy. Required government training is tracked in the Army Training Certification Tracking System (ATCTS). Completion of courses may require usage of a CAC to access certain online courses, such as the DoD Cyber Awareness Challenge Training. Training may be completed through various platforms including JKO, specific DoD websites or contractor's reference library/shared drive, recorded trainings, and live teleconferences.

New-hire training consists of government and contractor training:

- Contractor training is specifically outlined in new employee training documents, DoD Guide to Required Training, and program training to include Client transition tracking in accordance with CRS in TAP SOR and DoD information systems, TAP overview, specific role training.
- Additional contractor training, such as ethics, may also be required.

Sustainment Training

Sustainment training is designed to maintain currency of skills and is provided by the government and the contractor. Sustainment training can be either annual or ad hoc. Staff are required to complete the following government training IAW AR 350-1:

- Army Training and Certification Tracking System (ATCTS) profile is up-to-date and accurate
- DoD Cyber Awareness Challenge
- Anti-terrorism (AT) Training
- Personally Identifiable Information (PII) handling and procedures
- Health Information Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) and Privacy Act Training
- Combatting Trafficking In Persons (CTIP)
- Security Hub Awareness
 - Operations Security (OPSEC)
 - Unauthorized Disclosure of Classified Information
 - Threat Awareness & Reporting Program (TARP)
 - Information Security (INFOSEC)
 - DoD Initial Orientation and Awareness Training/Refresher
 - CUI Training
 - Combatting Trafficking in Persons (CTIP)
- IWatch (one-time only)
- Blended Retirement (CIMs, TCs, and FinCOs – one-time only)

At no time should an employee's required annual training expire. Lapses in maintaining required training may result in the loss of system access privileges and can affect an employee's ability to perform work. Exceptions to this rule exist for employees on certain types of leave (Military, Short- or Long-Term Disability). These individuals must complete training requirements upon reporting to work.

Additional sustainment training is provided by the contractor and includes information provided during regularly scheduled meetings or teleconferences, individual review of updated new hire training, or group attendance at training teleconferences for specific topics.

Training Compliance

All staff training (new hire and annual) is tracked monthly on a training compliance report. Tracking includes providing completion dates for required government and contractor training and allows for additional local training information. Refer to ARIMS guidance on filing training documents, such as staff training certification memos and completion certificates, to assist with completing this report.

Inquiries regarding how to access required training or the training report template should be directed to your immediate supervisor (CIM, or RM) or the PMO Senior Analyst LNO.

Chapter 15: Logistics

Facility

The Army maintains high standards for facilities located on its installations. Clean and well-maintained buildings foster productivity and avoid safety hazards. The PM provides specific guidance to the CIM regarding the facility. The TSM, who has the responsibility for ensuring that adequate facilities and services are provided to the TAP Center, supplements that guidance, and ensures that the TAP Center meets all applicable installation standards for facility appearance and safety. When meeting that goal, Clients must not be asked to set up, clean rooms, or sign for rooms/keys. Although the following standards do not supersede the guidance issued by those parties, they represent commonly accepted standards.

Supplies are stored out of sight in closets, storage rooms, or supply cabinets. Electrical cables are situated in a way that protects both the cables and the equipment they are connected to, in a manner that presents no safety hazard to staff or Clients. Cables must not detract from the facility's appearance. TAP Center equipment is situated to maximize its utility, afford easy access by staff and Clients, prevent safety hazards, while presenting a neat and businesslike appearance.

Cleaning contracts vary from installation to installation. In most instances, installations have a cleaning contractor that provides services. The TSM and CIM are responsible for reporting the lack of cleaning services provided by the installation through appropriate notification channels. The staff is responsible for maintaining a general level of cleanliness in the facility. TAP contractor staff are not expected to clean classrooms or common areas after other transition agents (DoL, VA, etc.) teach classes. TAP Center

buildings are the property of the Army. The responsibility for maintaining and repairing the TAP Center lies with the Army; therefore, maintenance problems are referred to the TSM for resolution.

The installation engineers and Directorate of Public Works (DPW) normally have service telephone numbers that can be used to report repair or maintenance problems. The CIM should ensure that key staff have access to emergency service numbers and are briefed on the routine process of requesting maintenance through the TSM. Whenever the TAP Center must be closed for scheduled or unscheduled maintenance or repair activities, the TSM is notified. If the Center closing is known in advance, it should be publicized in the installation newspaper and official information bulletins. The TSM approves all such announcements.

When facility problems or required maintenance activities present a threat to the TAP Center equipment, materials, and files, every effort, excluding jeopardizing staff safety, should be made to safeguard them by removal or other protective measures. This is especially true if the TAP Center's electronic equipment is threatened. Care should be taken to ensure that electronic equipment is moved strictly according to established procedures.

The CIM is required to develop both emergency and non-emergency evacuation plans and ensure that all staff understand their responsibilities under those plans. Assistance in developing those plans can be obtained from the RM, the contractor's Transition experts, and through coordination with the TSM, the installation safety office, fire department, and facility engineer. At least 30 calendar days prior to any move, the government notifies the contractor in writing of the intention to move equipment. This notification applies to non-emergency moves only. In the event of an emergency (e.g., fire, flood, earthquake, etc.), the contractor responds immediately to the government's notification for action. All situations of this type will be immediately reported to their RM, DPM, PM, and government POC at the TAP PMO at Fort Knox.

Equipment

All equipment in the TAP Center is used solely for the TAP Center's mission. However, remember that all TAP Center equipment is the property of the Army, and, consequently, the Army may determine its best use. Equipment is not diverted to other uses or organizations on the installation unless the TAP Program Management Office at Fort Knox issues instructions to do so. If instructed to release equipment to another agency, the CIM ensures that equipment removal is documented. The party receiving the equipment (another Army office, copier technician, computer maintenance worker, etc.) must sign a receipt for the equipment. Changes to the site's equipment are not to be made without prior notification. If the CIM is asked to release equipment permanently or temporarily, even with appropriate documentation, the CIM should immediately notify the RM responsible for the site. The CIM should ensure that all staff are briefed on procedures necessary to safeguard Army equipment. Contract staff may account for supplies, furniture, or equipment used at the location when inventory

support is requested by the TSM.

TAP Center equipment must not be used by staff, or any person, for personal benefit. Care should be taken to ensure that the printer, copier, and fax machine are safeguarded from unofficial use and that all staff understand the prohibition of their use for personal reasons. Therefore, a copy limit per visit should be established for each Client and machine use must be limited to Clients and TAP contractor staff. Additionally, TAP Clients are prohibited from copying or printing medical or legal records at the TAP Center. The TSM must be made aware of equipment that is malfunctioning, is down for maintenance, or requires repair.

Maintaining TAP SOR and DoDTAP Connectivity

Failure or slow automated response times related to TAP SOR can be reported through the TAP Transition and functional ticket website at https://www.aesmp.army.mil/csm?id=csm_index. A member of the Transition support team will then provide the necessary assistance.

Repairing Equipment

As installations incorporate TAP into their computer lifecycle management programs, TAP Centers may receive computers from the installation. The way contractors safeguard and account for government property, along with the processes they implement varies depending on the source of the property.

The FTST staff are responsible for receiving, maintaining, and accounting for their equipment issued by HRC in a specific manner. Questions regarding procedures should be directed to the CIM and/or RM.

The installation may allocate property listed on its Property Book for the use of the TAP Center. By signing a sub-hand receipt, the contractor staff member acknowledges their responsibility to safeguard and account for the property received. It is essential to thoroughly review the sub-hand receipt prior to signing to ensure that the property is accurately described, including details such as quantity, serial number, and condition, confirming that it is operational and in good standing.

Discrepancies should be documented in writing on the sub-hand receipt, or a revised version of the sub-hand receipt must be submitted for signature. If the property is later determined to be excess or no longer operational, the TSM must be informed, and a document signed by an authorized government official relieving the TAP contractor of responsibility for the equipment must be provided before the property can be removed.

Supplies

Supplies such as paper, toner, pens, and other materials are provided by the

government. It is essential to conduct periodic inventories, ensuring that stock levels do not drop below the minimum thresholds established by the CIM with the concurrence of the TSM. All supply orders must be submitted to the government point of contact by the CIM. The personal use of site supplies may result in disciplinary action, and in severe cases, may be prosecuted as theft of government property. The CIM holds the responsibility for ensuring that supplies are adequately protected against theft or misuse.

Consumables, such as handouts and folder content, must be consistently replenished during regular operations, ensuring that stock levels do not dip below the minimum required to meet monthly demands. The CIM is tasked with overseeing the procurement of adequate supplies of consumable publications from the designated point of contact for the courses taught by TAP contractors. Depending on the caseload and the size of the TAP Center, there may be limitations in on-site storage for these publication stocks. In such cases, the TSM is responsible for coordinating access to an off-site storage facility. However, utilizing off-site storage does not exempt the CIM from the obligation to manage supply stocks effectively to ensure uninterrupted service for TAP Clients.

All supply or equipment requisitions must be properly documented and maintained. A designated staff member is responsible for receiving the requisition. Upon receiving the ordered items, this individual verifies the delivery against the requisition to ensure that all items have been received and that they are in good condition. These documents are then filed in the TAP Center, creating a comprehensive "request and receipt" record.

Utilities

The Army provides essential utilities to the TAP Center, including heating, water, electricity, Internet, and telephone services. The mission capability of the TAP Center relies heavily on high-quality telephone service. Thus, every effort must be made to ensure that the TAP Center has access to an external telephone line, as well as the ability to connect with civilian contacts outside the local dialing area through existing long-distance control procedures.

The Army has established regulations governing telephone use on installations, which aim to minimize costs and reserve lines for mission-essential purposes. The staff at the TAP Center is required to adhere to these rules. Additionally, the Contract Installation Manager (CIM) must develop internal policies and procedures to ensure compliance with these installation regulations regarding telephone use.

At times, mission requirements of the Army may necessitate the implementation of "minimize" conditions for all telephone users on the installation. In these instances, the TAP Center will be informed and must adhere to the established procedures. The use of the installation's telephone lines and services is strictly limited to official calls and services only.

The TAP Center occasionally relies on fax communication to carry out its work. Other utilities also play a significant role in supporting the TAP Center's mission capabilities. Computers, printers, and fax machines require a consistent power supply. Therefore, the CIM must always verify that the electrical service is adequate prior to the installation of any site equipment. Any issues regarding the electrical supply should be reported to the installation office responsible for electrical services. If the service cannot be restored to acceptable minimum levels, the CIM is required to document the issue in writing to the TSM and subsequently inform the RM responsible for the site, providing a copy of the written notification. Outlet locations should allow equipment and furniture to be placed in the Center in a manner that facilitates operations, avoids safety hazards, and minimizes the use of extension cords.

The installation is responsible for supplying adequate drinking water, sanitary facilities, Client parking, and handicapped access. When heat and water problems create an unhealthy environment or effects TAP Center service quality, the CIM reports the issues to the TSM, in writing, including their effect on the TAP Center mission capability. The CIM immediately contacts the RM responsible for the site by phone and provides a copy of the written notification.

Logistics – Outside of the Continental or Contiguous United States (OCONUS)

OCONUS office space is at a premium and many existing facilities may be inappropriate for use as a TAP Center. Care should be taken to ensure that the existing electrical supply, access to phone lines, heating and cooling, and availability of lavatories are adequate. TAP Center effectiveness depends directly on the quality of telephone communications. TAP Center staff must be able to reach Clients and work with other TAP Centers throughout the world by fax and telephone. The TAP Center must be given access to a direct dial long distance service. Because the contractor's HR, payroll, and other sections may not have Defense Switched Network (DSN) access, it is essential for TAP Centers to establish the capability to communicate internationally using communication methods other than DSN lines.

Providing effective transition and employment assistance services requires a facility with a controlled environment. Adequate heat and air conditioning are essential for providing effective services to TAP Clients. Since the TAP Center depends on electronic equipment to perform its mission, that equipment must be protected from wide fluctuations in temperature and humidity.

Chapter 16: Performance Requirements and Quality Control Plan

Performance Objectives and Requirements

The TAP contract contains many performance requirements to support program objectives. The TAP contract contains principal objectives for the contractor as follows.

The Contractor:

- Ensures that all Service Members who receive notification and initiate further contact receive transition services
- Maintains and staffs Brick and Mortar locations, as well as FTSTs based on mission requirements
- Ensures tracking of transitioning Clients in compliance and noncompliance
- Ensures Service Members, transitioning with 180 days or more of continuous Active-Duty service, receive Pre-Separation Counseling NLT 12 months prior to their transition or retirement date
- Provides career assistance training and support to facilitate Service Member employment
- Collects data, conducts analysis, and summarizes metric information from program data and analysis monthly or as required by the government
- Provides choice-based program to Service Members, their Family Members, and eligible DA civilians, which will allow the user to receive services through face-to-face or live virtual means
- Supports installation notification and follow-up with TAP Clients
- Maintains accurate Service Member/Client records in automated database

To support these objectives, performance requirements with observable metrics are given to Contract and government staff. Both the Contractor and government are responsible for monitoring performance to ensure performance expectations are met. [Figure 10](#) below outlines important performance requirements that must be met, including specific thresholds and notes to help staff with clarifications. The examples of performance requirements provided are not exhaustive but highlight key points to assist TAP Center staff with goal setting and quality control functions.

Figure 10: Performance Requirement Examples

REQUIREMENT	THRESHOLD	NOTES
Initial Assessment, IIC, and ITP	100% of eligible SM receive an Initial Assessment, IIC and imitate their ITP No later than 12 months prior to separation	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – within 24 hours
Pre-Separation Counseling for AC and RC	100% of eligible SM receive their notification of Pre-Separation Counseling no later than 12 months prior to separation date	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – within 24 hours
Managing Your (MY) Transition	100% of eligible SM receive notification and scheduling assistance of the Managing Your (MY) Transition no later than nine months prior to the Service Member's separation date	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – Notification within 24 hours
Military Crosswalk Training for SM	100% of eligible SM are afforded the opportunity to receive Military Crosswalk Training	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – Notification within 24 hours
Financial Planning	100% of eligible Service Members are afforded the opportunity to complete Financial Counseling	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – Notification within 24 hours
Department of Labor One Day	100% of eligible SM receive notification and scheduling assistance of the DoL One Day no later than nine months prior to the Service Member's separation date	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – Notification within 24 hours
VA Benefits Briefing	100% of SM receive notification and scheduling assistance of the VA Benefits no later than six months prior to transition date	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – Notification within 24 hours
Resume	100% of eligible SM are afforded the opportunity to complete a tailored resume of choice no later than five months prior to separation or within the timeframe allotted for separation	Programmed Losses – no deviation Unanticipated Losses – Notification within 24 hours

REQUIREMENT	THRESHOLD	NOTES
Phone Calls to Virtual Center	100% Answered/Calls Taken Abandon rate of 15% or less	Provide root cause analysis and proposed course of action when abandoned call rate exceeds 15%
Commander Specific Notification Reports (UIC based report)	Weekly or as needed	
Hiring Events/Employer Days Support	Assist with one installation Hiring Event and one Employer Day per quarter (*government approved) per TAP contract location	Collaborative marketing efforts with stakeholders will be limited to Facebook, Google Calendar, flyers for distribution during CRS events, and assisting TSM with submitting PAO newspaper articles. Spearheading Hiring Events and Employer Day events cannot be supported. Collecting participant and employer data will be completed at the TAP booth in general.
Set up and breakdown of VA Benefits and DoL Classrooms	Set up and breakdown takes approximately 15 minutes each	Contract Staff will be required to conduct light cleaning; the contractor's role is to inform the TSM, or government staff of Transition and classroom issues encountered only
TAP SOR and additive classes taught by other personnel.	Contact staff assist with additive classes taught by others; by uploading events and maintaining attendance in TAP SOR. This level of effort will be reported in TAP SOR.	Contract staff will send appointment reminders, set-up classroom, provide any curriculum, or copy any materials for outside instructors
Maintain a Success Story board	Posted and updated monthly	Success Story template must be used to capture information
Maintain a physical or digital Job Announcement/ Articles Bulletin Board	Recent articles and current job announcements from sources such as USAJOBS, industry magazines, and trade associations posted and updated monthly	Updated monthly at a minimum

Quality Control Plan

An effective Quality Control Plan (QCP) necessitates a comprehensive program aimed at addressing problems and preventing their recurrence. The QCP is a proactive process that encompasses standardized inspections, the analysis of data gathered from both automated and non-automated sources, the collection of client questionnaire responses, the implementation of corrective actions, the maintenance of staff training programs, and the evaluation of staff performance. The QCPs at TAP Center prioritize contractual compliance, client satisfaction, and government satisfaction.

While every staff member contributes to quality services, QCP is primarily a management function. The DPM, the RMs, and the CIMs are charged with enforcing applicable contract compliance and service quality to ensure that standards are maintained. This responsibility includes reporting problems with recommendations up the Chain of Command for resolution.

The contractor is required to adhere to the contract stipulations and ensure all obligations are met. Key requirements of the TAP contract include providing Individualized Initial Counseling, Pre-Separation Counseling, employment assistance counseling, scheduling and completing CRS requirements for Service Members within specified timelines, and completing sections of the Individualized Transition Plan (ITP). A final assessment of Client Career Readiness through the Capstone process must be carried out, and the DD Form 2648 must be signed. All documentation should be recorded in TAP SOR as activities occur and must be done prior to the Service Member's release from Active Duty.

QCP inspectors use a checklist to document inspection results in person or virtually (VQC). Contractors are responsible for ensuring that all delivered content adheres to the required standards and that the quality of the presentation is satisfactory, recorded, and reported promptly. Contractual compliance is ascertained through reports, questionnaires, and site inspections by QCP inspectors.

The QCP inspector will contact the CIM two weeks prior to inspection. The CIM will be required to complete the CIM In-Brief and the CIM Pre-Inspection Checklist. The CIM should arrange time for the inspector to meet with the TSM, themselves, and other employees during the inspection.

The QCP inspector will prioritize sites that have identified corrective actions, have exceptional operations occur to identify best practices, where no in-person QC has been performed within the last 18 months, sites who have large staff turnovers, sites with a CIM less than 6 months on the program, sites where throughput demand and staff appointment capacity are not consistently managed properly balanced, sites with indications of sub-standard environmental issues, and Monitor IMCOM SAVs/Government SAVs as indicators for on-site visits.

The PM ensures that a minimum of 20 inspections is conducted annually. Generally, a single QCP inspector is scheduled for the inspection. Inspections may be announced or unannounced. If announced, they are coordinated with the TSM and CIM to ensure that conflicts with services do not occur and that the TSM and CIM are available for meetings. Typically, a location will experience one virtual and one on-site inspection within a 12-month period.

The inspector completes and submits the QCP Report. The report undergoes review to resolve any open issues, then sent to the TAP Policy Office at Fort Knox and the contracting officer.

Quality Assurance (QA) is the government's responsibility and is conducted by the contracting officer or their designated representative.

DRAFT

Appendix 1: Glossary of Terms

Active Counseling: This refers to a proactive and intensive form of counseling offered at the Client terminal, which encompasses two distinct types: just-in-time counseling and resource counseling

Administrative Specialist (AS): The TAP Administrative Specialist supports the Contractor Installation Manager (CIM) by taking on routine daily tasks that do not require specialized training or expertise. This role allows the CIM to focus on their core responsibilities. The Administrative Specialist possesses a solid understanding of transition and employment assistance functions, as well as the operational methods of the TAP Center, enabling them to effectively represent the professional staff of the TAP Center in their absence.

Alternate Contracting Officer's Representative (ACOR): An employee of the U.S. Government designated by the Contracting Officer (KO) to provide on-site support to the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR). Before being appointed, the ACOR must complete the necessary training, become familiar with the Performance Work Statement (PWS) requirements, and possess the qualifications needed to fulfill the role of ACOR. The appointment must be documented in writing, clearly outlining the scope of authority and any limitations. It is important to note that this individual does not have the authority to alter the terms and conditions of the contract.

Appropriated Fund Employees: Regular Government employees within the Army. Appropriated Fund employees qualify for TAP Center services based on the criteria specified in Chapter 4 of this manual.

Army Career Counselor: An active-duty service member who has received specific training to provide reenlistment or transition information and options to fellow service members, as well as to carry out responsibilities associated with retention and transition missions.

Army Community Service (ACS): ACS is the installation agency that offers a variety of support services, including relocation assistance, financial counseling, and stress management counseling. Additionally, ACS provides programs focused on Drug and Alcohol Abuse Prevention, support for Exceptional Family Members, advocacy programs for children, service members, and families, as well as the Employment Readiness Program (ERP). The ERP is designed to help Army spouses secure employment in the community when their sponsor is transferred within the Army, and its staff typically maintains strong connections with local employers.

Army Wounded Warrior (AW2) Program: The AW2 Program is the official U.S. Army initiative dedicated to assisting and advocating for severely wounded, injured, and ill service members and their families, regardless of their location, for as long as necessary. This program provides customized support to service members who were injured or fallen ill during their service in the Global War on Terrorism.

Capstone: The Capstone event serves as a concluding career milestone and final quality control measure to ensure that service members have successfully completed their Career Readiness Standards (CRS). This is facilitated by a Transition Assistance Program (TAP) Counselor, Unit Commander, or a forum for transitioning service members supported by organizations such as the Small Business Administration (SBA), Department of Labor (DoL), Department of Veterans Affairs (VA), Army Continuing Education System (ACES), and ACS. The Capstone can be conducted either in person or through virtual means.

Career Readiness Standards (CRS): A set of mandatory actions that transitioning Service Members must complete prior to their separation date, as defined by the Office of the Secretary of Defense, based on the assigned tier level.

Centralized Reporting: A reporting process directed to a specific individual to facilitate decision-making that supports the customer, as well as legal and policy requirements.

Certificate of Release or Discharge from Active Duty: The official title of DD Form 214, which is issued to Service Members to document their military service information and separation date.

Chaplain: The Chaplain serves as the primary resource for addressing spiritual issues and can provide assistance in personal counseling and stress management.

Civilian Personnel Advisory Center (CPAC): The Civilian Personnel Advisory Center consists of a team of human resources professionals committed to supporting and empowering Service Members, civilians, families, and veterans globally in an era characterized by persistent conflict. The CPAC is tasked with recruiting, retaining, and sustaining a high-quality volunteer force through innovative and effective enterprise solutions, ensuring human resources readiness for the Total Army across a full spectrum of operations.

Civilian Personnel Operations Center (CPOC): The CPOC serves as the central processing office for the minimally staffed Civilian Personnel Advisory Centers located at each installation within its region. All civilian personnel actions are now managed from a regional CPOC.

Community Care Unit (CCU): A CCU is a unit within the Service Member Recovery Unit (SRU) that provides command and medical management support to Service Members as they navigate the Army's medical treatment system while recovering at home with the assistance of their families and communities.

Continental or Contiguous United States (CONUS): This acronym is used to describe installations or activities within the 48 contiguous states, typically excluding Alaska and Hawaii.

Contractor: A contractor is a supplier, or vendor awarded a contract to provide specific supplies or services to the government. In this context, the term refers to the prime contractor.

Contract Specialist: A Contract Specialist is the official government representative authorized by the Contracting Officer (KO) to oversee contract administration. This individual is generally a member of the appropriate contracting or procurement career field and provides advice on all Transition contractual matters.

Contractor Installation Manager (CIM): The primary representative of the Contractor during the installation process. The CIM oversees the operations and staff of the TAP Center and functions under the supervision of the contractor's Site Responsible Manager (RM). Additionally, the CIM collaborates with the Transition Services Manager to ensure effective coordination, guidance, and oversight.

Contracting Officer (KO): The Government official tasked with the formal negotiation of all contracts, possessing the authority to enter into, administer, and terminate contracts, as well as make related determinations. The contracting officer is the sole individual authorized to modify the scope and requirements of a contract or contract delivery order. The KO relies on the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) to monitor compliance with the contract and to provide Transition direction to the contractor. Importantly, the KO is the only person authorized to contractually bind the government. The KO may designate a government employee to act as an authorized representative; however, this individual will not have the authority to award, agree to, or sign any contracts or modifications, nor to obligate the government's payment in any manner.

Contracting Officer's Representative (COR): An employee of the U.S. Government appointed by the Contracting Officer (KO). This appointment is formalized in writing and outlines the scope of authority and limitations. The COR has the authority to provide Transition direction to the contractor, provided that such direction falls within the contract's scope, does not constitute a change, and does not have funding implications. It is important to note that the designated individual does not possess the authority to alter the contract's terms and conditions.

Defense Switched Network (DSN): A specialized telephone network operated by the Army that enables "free" calls between DSN users. For example, one TAP Center can use DSN to communicate with another TAP Center. However, DSN cannot be utilized to connect with non-DSN users, such as the contractor's site manager.

Deliverable: Any item that can be physically delivered. This may also include non-manufactured items, such as meeting minutes or reports.

Department of Defense Education Activity (DODEA): A school system serving the children of military and federal employees in designated areas.

Department of Labor Employment Fundamentals for Career Transition (EFCT): An employment overview designed and funded by the Department of Labor, which is delivered independently by individual facilitators in states and overseas.

Designated Government Representative (DGR): In most locations, this individual will typically be the Transition Services Manager (TSM) or the Transition Services Specialist (TSS). If the contractor is uncertain about the identity of the DGR at a specific location, they should reach out to the COR for clarification.

Directorate of Human Resources (DHR): Principal staff officer of the Garrison Commander's staff responsible for human resource type functions: personnel (military and civilian), recreation, education, equal opportunity, etc. This responsibility includes all military, civilian employees, and Family Members.

Directorate of Public Works (DPW): The DPW is tasked with managing utilities, fire prevention, protection measures, and housing administration. Additionally, it is responsible for the maintenance and repair of utility systems and family housing units.

Disabled Veterans Outreach Program Specialist (DVOP): DVOPs offer essential employment assistance to disabled veterans. These specialists, who are employees of the Department of Labor, can be found at Veterans Employment and Training Service (VETS) offices.

Education Center: This is an office specifically designed to assist Service Members in defining and achieving their educational objectives. Those seeking testing or certification to support their transition goals can receive guidance from the Education Center or an Education Counselor at a TAP Center. Education Counselors offer transitioning Service Members valuable information and support regarding a wide array of post-service education and training opportunities, ranging from full university enrollment to vocational training.

Effective Service: Refers to a service output that fails to meet the performance standards outlined in the Performance Work Statement (PWS).

eForm: This term refers to the DD Form 2648, the Service Member Pre-Separation/Transition Counseling and Career Readiness Standards eForm intended for Service Members who are separating, retiring, or being released from Active Duty (REFRAD).

Electronic Military Personnel Office (eMILPO): This is a web-based electronic system used by the Army to manage personnel information, supporting operations at various levels, including battalion, separate units, installations, and divisions.

Enhanced Hiring Event/Job Fair Team: Enhanced hiring events and job fairs are organized to provide transitioning Service Members with opportunities to connect with potential employers and receive employment advice. These events are supported by a team of contractor personnel appointed by the installation Command Installation Manager (CIM) with the agreement of the DGR.

Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR): This is the compilation of regulations issued by the Federal Government that governs all contracting activities conducted by its agencies. Both the Army and its contractors are obligated to adhere to the complete set of Federal Acquisition Regulations.

Forward Transition Support Team (FTST): This team operates within the 54 states and territories and is primarily based in civilian communities supporting Reserve Component or remote Army units. The FTST's mission is to deliver services to geographically dispersed Service Members within its designated region. The team consists of counselors from the Transition Assistance Program (TAP), Army Community Service (ACS), and case managers from the Employer Partnership of the Armed Forces (EPAF).

Fusion Cell: This group comprises outreach assistance stakeholders who consolidate employment-related data and disseminate it in a targeted manner to transition services managers. The Fusion Cell has been succeeded by the Transition and Connection Analyst Team (TCAT).

General Schedule (GS): This term refers to a class of Appropriated Fund employees with Transition responsibilities. It typically applies to civilian employees in Grades 1–15 and is often used to represent all civilian personnel within the Army.

Headquarters, Department of the Army (HQDA): Comprises the Chief of Staff, the Army Staff, and the Field Operating Agencies associated with the Army Staff (such as the Human Resources Command).

Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) Training: Policies and procedures for HIPAA privacy and security have been established to protect individual health information and ensure that all patient data is handled appropriately.

Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC): This is a substantive counseling session provided to Service Members before Pre-Separation Counseling. During the IIC, a Counselor assesses the individual needs of the Service Member and their family, assigns a tier, offers an overview of the Individual Transition Plan (ITP), addresses any questions, schedules relevant events, and makes referrals to other service providers.

Individual Transition Plan (ITP): The ITP is a service-specific document required as part of the Comprehensive Transition Strategy (CRS), designed to assist Service Members in defining and achieving their goals and plans for life after military service.

Installation Management Command (IMCOM): This organization was created to centralize and oversee the financial and operational management of installation services.

Integrated Disability Evaluation System (IDES): A collaborative system utilized by the Department of Defense and the Department of Veterans Affairs, providing a unified disability examination and a single-source disability rating that each department employs to fulfill its responsibilities toward Service Members.

Joint Services Transcript (JST): The officially recognized document sanctioned by the American Council on Education serves to validate a Service Member's military occupational experience and training, along with the associated credit recommendations from the Council. A JST can support Service Members in conjunction with their VMET to conduct a MOC Gap Analysis, assess schools and programs of study, and assist in crafting resumes.

Local Veterans' Employment Representative (LVER): This refers to an employee of the state employment services agency, funded by the Department of Labor. LVERs are typically situated in state employment services offices and serve as the primary resource for information related to local employment opportunities, specialized veterans' employment programs, job training initiatives, and unemployment benefits. Therefore, every transitioning Service Member should be encouraged to reach out to the LVER at the earliest opportunity.

Loss Roster: This is a roster generated from eMILPO that identifies Service Members who are eligible to depart the Army within the next 24 months.

Medical Evaluation Board (MEB): The MEB is an informal procedure involving at least two physicians who assess the medical history of a Service Member and evaluate how the injury or illness may respond to treatment protocols. Should the MEB conclude that the member has a medical condition incompatible with continued military service, the case is referred to a Physical Evaluation Board (PEB).

Medical Treatment Facility (MTF): This term denotes a medical and dental facility catering to military members and their Family Members. At overseas locations, these facilities are also accessible to Department of Defense personnel and other designated civilians.

Military Occupational Code (MOC): This code serves as the fundamental skill identifier for enlisted Service Members, as outlined in Army Regulation AR 611-1 regarding Military Occupational Classification, Structure, Development, and Implementation, which is available as a PDF file. The MOC facilitates occupational classification and career path progression for enlisted personnel.

Military Personnel Division (MPD): This is the personnel office for the installation that serves all assigned military personnel. The MPD offers general personnel service support (PSS) and maintains military personnel files until Service Members are reassigned or separated from the Army. Additionally, the MPD assists Service Members and their Commanders with separation requests and forwards personnel files to the servicing Transition Center for final processing.

MyArmyBenefits: <https://myarmybenefits.us.army.mil/> is the Army's official benefits website and the primary source for all federal and state benefits plus retired pay and survivor benefits calculators that are excellent planning tools.

National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA): This term refers to a series of U.S. federal laws that outline the annual budget and expenditures for the Department of Defense. The U.S. Congress manages the defense budget mainly through two annual bills: the National Defense Authorization Act and defense appropriations bills. The authorization bill identifies the agencies responsible for defense, establishes funding levels, and outlines the policies governing the allocation of funds. The most recent version is the John S. McCain National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2019.

Network Enterprise Center (NEC): The NEC delivers integrated and sustained base information management services and support to installations. This encompasses a range of services, including telecommunications, office automation, records management, and printing and publishing.

Outside the Continental or Contiguous United States: States (OCONUS): This term refers to installations or activities located outside the 48 contiguous states, typically including Alaska and Hawaii.

Physical Evaluation Board (PEB): The PEB is a formal body that determines fitness for duty and disability status. The standard used by the PEB to assess fitness is whether the medical condition prevents the Service Member from reasonably fulfilling the duties associated with their office, grade, rank, or rating.

Physical Evaluation Board Liaison Officer (PEBLO): The PEBLO plays a crucial role in managing the case of the Service Member, assisting them in securing medical appointments. The PEBLO also keeps Service Members updated on the progress of their cases and facilitates communication with their unit.

Physical Security: Refers to the measures taken to safeguard government property from loss or damage.

Pre-Separation Counseling: This involves a mandated counseling session that provides Service Members the opportunity to address any questions they may have regarding the various benefits, programs, services, tools, and resource entitlements available to them.

Public Affairs Office (PAO): This office is responsible for command information, community relations, and media relations at the installation, serving as the liaison between the Installation Commander and the media.

Quality Assurance: This encompasses the government procedures used to verify that the services rendered by contractors meet the established acceptable standards.

Quality Assurance (QA) Performance Review: Regional Leaders from the Installation Management Command (IMCOM) visit TAP Centers to evaluate service performance and operational procedures in comparison to established quality standards.

Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan (QASP): A comprehensive document detailing the surveillance methodology that will be implemented to monitor contractor performance.

Quality Control (QC): All necessary actions taken by the contractor to ensure that the quality of a product or service meets contractual obligations.

Quality Control (QC) Inspection: In line with contractual requirements, members of the TAP Center contractor's management team conduct QC inspections semiannually for all TAP Centers. These inspections assess service performance and operational procedures against established quality standards.

Reduction-In-Force (RIF): A mandated employee reduction initiative aimed at achieving authorized staffing levels, resulting in the termination of individuals from employment or Active Duty. Decisions regarding RIFs may be based on either performance quality or seniority.

RM Responsible for the Site: The corporate representative who is contractually accountable for providing management support and operational guidance to contractor staff delivering transition and employment assistance services at TAP Centers.

Reserve Component Career Counselor (RCCC): A professional tasked with recruiting separating Active Component military personnel into the Army National Guard or Army Reserve, as well as delivering the Continuum of Military Service Counseling (CRS).

Resource Counseling: A proactive form of counseling conducted in a public area of the TAP Center, during which a Transition Counselor addresses general inquiries regarding transition and employment assistance, offers coaching, and aids Clients in decision-making.

Retirement Services Office/Officer (RSO): The entity responsible for processing retiring military personnel. Their administrative duties include conducting periodic orientations for Service Members with over 18 years of service, providing orientations for individuals requesting retirement, counseling spouses of retiring individuals who opt not to elect Survivor Benefit Plan coverage, and offering assistance to retired individuals residing locally. The RSO serves as the official source of information regarding retirement pay, benefits, and privileges for TAP Center customers.

Safety Office: This office provides guidance to the Garrison Commander on all matters related to establishing and maintaining a safe and healthy working and living environment on the installation.

Scheduled Counseling: Private, individual counseling sessions are available for Clients who prefer to discuss transition-related issues in a confidential setting.

Senior Executive Service (SES): This classification pertains to executive positions within the Office of Personnel Management that are above the GS/GM 15 level.

Service Member Pre-Separation/Transition Counseling and Career Readiness Standards: The E-Form for Service Members who are Separating, Retiring, Released from Active Duty (REFRAD), or Being Deactivated (DD Form 2648) is mandated by Public Law. This form confirms that Service Members who are separating from military service have been counseled on their separation benefits and entitlements via Pre-separation and Capstone counseling. It requires signatures from the Service Member, Transition Counselor, and Commander or Designee.

Service Member and Family Assistance Centers (SFAC): These centers provide supportive services to Service Members assigned to or attached to the SRC and their family members. The Transition Assistance Program (TAP) is a key component of the network of providers that support the SFAC.

Site Management Manual (SMM): The SMM serves as the operational guide for TAP Centers, ensuring a uniform approach to operations throughout the entire program.

Soldier Recovery Unit (SRU): The SRU offers administrative oversight, accountability, and support for Service Members who are seriously injured, wounded, or ill.

Staff Judge Advocate (SJA): The SJA is the legal office on a military installation responsible for advising Commanders and assisting Military and Family Members with matters such as wills, powers of attorney, tax information, and providing counseling on employment restrictions.

Status of Forces Agreement (SOFA): These are negotiated agreements between the United States and nations where U.S. military forces are stationed on a permanent basis.

TAP System of Record: The TAP SOR represents the Army's comprehensive strategy to address the needs of today's Army and its Service Members. TAP SOR encompasses all activities and resources related to TAP Centers, backed by current business practices and a modernized web-based application.

TAP SOR Web-based Application: As a key component of TAP SOR, this web-based application is frequently referred to simply as TAP SOR. It seamlessly integrates support for all operations of the TAP Center, serving both staff and Clients. As a unified application, TAP SOR caters to all user requirements, including record keeping, scheduling, access to automated tools and resources, and system administration.

TAP SOR User Guide: This guide provides information and guidance specifically designed for users of the TAP SOR system.

Tier 1: Assigned transition requirement consisting of Individualized Initial Counseling with review of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation Counseling, eBenefits, Army Transition Day, DoL Day, VA Day, Individual Transition Plan, Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only – All Retirees are Exempt), and Capstone with review of the Post Assessment.

Tier 2: Assigned transition requirement consisting of Individualized Initial Counseling with review of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation Counseling, eBenefits, Army Transition Day, DoL Day, VA Day, Individual Transition Plan, Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only – All Retirees are Exempt), Post-Transition Spending Plan, Gap Analysis or verification of employment, CRS associated with career track (if track is selected) and Capstone with review of the Post Assessment.

Tier 3: Assigned transition requirement consisting of Individualized Initial Counseling with review of the Initial Assessment, Pre-Separation Counseling, eBenefits, Army Transition Day, DoL Day, VA Day, Individual Transition Plan, Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only – All Retirees are Exempt), Post-Transition Spending Plan, Gap Analysis or verification of employment, CRS associated with career track (mandatory track selection) and Capstone with review of the Post Assessment.

Transition: A broad term that refers to the process of departing from active Government service, which includes both military and civilian roles. This transition may occur voluntarily or involuntarily.

Transition Center: The designated facility responsible for the final separation processing of Service Members concluding their active-duty service. The timing for initiating transition processing varies based on the type of separation. The Service

Member's military personnel file is transferred from the servicing Military Personnel Office (MILPO) to the Transition Center, which then prepares the necessary final separation documents, including transition orders and the DD Form 214, Certificate of Release or Discharge from Active Duty.

Transition and Connection Analyst Team (TCAT): Formerly referred to as Fusion Cell, TCAT is a collaborative group of outreach assistance stakeholders. This team consolidates employment-related data and disseminates the information in a targeted manner to the Transition Services Manager (TSM) level.

Transition Counselor (TC): The TAP Transition Counselor serves as the primary provider of services at the TAP Center. These services encompass a range of offerings, including Individualized Initial Counseling, Pre-Separation Counseling, Career Readiness Standards, as well as counseling and training in employment assistance. The Transition Counselor adheres to the directives of the CIM.

Transition Services Manager (TSM): At the installation level, the TSM oversees the quality and volume of transition and employment assistance services. Although the TSM does not directly supervise the staff at the TAP Center, they are responsible for monitoring its operations. Acting as the installation liaison for the CIM, the TSM serves as the Commander's main advisor on transition matters and coordinates activities related to transition services.

Transition Services Specialist (TSS): A TSS may be positioned at the installation level to assist the Transition Services Manager (TSM) and/or the Director of Human Resources (DHR). It is important to note that not all installations will have a TSS available.

Veterans Affairs: This federal agency serves as the primary entity for establishing policies and providing services for all veterans in the United States.

Verification of Military Experience and Training (VMET), DD Form 2586: This official Department of Defense document outlines and confirms the Service Member's military education and training.

Warm Handover: A Warm Handover with external agencies is usually conducted during a Service Member's Capstone Event. Warm Handovers are conducted if a Service Member does not meet CRS, does not have a viable ITP, does not have a post-service housing or transportation plan, does not have adequate peer support, displays a red indicator for a life domain(s) on their post assessment, or requires additional assistance. Warm Handovers are intended to be in-person events with DoL, VA, Military OneSource representatives or other agencies. During the interaction, post-transition location and POCs are identified. If a Warm Handover cannot be conducted in person, then an email, a phone call, or providing the Client a phone number to the agency point of contact at the post-transition location will suffice.

Workday: Refers to the number of hours per day that the contractor delivers services in accordance with the contract.

Work Week: Defined as Monday through Friday, unless otherwise specified.

Appendix 2: Commonly Used Acronyms

AC	Active Component
ACES	Army Continuing Education System
ACS	Army Community Service
ACOM	Army Command
ACOR	Assistant Contract Officer Representative
ACT	Army Career Tracker
AD	Active Duty
AHRC	Army Human Resource Command
AIT	Advanced Individual Training
AJC	American Job Center
ALMS	Army Learning Management System
AOR	Area of Responsibility
AR	Army Regulation
ARIMS	Army Records Information Management System
ARNG	Army National Guard
AS	Administrative Specialist
AT	Antiterrorism
ATCTS	Army Training and Certification Tracking System
AW2	Army Wounded Warrior
B&M	Brick and Mortar
CAC	Common Access Card
CEM	Contract Execution Manager
CIM	Contractor Installation Manager
CCU	Community Care Unit
CMR	Contractor Manpower Reporting
CON	Certificates of Net worthiness
CONUS	Continental or Contiguous United States (excludes Alaska and Hawaii)
COP	Command Operating Picture
COR	Contracting Officer Representative
CRS	Career Readiness Standard
CSP	Career Skills Program
CTIP	Combating Trafficking in Persons
CTS	Client Tracking System
DA	Department of the Army
DAC	Department of the Army Civilian
DAR	Data at Rest
DD254	Department of Defense Contract Security Classification Specification
DEERS	Defense Enrollment Eligibility Reporting System

DGR	Designated Government Representative
DHR	Directorate of Human Resources
DMDC	Defense Manpower Data Center
DoD	Department of Defense
DoDI	Department of Defense Instruction
DoDTAP	Department of Defense Transition Assistance Program
DoL	Department of Labor
DoLEW	Department of Labor Employment Workshop (Two-Day)
DoL EFCT	Department of Labor Employment Fundamentals for Career Transition
DPM	Deputy Program Manager
DRU	Direct Reporting Units
DS	Defense Self-Service
DSN	Defense Switched Network
DTM	Directive-Type Memorandum
ECCS	Electronic Client Critique System
eCRMA	Enterprise Contractor Manpower Reporting Application
eMILPO	Electronic Military Personnel Office
EPAF	Employer Partnership of the Armed Forces
ESA	Expiration of Service Agreement
ETS	Expiration of Term of Service
EXORD	Executive Order
EXSUM	Executive Summary
FAR	Federal Acquisition Regulation
FAQ	Frequently Asked Questions
FinCO	Financial Counselor
FIPS	Federal Information Processing Standard
FPCON	Force Protection Condition
FSO	Facilities Security Officer
FTR	Federal Travel Regulations
FTST	Forward Transition Support Team
FY	Fiscal Year
G&A	General & Administrative
GFE	Government Furnished Equipment
GFP	Government Furnished Property
GPS	Goals, Plans, Success
HIPAA	Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act
HQ	Headquarters
HQDA	Headquarters Department of the Army
HQINS	Headquarters Information Notification System
HRC	Human Resources Command
ASC	Army Service Center
IA	Information Awareness
IIC	Individualized Initial Counseling
ICE	Interactive Customer Evaluation
IDES	Integrated Disability Evaluation System

IMCOM	Installation Management Command
IMO	Information Management Officer
IDP	Individual Development Plan
IET	Initial Entry Training
IT	Information Technology
ITP	Individual Transition Plan
JKO	Joint Knowledge Online
JST	Joint Services Transcript
JTR	Joint Travel Regulation
KO	Contracting Officer
LNO	Liaison Officer (Contractor)
MEB	Medical Evaluation Board
MOC	Military Occupational Code
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
MP	Military Police
MPD	Military Personnel Division
MSO	Military Service Organization
MSM	Military Service Members
MSR	Monthly Status Reports
NACI	National Agency Check with Inquiries
NCR	National Capital Region
NDAA	National Defense Authorization Act
NEC	Network Enterprise Center
NETCOM	Network Enterprise Technology Command
NFE	Non-Federal Entity
NGB	National Guard Bureau
NIST	National Institute of Standards and Technology
NLT	Not Later Than
OCI	Organizational Conflict of Interest
OCONUS	Outside the Continental or Contiguous United States
ODC	Other Direct Cost
OEMA	Office of Economic and Manpower Analysis
OMB	Office of Management and Budget
OPSEC	Operations Security
OSD	Office of the Secretary of Defense
PaYS	Partnership for Your Success
PCS	Permanent Change of Station
PEB	Physical Evaluation Board
PEBLO	Physical Evaluation Board Liaison Officer
PERSINSD	Personal Information Systems Directorate
PERSTAT	Personnel Status Report
PDRL	Permanent Disability Retirement List
PII	Personally Identifiable Information
PM	Program Manager
PMO	Program Management Office

POC	Point of Contact
POP	Period of Performance
PWS	Performance Work Statement
QA	Quality Assurance
QASP	Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan
QC	Quality Control
QCI	Quality Control Inspection
QCP	Quality Control Plan
RA	Regular Army
RC	Reserve Component
RCCC	Reserve Component Career Counselor
RFI	Request for Information
RIF	Reduction in Force
ROK	Republic of Korea
RM	Regional Manager
RSO	Retirement Services Officer
SBA	Small Business Administration
SCA	Service Contract Act
SFAC	Service Member and Family Assistance Center
SFL	Soldier for Life
SMM	Site Management Manual
SRU	Soldier Recovery Unit
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
SOFA	Status of Forces Agreement
SOR	System of Record
SPD	Special Designator
STP	Student, Trainee and Prisoner
STRATCOM	Strategic Command
TAP	Transition Assistance Program
TCAT	Transition and Connection Analyst Team
TC	Transition Counselor
TD	Transition Division
TDRL	Temporary Disabled Retirement List
TSM	Transition Services Manager
TSS	Transition Services Specialist
USAR	U.S. Army Reserve
UCX	Unemployment Compensation for Ex-Service Members
UIC	Unit Identification Code
VA	Veterans Affairs
VMET	Verification of Military Experience and Training
VQCI	Virtual Quality Control Inspection
WII	Wounded, Ill and Injured

Appendix 4: Commander's Fact Sheet



Commander's Fact Sheet

Fort [Name]
 Phone
 Government Group Email Box Address
 Building Number, Street, Floor/Wing, Room Number
 Installation Name, State, Zip Code
 Facebook Page URL

Transition Assistance Program (TAP) delivers transition services that ensure all eligible transitioning Soldiers have the training and counseling necessary to be successful as a civilian. TAP Centers hold enhanced hiring events and other opportunities to meet with prospective employers and connect to civilian opportunities.

Commander's Program: The unit Commander ensures all transitioning Soldiers use TAP services IAW AR 600-81. Commanders support a Soldier's transition and encourage them to attend additive classes and events to support their transition goals.

The Army Transition Timeline

Time Before Transition Date																	
18	17	16	15	14	13	12	11	10	9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1
months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	months	month
Self-Assessment (must be done first), Individualized Initial Counseling (IIC) & Pre-Separation Counseling																	
ARMY DAY MY Transition MOC Crosswalk Financial Planning for Transition DOL Employment Fundamentals						VA Benefits & Services with eBenefits Registration											
						Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC Only)											
						Career Tracks											
						Capstone <i>*must be done last*</i>											
						Career Skills Program Eligibility											

TAP services represented here can be accessed face-to-face at your local TAP Center, through Army TAP Virtual Center (www.armytap.army.mil) or at 800.325.4715

Additional Resources & Information

The TAP Virtual Center (VC) provides access to required courses, counselors, transition materials, resume resources, and seminars. The Virtual Center and call line are open 24/7. The VC is beneficial for deployed and remote Soldiers, and is available online and at 1-800-325-4715.	The Career Skills Program (CSP) provides Soldiers with the opportunity to participate in apprenticeships, on-the-job training, internships, and employment skills training. For more information, visit https://home.army.mil/imcom/index.php/customers/career-skills-program.	There are four Career Tracks offered, each one taking two days. If required, the class and applicable CRS must be completed NLT 3 months prior to transition. They are Education, Employment, Entrepreneur, and Vocational.
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[*www.linkedin.com/in/taphq/](http://www.linkedin.com/in/taphq/) [*www.facebook.com/USArmyTAP](https://www.facebook.com/USArmyTAP) [*www.armytap.army.mil](http://www.armytap.army.mil) [*twitter.com/usaarmy_tap](https://twitter.com/usaarmy_tap)

Appendix 5: Success Story Submission Form



Army TAP Center Name: _____

You may write your responses in the boxes below or you may email your narrative/story to **CENTER GOV GROUP BOX EMAIL**

Name (Rank, Last, First): _____	Company Employed/School Attending/Business Started: _____
Civilian Phone Number: _____	_____
Civilian Email Address: _____	Transition Date or On Transition Leave? _____
Current MOS: _____	

We ask you to submit a narrative/story that answers as many of the following questions as you can (if you did not attend a class or the question does not apply to you, please skip the question in your narrative):

- How many months prior to transition did you start TAP? What were the benefits of going early? Do you wish you had gone earlier?
- Did you take a career track when you went through TAP (two-day education, employment, vocational training, or entrepreneurship workshops)? Did you participate in a Career Skills Program (CSP)? Please tell us about your experience.
- How did TAP help you? What did you learn?
- How did you find career success in the civilian sector (network, use social media, go to hiring events, etc.)?
- What advice can you offer transitioning Soldiers going through the program now? What is one thing you wish you had done differently? What lessons have you learned?

Release Statement: By submitting your story, you understand that your submission could be used at any time as a quote, story, narrative, etc. on social media, in media releases/press releases, on our website, in articles, briefings, and any other TAP marketing/PR efforts.

We ask that you submit "print-ready" stories, meaning they are ready to be copy/pasted into a feature with minimal spelling, grammar, and punctuation issues, though we will address those if we see them. Stories may be modified for length and flow, depending on publishing platform. If you are willing, please submit two photos for use along with the narrative – one in professional civilian attire (head shot) and another in uniform. Both photos must be copyright free (proof of release from any professional photographers) and available for re-print.

Appendix 6: POC Placard



The Installation Point of Contact
for this TAP Center is
Mr./Ms. XXXX
Phone: XXX-XXX-XXXX
Email: XXX.XXX@mail.mil

Please call or write with comments on services provided or
suggestion for improvement.

Appendix 7: DD Form 2648 eForm (Oct 2019)

SERVICE MEMBER PRE-SEPARATION/TRANSITION COUNSELING AND CAREER READINESS STANDARDS EFORM FOR SERVICE MEMBERS SEPARATING, RETIRING, RELEASED FROM ACTIVE DUTY (REFRAD)					
SECTION I - PRIVACY ACT STATEMENT					
AUTHORITY: 10 U.S.C. 1142, Pre-separation Counseling; transmittal of medical records to Department of Veterans Affairs. PURPOSE(S): To record pre-separation counseling services and benefits requested by and provided to Service members; to identify pre-separation counseling areas of interest as a basis for development of an Individual Transition Plan (ITP). The signed pre-separation counseling checklist will be maintained in the Service member's official personnel file. Title 10 USC 1142, requires that not later than 365 days before the date of separation, for anticipated losses, pre-separation counseling for Service members be made available. For unanticipated losses, or in the event a member of a reserve component is being demobilized under circumstances in which operational requirements make the 365-day requirement unfeasible, pre-separation counseling shall be made available as soon as possible within the remaining period. ROUTINE USE(S): Disclosure of records are generally permitted under 5 U.S.C. 552a(b) of the Privacy Act of 1974, as amended. Applicable Routine Use(s) are: To the Department of Veterans Affairs for available benefits to the Service member; additional routine uses are listed in the applicable system of records notice, DMD C 01, Defense Manpower Data Center Data Base; at https://dpcld.defense.gov/Privacy/SORNIndex/DOD-wide-SORN-Article/Article/570563/dmdc-01. DISCLOSURE: Voluntary; however, it may not be possible to initiate pre-separation counseling and other transition assistance services or develop an Individual Transition Plan (ITP) for a Service member if the information is not provided.					
SECTION II - SERVICE MEMBER PERSONAL INFORMATION					
1. NAME	2. DOD ID NUMBER	3. GRADE	4. DATE OF BIRTH	5. SERVICE	5a. COMPONENT
6. UNIT NAME	6a. UNIT ID CODE		7. MILITARY INSTALLATION		
8. ANTICIPATED DATE OF SEPARATION	8a. REASON FOR SEPARATION		8b. TYPE OF SEPARATION	9. DATE FORM WAS INITIATED	
10. MEMBER ALLOWS THIS FORM TO BE SENT TO FEDERAL AGENCIES FOR ADDITIONAL TRANSITION ASSISTANCE POST SEPARATION:					
10a. MEMBER ALLOWS THIS FORM TO BE SENT TO FEDERAL AND OTHER AGENCIES WHO LOOK FOR CRITICAL LANGUAGE SKILLS AND/OR REGIONAL EXPERTISE THAT COULD BE VITAL DURING TIMES OF NEED, CRISIS, AND/OR NATIONAL EMERGENCIES:					
10b. MEMBER ALLOWS THIS FORM TO BE SENT TO STATE AGENCIES FOR ADDITIONAL TRANSITION ASSISTANCE POST SEPARATION:					
10c. POST-SEPARATION EMAIL:			10d. POST-SEPARATION PHONE NUMBER:		
SECTION III - INITIAL COUNSELING					
Service members shall receive individualized initial counseling pursuant to Title 10 U.S.C., Section 1142 and DoD policies.					
11. SPOUSE/CAREGIVER/LEGAL GUARDIAN/DESIGNEE GOING TO BE PRESENT DURING PRE-SEPARATION COUNSELING:					
12. HAS THE SERVICE MEMBER COMPLETED A PERSONAL SELF-ASSESSMENT:					
13. HAS THE SERVICE MEMBER COMPLETED AN INITIAL COUNSELING:			13a. INITIAL COUNSELING COMPLETION DATE:		
14. WHAT ARE THE SERVICE MEMBER'S POST-TRANSITION GOALS:					
15. REQUIRED CRS AND SESSIONS BY SELECTED PATHWAY AND TIER:					
SECTION IV - PRE-SEPARATION / TRANSITION COUNSELING, PRE-SEPARATION / TRANSITION COUNSELING NEEDS ASSESSMENT, REVIEW, AND VERIFICATION TO MEET CAREER READINESS STANDARDS (CRS), AND TITLE 10 U.S.C. COMPLIANCE					
Service members will be counseled on all items prescribed in Title 10, United States Code (U.S.C.), Sections 1142(b) (1-18), Sections 1143, 1144, 1145, 1146, 1147, 1148, 1149, 1150, 1151, 1154, and 1155 and DoD policies. Involuntarily separated Service members receive alternative benefits and programs that apply to them. Service member completed the following to meet Career Readiness Standards (CRS): *Required					
16. Completed Pre-Separation Counseling*				Pre-Sep Assessment	Capstone CRS Review
17. Registered on eBenefits *					
18. Completed resume or provided employment verification in support of the Individual Transition Plan (ITP)					
19. Prepared a criterion-based, post separation financial plan					
20. Completed a criterion-based Individual Transition Plan (ITP) *					
21. Completed a Continuum of Military Service Opportunity Counseling (Required Active Component Only)					
22. Verify a completed Gap Analysis or provide verification of employment					
23. Completed a comparison of higher education or vocational technical training institution options					
24. I WAS COUNSELED AND RECEIVED DOCUMENTATION ON ALL ITEMS IN SECTION IV, WHICH INCLUDES ALL ITEMS LISTED ON THE PRE-SEPARATION / TRANSITION COUNSELING ADDENDUM SHEET:					
25. PRE-SEPARATION / TRANSITION COUNSELING WAS COMPLETED WITH 364 DAYS OR LESS REMAINING BEFORE SEPARATION:					
25a. PRE-SEPARATION / TRANSITION COUNSELING COMPLETED 364 DAYS OR LESS JUSTIFICATION:					
26. SERVICE MEMBER SIGNATURE & DATE			27. TRANSITION COUNSELOR SIGNATURE & DATE		

Appendix 8: TAP Client Information Sheet for Disconnected OPS

TAP CLIENT INFORMATION SHEET for Disconnected OPS			
Privacy Act Statement AUTHORITY: 10 U.S.C. 1142, Preseparation Counseling; transmittal of medical records to Department of Veterans Affairs. PURPOSE(S): To record pre-separation counseling services and benefits requested by and provided to Service members, to identify pre-separation counseling areas of interest as a basis for development of an Individual Transition Plan (ITP). The signed pre-separation counseling checklist will be maintained in the Service member's official personnel file. Title 10 USC 1142, requires that not later than 90 days before the date of separation, for anticipated losses, pre-separation counseling for Service members be made available. For unanticipated losses, or in the event a member of a reserve component is being demobilized under circumstances in which operational requirements make the 90-day requirement unfeasible, pre-separation counseling shall be made available as soon as possible within the remaining period. ROUTINE USE(S): Disclosure of records are generally permitted under 5 U.S.C. 552a (b) of the Privacy Act of 1974, as amended. Applicable Blanket Routine Use(s) are: Law Enforcement Routine Use, Congressional Inquiries, Disclosure to the Department of Justice for Litigation Routine Use, Disclosure of Information to the National Archives and Records Administration Routine Use, and Data Breach Remediation Purposes Routine Use. To the Department of Veterans Affairs for the purpose of available benefits to the Service member. The complete list of DoD Blanket Routine Uses can be found online at http://dpcld.defense.gov/Privacy/SORNIndex/BlanketRoutineUses.aspx. The applicable system of records notice is: DMDC 01, Defense Manpower Data Center Data Base. The SORNs may be found at http://dpcld.defense.gov/Privacy/SORNIndex/DOD-wide-SORN-Article-View/Article/570563/4mdc-01/. DISCLOSURE: Disclosure is voluntary however it may not be possible to initiate Pre-Separation counseling and other transition assistance services or develop an Individual Transition Plan (ITP) for a Service member if the information is not provided.			
SIGNATURE _____		DATE _____	
1. Last Name, First Name: _____		17. Reason for Separation: ☐ Discharge ☐ Retiring	
2. Type of Separation: ☐ Voluntary ☐ Involuntary		☐ Release from AD (RNG) ☐ Release from AD (IRR)	
Comments: _____		18. Special Program/Disability: ☐ MEB ☐ PEB	
3. Complete DOD ID/SSN Number: _____		19. Reason Late (If Pre-Separation Counseling was conducted 364 days or less from separation):	
4. Training/PME: Yes ☐ No ☐		☐ Mission Requirements ☐ Personal/Medical	
5. Pay Grade/Rank: _____		☐ Legal ☐ Change in Career Decision	
6. Component: ☐ AC ☐ RC ☐ 180+ on title 10		☐ Demob ☐ Prior Pre-Sep	
7. Marital Status: _____ Dependents #: _____		☐ Forced Retirement ☐ Other: _____	
8. Caregiver/Spouse/Legal Guardian/Designee present: ☐ Yes ☐ No		20. MOC: _____ Security Clearance: ☐ Yes ☐ No	
9. Assigned to WTU prior to separation: ☐ Yes ☐ No		21. Do you have any stress or concerns associated with your transition? _____	
Number of days assigned to a Warrior Transition Unit (WTU) prior to separation: _____		22. Wanted Salary: _____	
(WTU) Name: _____		a. Sufficient funds set aside: ☐ Yes ☐ No	
10. Phone Number: _____		23. Post-Transition Goals:	
11. Email (civilian): _____ (mil) _____		☐ Retiring (Not working outside the home)	
12. Type: ☐ Enlisted ☐ Warrant ☐ Commissioned		☐ Retiring (Joining Workforce/Entrepreneurship)	
13. Affiliation: ☐ Army ☐ Navy ☐ Marine Corps		☐ Employment ☐ Education	
☐ Air Force ☐ Coast Guard		☐ Entrepreneurship ☐ Vocational	
14. Unit ID Code (UIC): _____		Other: _____	
Unit Name: _____		24. Home of Record/Relocation:	
15. Installation: _____		State: _____	
16. Departure Date: _____		City: _____	
Consent Questions:		Zip code: _____	
a) Does the Service member consent to allow this form to be sent to: a. Federal agencies for additional Transition assistance post-separation? ☐ Yes ☐ No b. Federal and other agencies who look for critical language skills and/or regional expertise that could be vital during times of need, crisis, and/or national emergencies? ☐ Yes ☐ No c. Elect to participate in the long term post-transition tracking study? ☐ Yes ☐ No b) Does the Service member elect to receive additional information regarding their immigration status and expedited citizenship application? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A c) Does the Service member elect to allow this form to be sent to State/Territory Agencies for additional assistance post separation? ☐ Yes ☐ No a. Allow this form to be sent to all States/Territories or specify which States/Territories? Specify: _____			
Internal for MKS2 Staff only		March 2023	

Appendix 9: TAP Standards (ALL)

TAP Standards Tier 1	TAP Standards Tier 2	TAP Standards Tier 3
Required/Mandatory Initial Assessment with Individualized Initial Counseling Date Completed Pe-Separation Counseling Date Completed Managing Your (MY) Transition Date Completed MOC Crosswalk Date Completed Financial Planning for Transition Date Completed DoL One Day (One Day)- exemption Date Completed VA Benefits and Services Date Completed eBenefits Registration Date Completed Continuum of Military Services (AC only) – All Retirees are Exempt Date Completed Individual Transition Plan Date Completed Capstone Event with review of Post Assessment Date Completed <u>Optional</u> Employment Track-Resume or verification of employment Education /track- Comparison of colleges/universities Vocational Track- comparison of Transition schools Entrepreneurship Track- none	Required/Mandatory Initial Assessment with Individualized Initial Counseling Date Completed Pe-Separation Counseling Date Completed Managing Your (MY) Transition Date Completed MOC Crosswalk Date Completed Gap Analysis or verification of employment Date Completed Financial Planning for Transition Date Completed Post Separation Spending Plan Date Completed DoL One Day (One Day)- exemption Date Completed VA Benefits and Services Date Completed eBenefits Registration Date Completed Continuum of Military Services (AC only) – All Retirees are Exempt Date Completed Individual Transition Plan Date Completed Capstone Event with review of Post Assessment Date Completed Optional (with deliverable if applicable) Employment Track-Resume or verification of employment Education /track- Comparison of colleges/universities Vocational Track- comparison of Transition schools Entrepreneurship Track- none	Required/Mandatory Initial Assessment with Individualized Initial Counseling Date Completed Pe-Separation Counseling Date Completed Managing Your (MY) Transition Date Completed MOC Crosswalk Date Completed Gap Analysis or verification of employment Date Completed Financial Planning for Transition Date Completed Post Separation Spending Plan Date Completed DoL One Day (One Day)- exemption Date Completed VA Benefits and Services Date Completed eBenefits Registration Date Completed Continuum of Military Services (AC only) – All Retirees are Exempt Date Completed Individual Transition Plan Date Completed Capstone Event with review of Post Assessment Date Completed Mandatory (Select one with deliverable if applicable) Employment Track-Resume or verification of employment Education /track- Comparison of colleges/universities Vocational Track- comparison of Transition schools Entrepreneurship Track- none

TAP Standards Tier 1

TAP is a Congressionally mandated program that provides information, tools and training to ensure Service Members and their spouses are prepared for the next step in civilian life.

STEP 1: Enterprise Individualized Self Assessment (EISA) Initial Assessment/IIC/PSC must be completed PRIOR to Step 2

CRS Completed during Event/Brief	Name of Event	Date Completed
Completed EISA Initial Assessment prior to IIC; One-on-one with Counselor; Initiate ITP	Individualized Initial Counseling	
Attendance required	Pre-Separation Counseling	

STEP 2: Mandatory Events

CRS Completed during Event/Brief	Name of Event	Date Completed
Attendance required	Managing Your (MY) Transition	
Attendance required	MOC Crosswalk	
Attendance required	Financial Planning for Transition	
Attendance required eBenefits registration on VA.gov	VA Benefits and Services	
Attendance required	DoL One Day	
Attendance at Briefing or One-on-One	Complete a Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only) - All Retirees are Exempt	

STEP 3: OPTIONAL Track – 2 day event (optional, but highly encouraged)

If attended deliverables are optional	Name of Track	Date Completed
Draft resume or verification of employment	Employment (DoL Employment: Employment Workshop)	
Comparison of technical training institution	DoL Vocational: Career and Credential Exploration	
Comparison of higher education institution	DoD Education: Managing Your Education	
None	SBA Entrepreneurship: Boots to Business	

STEP 4: EISA Post Assessment/Capstone Event/ITP Review

All Deliverables: Completed EISA Post Assessment prior to Capstone Event; Completed ITP; eBenefits registration	Due to Counselor at Capstone Event appointment; Warm handover if necessary
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TAP Standards Tier 2

TAP is a Congressionally mandated program that provides information, tools and training to ensure Service Members and their spouses are prepared for the next step in civilian life.

STEP 1: Enterprise Individualized Self Assessment (EISA) Initial Assessment/IIC/PSC must be completed PRIOR to Step 2

CRS Completed during Event/Brief	Name of Event	Date Completed
Completed EISA Initial Assessment prior to IIC; One-on-one with Counselor; Initiate ITP	Individualized Initial Counseling	
Attendance required	Pre-Separation Counseling	

STEP 2: Mandatory Events

CRS Completed during Event/Brief	Name of Event	Date Completed
Attendance required	Managing Your (MY) Transition	
Attendance Required Gap Analysis or verification of employment	MOC Crosswalk	
Attendance Required Prepare Post Separation Spending Plan	Financial Planning for Transition	
Attendance Required eBenefits registration on VA.gov	VA Benefits and Services	
Attendance required	DoL One Day	
Attendance at Briefing or One-on-One	Complete a Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only) - All Retirees are Exempt	

STEP 3: OPTIONAL Track – 2 day event (optional, but highly encouraged)

Deliverable due to Counselor if attended	Name of Track	Date Completed
Draft resume or verification of employment	Employment (DoL Employment: Employment Workshop)	
Comparison of technical training institution	DoL Vocational: Career and Credential Exploration	
Comparison of higher education institution	DoD Education: Managing Your Education	
None	SBA Entrepreneurship: Boots to Business	

STEP 4: EISA Post Assessment/Capstone Event/ITP Review

All Deliverables: Completed EISA Post Assessment prior to Capstone Event; Completed ITP; eBenefits registration; Gap Analysis; Post Separation Spending Plan	Due to Counselor at Capstone Event appointment; Warm handover if necessary
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Updated: March 2023

TAP Standards Tier 3

TAP is a Congressionally mandated program that provides information, tools and training to ensure Service Members and their spouses are prepared for the next step in civilian life.

STEP 1: Enterprise Individualized Self Assessment (EISA) Initial Assessment/IIC/PSC must be completed PRIOR to Step 2

CRS Completed during Event/Brief	Name of Event	Date Completed
Completed EISA Initial Assessment prior to IIC; One-on-one with Counselor; Initiate ITP	Individualized Initial Counseling	
Attendance required	Pre-Separation Counseling	

STEP 2: Mandatory Events

Completed during Event/Brief	Name of Event	Date Completed
Attendance required	Managing Your (MY) Transition	
Attendance required	MOC Crosswalk	
Gap Analysis or verification of employment		
Attendance required	Financial Planning for Transition	
Prepare Post Separation Spending Plan		
Attendance required	VA Benefits and Services	
eBenefits registration on VA.gov		
Attendance required	DoL One Day	
Attendance at Briefing or One-on-One	Complete a Continuum of Military Service Counseling (AC only) - All Retirees are Exempt	

STEP 3: Mandatory Track (select one) – 2 day event

Deliverable due to Counselor	Name of Track	Date Completed
Draft resume or verification of employment	Employment (DoL Employment: Employment Workshop)	
Comparison of technical training institution	DoL Vocational: Career and Credential Exploration	
Comparison of higher education institution	DoD Education: Managing Your Education	
Attendance required	SBA Entrepreneurship: Boots to Business	

STEP 4: EISA Post Assessment/Capstone Event/ITP Review

All Deliverables: Completed EISA Post Assessment prior to Capstone Event; Completed ITP; eBenefits registration; Gap Analysis; Post Separation Spending Plan; Selected Track deliverable	Due to Counselor at Capstone Event appointment; Warm handover if necessary
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Updated: March 2023

Appendix 10: PaYS Lookup Access

Service Member look up on the Army PaYS website will allow you to look up Service Members to see if they have PaYs access and if they have selected their PaYs partner. You will be provided the PaYS partner name, POC, email, and phone number. ¹³

To request access to the 'PaYS Soldier Lookup' application, please have your Regional Manager send an email authorizing access to the PaYS Soldier Lookup application (usarmy.knox.hqda-asamra.mbx.payshelpdesk@army.mil)

Once access has been verified you will receive an email from the PaYS helpdesk requesting the following (Do not REPLY ALL to the email):

Name: (Last Name, First Name, Middle Initial)

Phone Number:

Work Email: (@army.mil)

Password: Requirements are 15 characters minimum - 20 characters maximum; must include one of each: uppercase letter, lowercase letter, number, and special character.

TAP Location:

Appendix 11: Resume Rubric

Resume Rubric

from the National Association of Colleges and Employers (NACE)

	Resume should effectively land you an interview. GOOD JOB!	Resume could land you an interview (borderline case).	Resume is average, needs improvement to rise to the "top of the stack."	Resume needs significant improvement and would be discarded during screening
Format	This resume fills the page but also is not overcrowded. There are no grammar or spelling errors. This resume could be easily scanned.	This resume almost fills the page but has some uneven white space. There may be a single spelling or grammar error here.	The font and spacing of this resume are not appealing and easily scanned. There are more than one spelling or grammar errors.	This resume is either one-half page or two to three pages long. The font is too big or may be hard to read. There is more white space than words on the page. There are multiple spelling errors.
Education Section	This section is organized, clear, and well defined. It highlights the most pertinent information. This section includes: institution with its location, graduation date, major, degree, GPA, study abroad, and any relevant course work.	This section is organized and easy to read. This section includes: institution with its location, graduation date, major, and degree. GPA is missing from this section. Also, "extra" information such as study abroad and course work are not mentioned.	This section is not well organized. Information such as institution with its location, graduation date, and major are included. Degree and GPA are not listed. There is no order to how information is formatted in this section.	This section is missing the most crucial information. Institution is listed without a location. Graduation date is not listed. Major is listed but not degree. No GPA is stated in this section.
Experience Section	This section is well defined, and information relates to the intended career field. Places of work, location, titles, and dates are included for each position. Descriptions are clear and well marketed in the form of bullet statements beginning with action verbs. This section could be split into related and other experience.	Descriptions are clear in the form of bullet statements beginning with action verbs. Descriptions are not detailed enough to fully understand what was done. Information does not relate 100 percent to the intended career field. Places of work, location, titles, and dates are included for each position.	Descriptions are not in the form of bullets beginning with action verbs. Complete sentences in paragraph form are used to describe previous positions. Places of work are included for each position but not locations, dates, and titles.	This section is not well defined, and there is no order to the descriptions of each position. Descriptions are not detailed and offer no illustration of what was done. No locations and dates of employment are listed.
Honors/Activities	This section is well organized and easy to understand. Activities and honors are listed and descriptions include skills gained and leadership roles held. Dates of involvement are listed.	This section includes all necessary information but is difficult to follow. Leadership roles within organizations are listed but skills are not defined. Dates of involvement are listed.	This section is missing key information such as leaderships positions held or dates of involvement. Organizations are listed describing the organization, not individual involvement.	This section is missing or contains very little information. Organization titles or dates of involvement are not listed. No descriptions are listed.